The Deserts of the West

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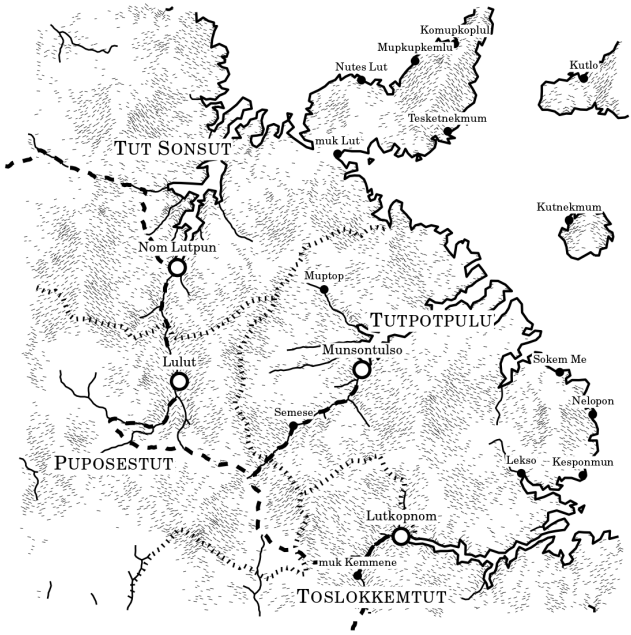
A novel of NaNoGenMo

In that Empire, the Art of Cartography attained such Perfection that the map of a single Province occupied the entirety of a City, and the map of the Empire, the entirety of a Province. In time, those Unconscionable Maps no longer satisfied, and the Cartographers Guilds struck a Map of the Empire whose size was that of the Empire, and which coincided point for point with it. The following Generations, who were not so fond of the Study of Cartography as their Forebears had been, saw that that vast map was Useless, and not without some Pitilessness was it, that they delivered it up to the Inclemencies of Sun and Winters. In the Deserts of the West, still today, there are Tattered Ruins of that Map, inhabited by Animals and Beggars; in all the Land there is no other Relic of the Disciplines of Geography.

Jorge Luis Borges, *Del rigor en la ciencia*



TUT SONSUT TO TOSLOKKEMTUT

Nom Lutpun

At the edge of colossal Nom Lutpun the traveller may see soldiers, trying their luck at *kepte*. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear songs of buoyant melancholy, sung by actors of the Blue Quarter. In the end the musk of *topketnonnut* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has surely arrived.

Around the barbican, the boulevards are lined with *setonleskeklon* trees, and the blue petals shimmer in the afternoon wind. Should one be so ill-fated as to come across a herd of mighty *teptemekket*, prized for their milk, it may be a humbling experience. Scholars swarm here, singing. The *tepom* plants will be conspicuous to a traveller. These are a deterrent to malign spirits. In the night, one can usually hear the chimes of the university clock.

Lulut

From Nom Lutpun the traveller can journey north to Lulut. It is an enjoyable journey. Along the way the road crosses a deep gully, spotted with *numkekkut* plants. When a traveller crosses into Puposestut, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *kupsutopnutkek* bushes and hedgerows.

The traveller, on reaching the outskirts of the city, can observe the obsidian vaulted roof of the famed prison of Kekumnolu. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of mournful bliss, sung by criminals of the city. Finally the perfume of *setonleskeklon* trees fills the air, and one is without a doubt in Lulut.

In the Red District, the alleyways are paved with *tetmun* stone, inlaid with bronze. In the event that a traveller is unlucky enough to encounter a fight between two lovers, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. Writers flock here, talking. In the early morning, one may often hear the song of the *sokmokup* birds. A distracted observer will not notice the stone gargoyles that grace the doorways. These function as a memento of the revolution which recently ravaged Lulut.

Munsontulso

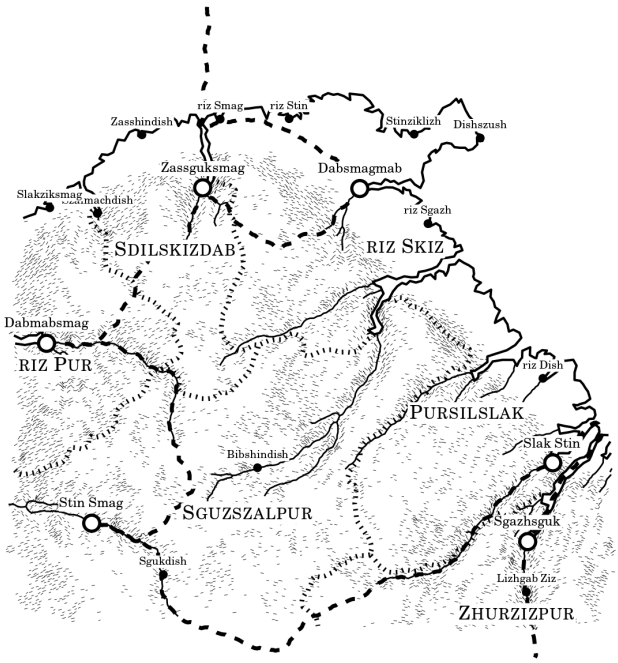
Leaving Lulut a traveller may go west to Munsontulso. It is a pleasant journey. As the traveller enters Tutpotpulu, the foliage changes, giving way to scrubland and hedgerows. On the route, *kultulmusko* graze. At one point the track crosses a broad depression.

A traveller, passing into the vast metropolis of Munsontulso, may find hairy *teptemekket*, the national animal of Tutpotpulu. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the clanging of the bastion clock. Eventually the bouquet of *kekutpomnupun* bushes fills the wind, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the castle of Koltotenput, the roadways are lined with *nup* flowers, and the pleasant smell fills the late evening air. The caged *soktu* birds will be apparent. These mark the shop of a fortune-teller. A traveller can occasionally hear songs of joyous gloom, sung by merchants of the Merchants' Quarter.

Lutkopnom

Onwards from Munsontulso one can travel north to Lutkopnom. It is an agreeable journey. Near the roadside, *penup* trees grow. As



the traveller enters Toslokkemtut, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the landscape.

Nearing the outskirts of famous Lutkopnom a traveller will come across scattered goldsmiths, setting out their stalls. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the song of the *sokmokup* birds, kept by farmers. At last the scent of *topketnonnut* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Lutkopnom.

In the Temple District of the city, the plazas are paved with granite, inlaid with sandstone. If one is so fortunate as to see scholars dancing, it can be an educational experience. A traveller will take note of the *tepom* plants. These warn off evil influences. The bourgeoisie crowd here, telling stories and talking.

RIZ SKIZ TO ZHURZIZPUR

Dabsmagmab

A traveller, entering the city, will discern the emerald clock-tower of the tremendous counting-house of Szurschiz. Closer to the

heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of doleful joy, sung by priests of the surrounding countryside. Finally the perfume of *shuchsnipschutsran* flowers fills the wind, and one has undeniably arrived.

Close to the mint of Machsgish, the alleyways are lined with *srangal* bushes, and the emerald leaves rustle in the morning breeze. Citizens swarm here, practising their skill on the *ziztishshikbub* tables. The *sbish* stone figurines which ornament the eaves will be obvious. These act as a caution to hostile spirits. In the early afternoon, the traveller may typically hear the sweet song of the *sgukbiblizhrum* birds.

Zassguksmag

From Dabsmagmab one may journey east to Zassguksmag. It is a simple journey. *Shuchsnipschutsran* flowers grow by the fringe of the road. When the traveller crosses the border into Sdilskizdab, the greenery changes, giving way to open fields and meadows. Along the way the route crosses a deep gorge.

Approaching the walls of Zassguksmag one may make out the gleaming lookout of the monumental citadel of Riz Szursdil. From so far, a traveller is unable to catch sight of how criminals congregate near its gates, laughing and singing. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, one will hear the knell of the barbican clock. In the end the musk of *pazhsran* plants fills the air, and the traveller is truly in Zassguksmag.

In the Tailors' Quarter, the streets are lined with *shug* trees, and the delicate bouquet fills the late night air. One can often hear songs of mirthful misery, sung by scholars of a nearby village. If a traveller is lucky enough to encounter a quarrel between two lovers, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Dabmabsmag

Onwards from Zassguksmag the traveller can go north-east to Dabmabsmag. At one point the road crosses a broad rift, spotted with *szashszhishsranschid* bushes. Shaggy *szhiplipkud* graze near the bank of the track. As one crosses the border into riz Pur, the vegetation changes, giving way to groves of *dablipszhishshug* flowers and wild *shug* flowers.

On entering the metropolis of Dabmabsmag a traveller can find actors, trying their luck at *szushzishkash*. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the song of the *sguk-*

biblizhrum birds, kept by farmers. Ultimately the scent of *chashshuz* fruit fills the breeze, and one is surely in Dabmabsmag.

Around the castle of Lipsgish, the back-streets are paved with bronze, inlaid with marble. One will see the tame *shid* birds. These are in memory of the sickness which twenty years ago tormented the surrounding countryside. Citizens cluster here, dancing. In the early evening, a traveller can typically hear songs of heavy-hearted pleasure, sung by priests of the city.

Stin Smag

Leaving Dabmabsmag the traveller may go north to Stin Smag. It is a pleasant journey. Near the roadside, *chushtis* graze. When a traveller enters Sguzszalpur, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the countryside. At one point the route crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *shuchsnipschutsran* trees.

The traveller, on reaching the gates of famous Stin Smag, can espy the chryselephantine tower of the great bastion of Gilshap. Even though from here it may seem magnificent, the natives of the city find its form distasteful, and stay away from it. Nearer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear the balmy song of the *nir* birds. At last the fragrance of *chashshuz* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the New Quarter of the city, the plazas are lined with *szash-szhishsranschid* bushes. The tame *shid* birds will be tricky to miss to one. These indicate the home of a smith. Should a traveller be so ill-fated as to come across a herd of horned *szhiplipkud*, beloved for their horns, it can be half a day before escape is possible. One may occasionally hear the bells of the dancing-hall clock. Artisans lounge here, telling stories and talking.

Slak Stin

Onwards from Stin Smag the traveller can travel to Slak Stin. *Shug* plants grow on the road. Along the way the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *szalschidshipskizh* flowers. As a traveller crosses into Pursilslak, the greenery changes, giving way to pastures and hedgerows.

The traveller, entering the city, may stumble upon mighty *chushtis*, the sacred animal of Pursilslak. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of blissful sadness, sung by soldiers of the Red District. In the end the aroma of *dablipszhishshug* bushes fills the breeze, and the traveller is undeniably in Slak Stin.

In the vicinity of the citadel, the boulevards are paved with basalt. In the late morning, a traveller can sometimes hear the tolling of the theatre clock. Farmers throng here, practising their skill on the *szushzishkash* field.

Sgazhsguk

From Slak Stin the traveller may journey to Sgazhsguk. Squalls typically trouble boats in this area. Off the bow jet-black *zhazh* fish can often be observed, moving in unison. Flocks of *sgukbiblizhrum* birds may occasionally be spotted true the coast.

Near the outskirts of the vast city of Sgazhsguk one will make out the famed market-hall of Kush Bish. At this distance, a traveller has no way to espy how citizens avoid it. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear songs of elegiac glee, sung by actors of Sgazhsguk. Eventually the smell of *chashshuz* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has truly arrived.

In the Actors' Quarter of the city, the squares are lined with *galmabsran* trees, and the gentle scent fills the evening wind. The idle rich cluster here, singing. In the event that a traveller is unlucky enough to see the famous Szilstim procession, it can be a most instructive experience. In the night, the traveller may sometimes hear the sweet song of the *nir* birds, kept by merchants.

PEIŽIYSELB TO ŽO JU KAR

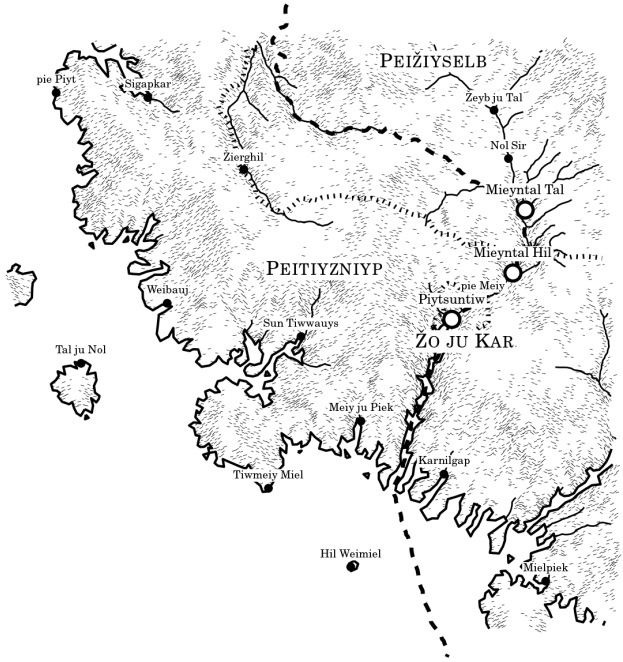
Mieyntal Tal

A traveller, passing into the city of Mieyntal Tal, can come across citizens, dancing and praying. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the clanging of the barbican clock. Finally the perfume of *hansun* flowers fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Mieyntal Tal.

Close to the mint, the plazas are paved with granite, inlaid with obsidian. Soldiers swarm here, laughing. A hasty visitor will overlook the *ba* stone medallions that adorn the archways. These call to mind the war which in times past beset a nearby village.

Mieyntal Hil

Leaving Mieyntal Tal the traveller can travel north to Mieyntal Hil. The road is crowded, and the journey takes but an afternoon.



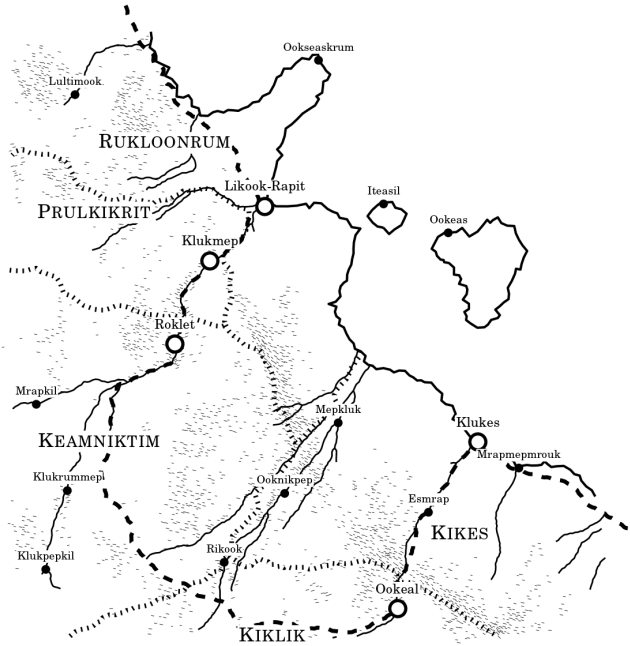
Near the side of the track, shaggy *delč* graze. When one enters Peitiyzniyp, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls upon the land. At one point the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *jeiynelgžoy* plants.

Nearing the gates of the city a traveller may encounter merchants, hawking their wares. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the song of the *jauyt* birds. Eventually the aroma of *paurhiernelg* trees fills the air, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Around the theatre of Gihnažiy, the back-streets are lined with *paurmieynkar* flowers, and the yellow blossoms whisper in the early morning wind. Should the traveller be so unfortunate as to stumble upon the bourgeoisie talking, one may be drawn in, and it may be a couple of hours before escape is possible. Labourers flock here, showing off at the game of *jeid*. The *paur* bushes will be conspicuous. These serve to deter malign influences. A traveller may occasionally hear the knell of the bastion clock.

Piytsuntiw

From Mieyntal Hil one can go north-east to Piytsuntiw. It is a delightful journey. *Paurhiernelg* plants grow by the road. As the



traveller enters Žo ju Kar, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the countryside. Along the way the track crosses a deep gully, spotted with *jeiynelgžoy* bushes.

A traveller, approaching the walls of colossal Piytsuntiw, will see the famous watchtower of Čirnseynelg. Although from here it seems enchanting, the people of Piytsuntiw find its bulk obscene, and hide from it. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will hear songs of hopeful melancholy, sung by petty criminals of the surrounding countryside. At last the fragrance of *nielhier* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Fishmongers' District of the city, the streets are paved with limestone, inlaid with stone. The idle rich lounge here, telling stories and dancing. One will notice the caged *wauyšzeybjauyt* birds. These signify the place of business of a doctor. If a traveller is lucky enough to come across a game of *to*, it can be half a day before escape is possible.

Rukloonrum to Kikes

Likook-Rapit

Entering the monstrous city of Likook-Rapit the traveller can find farmers, singing. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the song of the *ikles* birds. Ultimately the musk of *rooklool* trees fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Likook-Rapit.

In the Goldsmiths' District of the city, the boulevards are lined with *riklup* bushes. Citizens cluster here, showing off on the *rouknikkrum* board. If one is so charmed as to come across an altercation between two lovers, it may be a most educational experience. A traveller can often hear the song of the *esrikik* birds, kept by priests. The sandstone carvings which decorate the walls will be easy to see to the traveller. These serve as a warning to harmful influences.

Klukmep

Leaving Likook-Rapit one may journey to Klukmep. The route is well-trodden, and the journey takes but an afternoon. When the traveller crosses into Prulkikrit, the vegetation changes, giving way to thickets of *loolmran* plants and hedgerows. At one point the road crosses a broad depression, spotted with *tillool* flowers.

The traveller, at the edge of the great city, can discern the obsidian spires of the infamous castle of Rousleap. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear songs of desolate exuberance, sung by artisans of a nearby village. Eventually the perfume of *epit* fruit fills the wind, and one is surely in Klukmep.

In the vicinity of the fortress of Mroukrikrous, the alleyways are paved with marble. An inattentive traveller will miss the *loolmran* trees. These are a reminder of the war which not long ago troubled Klukmep. In the event that a traveller is blessed enough to see a herd of hairy *krakpruleam*, bred for racing by the actors of the city, it may be an edifying experience. In the afternoon, a traveller may typically hear the striking of the university clock. Writers gather here, talking and laughing.

Roklet

From Klukmep the traveller may travel north-east to Roklet. On the roadside, *krumsukseas* graze. Along the way the track crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *riklup* bushes. As one enters Keamniktim, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the landscape.

Outside the monumental metropolis the traveller may encounter shaggy *suktimleap*, beloved for their meat. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the pleasant song of the *ikles* birds, kept by soldiers. In the end the smell of *rooklool* flowers fills the breeze, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Tailors' Quarter, the boulevards are lined with *mranlup* plants, and the balmy fragrance fills the late evening air. The caged *esrikik* birds will be clear to one. These betoken the shop of an apothecary. Farmers flock here, praying. A traveller can sometimes hear songs of exuberant dejection, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. If the traveller is lucky enough to stumble upon merchants dancing, one may be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Ookeal

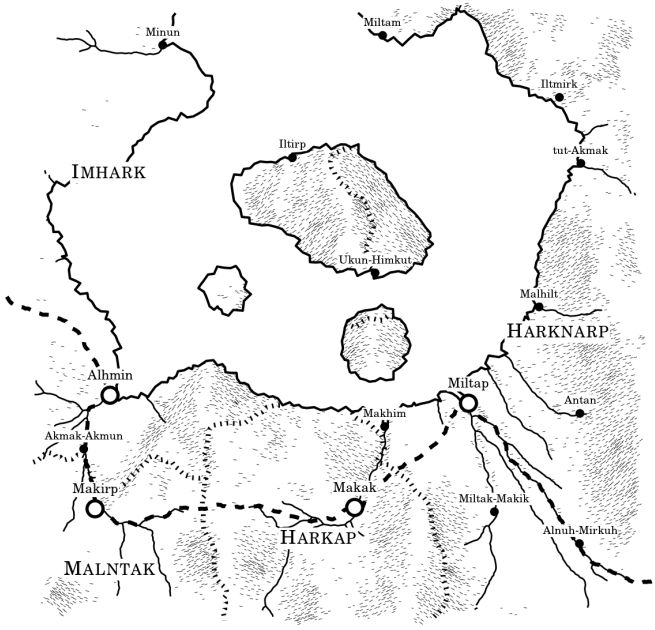
Onwards from Roklet a traveller can go to Ookeal. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking some days. *Loolmran* trees grow by the roadside. At one point the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *riklup* plants.

A traveller, on reaching the outskirts of the gargantuan city of Ookeal, will catch sight of the crystal towers of the vast counting-house of Mranrous. From so far, a traveller cannot make out how writers congregate around it. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the gentle song of the *ikles* birds, kept by citizens. Ultimately the scent of *roumremkil* fruit fills the wind, and one is surely in Ookeal.

Near the market-hall, the plazas are paved with ivory. The traveller will be impressed by the *prullupeal* flowers. These serve to warn off evil spirits. Should a traveller be so unfortunate as to find a game of *rouknikkrum*, it can be a very instructive experience.

Klukes

Leaving Ookeal one may journey south-west to Klukes. It is a smooth journey. Near the verge of the route, *pepsuk* graze. Along



the way the road crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *loolmran* trees.

Near to iniquitous Klukes a traveller will catch sight of horned *suktimleap*, the sacred animal of Kikes. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear songs of sombre delight, sung by petty criminals of a nearby village. At last the perfume of *mranlup* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

In the Actors' District of the city, the back-streets are lined with *rooklool* bushes, and the fragrant leaves sway in the air. The idle rich throng here, trying their luck on the *rouknikkrum* court. One may typically hear the tolling of the theatre clock.

IMHARK TO HARKNARP

Alhmin

The traveller, near the walls of the metropolis of Alhmin, may observe the limestone spire of the gargantuan bastion of Kurmkilm. Despite the fact that from such a large distance it may look quaint, the citizens of the city find its architecture unsavoury, and steer

clear of it. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the sweet song of the *armim* birds. In the end the bouquet of *anurp* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is beyond doubt in Alhmin.

In the vicinity of the counting-house of Alnkilm, the alleyways are paved with sandstone. In the early night, one can occasionally hear the clanging of the barbican clock. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to come across an argument between two lovers, one might be drawn in, and find it hard to escape. Actors teem here, talking and laughing. The bronze figurines that adorn the archways will be obvious. These mark the workplace of a fortune-teller.

Makirp

From Alhmin the traveller can go to Makirp. It is an enjoyable journey. *Arnak* plants grow on the road. At one point the track crosses a deep gorge.

Passing into the monstrous city a traveller may encounter philosophers, practising their skill at the game of *irpkarm*. Somewhat closer to the heart of the city, one will hear the balmy song of the *mannih* birds, kept by writers. At last the musk of *irmarn* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller has truly arrived.

In the Green Quarter of the city, the squares are lined with *kurmkark* flowers. In the event that one is so unfortunate as to catch sight of the revered Himut ritual, it may be two hours before escape is possible. The traveller can sometimes hear songs of gleeful gloom, sung by artisans of the Red District. Priests lounge here, singing.

Makak

Onwards from Makirp one can travel west to Makak. As a traveller crosses the border into Harkap, the greenery changes, giving way to open fields and scrubland. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *karnkark* trees.

A traveller, approaching the gates of colossal Makak, can see the gleaming dome of the infamous theatre of Alhkilm. From here, the traveller has no way to espy how the bourgeoisie avoid it, trying their luck at the game of *irpkarm*. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the delicate song of the *mannih* birds, kept by writers. Eventually the perfume of *anurp* fruit fills the breeze, and one has undeniably arrived.

Close to the market-hall, the streets are paved with lead, inlaid with marble. Artisans mill here, praying and telling stories. If the traveller is fortunate enough to stumble upon a game of *nihpurn*, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Miltap

Onwards from Makak a traveller may journey south-west to Miltap. It is a smooth journey. When one enters Harknarp, the foliage changes, giving way to clumps of *kutkark* plants and *irmarn* flowers. At one point the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *kurmarn* bushes. By the fringe of the route, *ahnark* graze.

Nearing the edge of the city of Miltap the traveller will come across a series of fishmongers, setting out their stalls. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the sound of the castle clock. Finally the scent of *arnmurk* plants fills the air, and one is surely in Miltap.

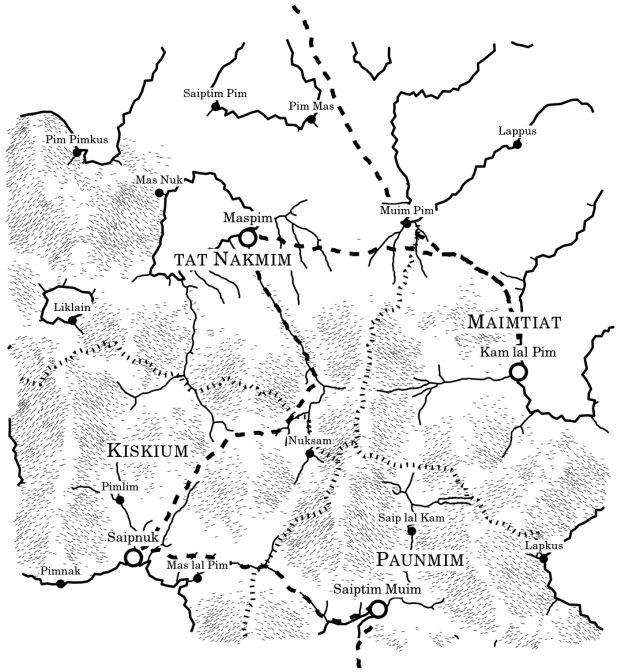
In the Temple Quarter of the city, the plazas are lined with *arnak* flowers, and the red petals rustle in the wind. In the late morning, a traveller may usually hear the clanging of the bastion clock. The *karnkark* trees will be difficult to miss to the traveller. These act as a deterrent to unwanted influences. Soldiers swarm here, laughing and praying.

Maimtiat to Paunmim

Kam lal Pim

The traveller, on entering the city, can catch sight of the immense temple of Miaktuil. At this distance, a traveller is unable to see how farmers flock by it, showing off on the *kak* tables. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the gentle song of the *num* birds, kept by petty criminals. In the end the aroma of *kilpaun* plants fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

Near the counting-house of Piumsak, the alleyways are paved with granite. A careless visitor will not notice the tame *num* birds. These are a vestige of the sickness which twenty years ago engulfed the city. The idle rich congregate here, telling stories.



Maspim

From Kam lal Pim a traveller may go south-east to Maspim. Along the way the road crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *kil* flowers. When the traveller crosses the border into tat Nakmim, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the land. *Tak* graze on the roadside.

Outside tremendous Maspim one can discern the basalt roof of the celebrated citadel of Piumlil. Though from so far it appear magnificent, the denizens of Maspim find its form disagreeable, and shun it. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of mournful bliss, sung by writers of Maspim. Finally the bouquet of *paim* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller is undeniably in Maspim.

Around the palace, the boulevards are lined with *kilmuim* bushes, and the pleasant fragrance fills the night breeze. Should one be so unlucky as to see labourers talking, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. The idle rich crowd here, trying their luck on the *lium* field. The obsidian statues which decorate the balustrades will be conspicuous. These signify the home of a smith.

Saipnuk

Leaving Maspim the traveller can travel north to Saipnuk. The track is arduous, but scenic, taking three weeks. By the road, *kil* trees grow. As one crosses into Kiskium, the vegetation changes, giving way to open fields and meadows. Along the way the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *kilpaun* trees.

A traveller, at the gates of the great city of Saipnuk, may find mighty *kais*, bred for show by the artisans of a nearby village. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the song of the *num* birds. Ultimately the perfume of *paim* fruit fills the air, and one is surely in Saipnuk.

In the Fishmongers' District of the city, the roadways are paved with bronze, inlaid with stone. Merchants cluster here, dancing and laughing. In the early evening, the traveller can often hear the bells of the watchtower clock. One will take note of the caged *lisnak* birds. These indicate the workplace of an artisan.

Saiptim Muim

Leaving Saipnuk the traveller may go west to Saiptim Muim. It is a pleasant journey. When a traveller enters Paunmim, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls upon the countryside. Near the side of the track, *kilpaun* flowers grow. At one point the route crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *kilmam* plants.

Approaching the edge of the monumental city one will observe the bone-white towers of the mighty fortress of Lim Kam. From such a great distance, the traveller cannot discern how philosophers shun it, showing off at the game of *kakkan*. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the song of the *liam* birds, kept by actors. At last the smell of *kil* bushes fills the breeze, and one has truly arrived.

In the New Quarter, the back-streets are paved with ivory, inlaid with granite. Citizens teem here, praying. The traveller may sometimes hear songs of buoyant sadness, sung by the bourgeoisie of the surrounding countryside.

KOKAK TO OM EPKA IKNO

om Anti

The traveller, near to the immense city of om Anti, will encounter crowds of hawkers, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the striking of the counting-house clock. Eventually the aroma of *kones* fruit fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in om Anti.

Close to the castle, the squares are lined with *kamop* flowers, and the delicate blossoms whisper in the late night wind. The *litu* trees will be clear. These commemorate the revolution which long ago beset the Ancient District. Scholars lounge here, telling stories and talking. One can usually hear the sweet song of the *taklap* birds, kept by labourers. In the event that a traveller is ill-fated enough to see a squabble between two lovers, it can be a couple of hours before escape is possible.

om Kaen Akan

From om Anti the traveller can journey south-west to om Kaen Akan. The track is busy, and the journey takes but half a day. As the traveller crosses the border into Akan a Ekok, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls across the landscape. Horned *okas* graze on the roadside.

Near the outskirts of colossal om Kaen Akan a traveller may catch sight of hairy *nosek*, valued for their meat. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear songs of sorrowful joy, sung by philosophers of om Kaen Akan. Finally the scent of *litu* flowers fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Blue Quarter of the city, the squares are paved with limestone, inlaid with basalt. If a traveller is so lucky as to find the intricate Mae Ema procession, it can be a very educational experience. In the morning, one may typically hear the knell of the palace clock. Petty criminals swarm here, practising their skill on the *emtut* court.

Lulso a Ale

Onwards from om Kaen Akan a traveller can travel north to Lulso a Ale. The road is long, but rewarding, taking several days. By the edge of the road, *susin* plants grow. At one point the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *litu* bushes. As the traveller enters Mukok, the greenery changes, giving way to hedgerows and thickets of *tutop* flowers.

A traveller, entering the celebrated metropolis, will catch sight of the sapphire tower of the great bastion of Om Islap. Nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear songs of ebullient melancholy, sung by artisans of the Green District. At last the musk of *eslat* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Lulso a Ale.

In the Merchants' Quarter, the roadways are lined with *susin* trees. The tame *taklul* birds will be easy to see to a traveller. These act to ward off hostile spirits. Soldiers gather here, telling stories and praying. In the afternoon, one can usually hear the song of the *taklap* birds, kept by citizens. Should a traveller be charmed enough to come across a game of *emtut*, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Mikem Alko

Leaving Lulso a Ale the traveller may travel south-east to Mikem Alko. It is an agreeable journey. *Okas* graze near the route. When the traveller crosses into Kokum a Ikep, the vegetation changes, giving way to pastures and scrubland.

The traveller, outside famed Mikem Alko, may encounter philosophers, dancing. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear the clanging of the theatre clock. Eventually the smell of *tutop* flowers fills the wind, and a traveller has truly arrived.

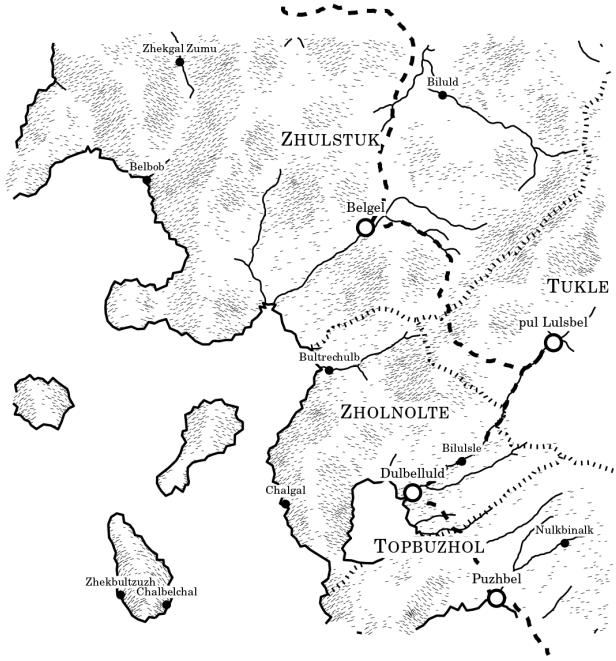
In the vicinity of the castle of Esok a Islap, the alleyways are paved with marble. In the early afternoon, the traveller may occasionally hear the balmy song of the *sintak* birds. A distracted observer will overlook the lead columns that ornament the lintels. These repel unwanted spirits. Scholars throng here, trying their luck at the game of *emtut*. If a traveller is so unlucky as to find the idle rich singing, the traveller may be drawn in, and it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Akan Lulkes

From Mikem Alko a traveller may journey to Akan Lulkes. It is a delightful journey. Along the way the road crosses a deep gorge. When one enters om Epka Ikno, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the countryside.

Nearing the walls of the vast city of Akan Lulkes the traveller can discern the famous dancing-hall of Kaen a Kakas. While from here it looks enchanting, the people of the city find its architecture distasteful, and avoid it. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear the sound of the temple clock. Ultimately the aroma of *eslat* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Akan Lulkes.

Around the counting-house of Akkek, the plazas are lined with *lusu* bushes, and the pleasant perfume fills the late night air. Should the traveller be so unfortunate as to come across an altercation between two lovers, it may be a most humbling experience. One can often hear songs of elegiac glee, sung by philosophers of the city. Citizens crowd here, telling stories and laughing. A traveller will notice the caged *moktak* birds. These serve as a reminder of the plague which recently ravaged the surrounding countryside.



Zhulstuk to Topbuzhol

Belgel

Entering the colossal city the traveller can catch sight of the emerald vaulted roof of the tremendous fortress of Selzhulmu. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the balmy song of the *talpuzh* birds, kept by writers. Finally the fragrance of *lolridchoch* trees fills the air, and one has surely arrived.

In the Grey District of the city, the streets are paved with bronze, inlaid with basalt. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to encounter the holy Teton parade, it may be three hours before escape is possible. In the late evening, the traveller may usually hear the peal of the university clock. Scholars teem here, praying.

pul Lulsbel

Onwards from Belgel a traveller can go north-west to pul Lulsbel. The track is arduous, but scenic, taking many weeks. At one point the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *mulnkulol* plants. As one crosses the border into Tukle, the foliage changes, giving way to *selbulnu* flowers and open fields. On the roadside, *lolridchoch* bushes grow.

A traveller, on reaching the outskirts of pul Lulsbel, can find scattered pedlars, setting out their stalls. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear songs of dirgeful ecstasy, sung by soldiers of pul Lulsbel. At last the smell of *meldguln* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in pul Lulsbel.

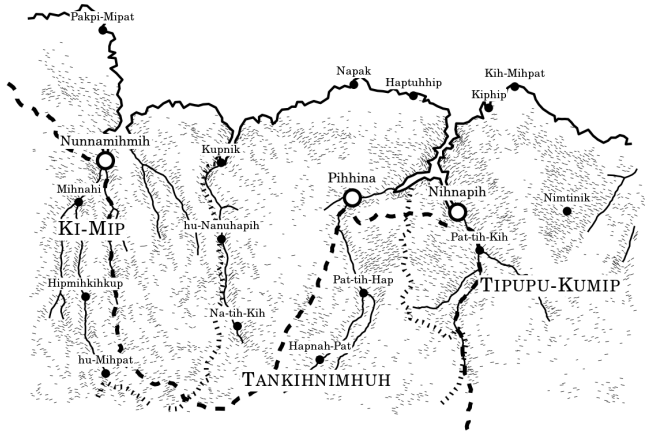
Near the barbican of Kuzhultop, the squares are lined with *nalklol* plants, and the golden leaves sway in the night air. The sandstone medallions which adorn the rooftops will be obvious to a traveller. These call to mind the pestilence which long ago devastated pul Lulsbel. Labourers congregate here, singing and laughing. If the traveller is so fortunate as to come across the intricate Tonrald ritual, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. In the evening, one can occasionally hear the striking of the market-hall clock.

Dulbelluld

Leaving pul Lulsbel the traveller may journey to Dulbelluld. Along the way the road crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *lolridchoch* bushes. *Mulnkulol* trees grow by the bank of the route. When a traveller enters Zholnolte, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls over the terrain.

The traveller, at the gates of the infamous city of Dulbelluld, will find petty criminals, showing off at the game of *gukolnel*. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of mirthful melancholy, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. In the end the scent of *nullol* flowers fills the wind, and one has truly arrived.

In the Artisans' Quarter, the back-streets are lined with *shilzuzh* plants, and the gentle fragrance fills the early morning breeze. In the early night, the traveller may sometimes hear the song of the *chalkoltal* birds, kept by philosophers. Artisans mill here, singing and telling stories.



Puzhbel

From Dulbelluld a traveller can travel north-west to Puzhbel. It is a pleasant journey. At one point the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *gulnmulol* flowers. On the road, *mulnmoki* graze.

On entering the iniquitous city a traveller will observe the silver clock-tower of the celebrated prison of Nubep. Although from here it seems beautiful, the natives of Puzhbel find its form obscene, and steer clear of it. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear songs of hopeful misery, sung by labourers of the city. Ultimately the musk of *kobtop* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is undeniably in Puzhbel.

In the vicinity of the fortress of Kolkeki, the boulevards are paved with marble. A careless visitor will fail to see the *shilzuzh* bushes. These denote the shop of an apothecary. In the evening, one can often hear the tolling of the castle clock. Actors cluster here, praying. In the event that the traveller is unlucky enough to encounter a fight between two lovers, it may be a most instructive experience.

KI-MIP TO TIPUPU-KUMIP

Nunnamihmih

A traveller, on reaching the edge of Nunnamihmih, can catch sight of horned *huntuhkiptuh*, prized for their leather. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the sweet song of the *huktu* birds, kept by writers. Finally the aroma of *tahmih* trees fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

Around the citadel, the plazas are lined with *kat* plants. Priests mill here, trying their luck on the *nuh* tables. The lead carvings that grace the eaves will be hard to miss. These signify the home of a doctor. Should a traveller be so blessed as to stumble upon a herd of shaggy *puphunha*, bred for work by the petty criminals of the Goldsmiths' District, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Pihhina

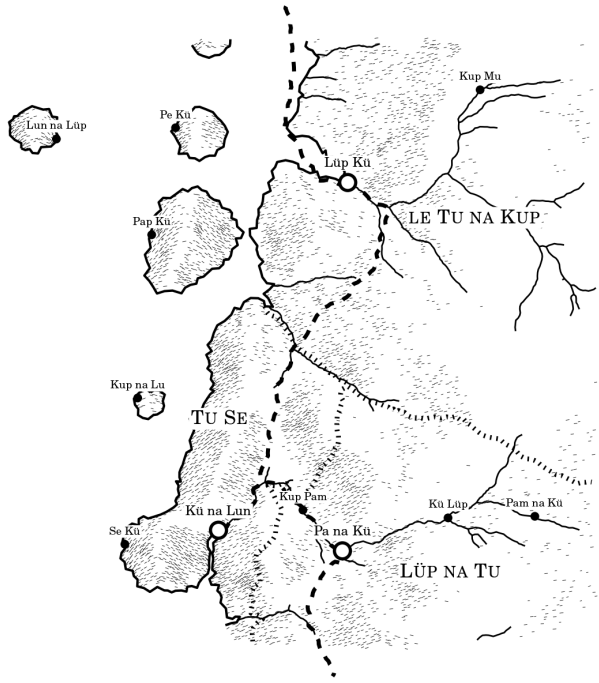
Leaving Nunnamihmih one may journey west to Pihhina. The route is long, but rewarding, taking two weeks. Hairy *paknimhup* graze near the roadside. Along the way the track crosses a deep ravine.

Near to the monstrous metropolis the traveller can espy the crystal spires of the monumental theatre of Tuhhummu. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the clanging of the watchtower clock. In the end the fragrance of *muhkupi* fruit fills the wind, and one is surely in Pihhina.

In the Red Quarter, the roadways are paved with ivory. Soldiers crowd here, laughing and talking. If the traveller is lucky enough to see a game of *nuhkim*, a traveller may be drawn in, and find it tricky to escape.

Nihnapih

Onwards from Pihhina one can go west to Nihnapih. On the fringe of the route, *nintahnihtuk* flowers grow. As the traveller crosses the border into Tipupu-Kumip, the greenery changes, giving way to scrubland and woods of *kat* bushes.



The traveller, passing into the gargantuan city of Nihnapih, may find crowds of goldsmiths, hawking their wares. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear songs of forlorn pleasure, sung by scholars of a nearby village. Finally the smell of *tutahmat* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Merchants' District of the city, the squares are lined with *tahmih* plants, and the yellow petals shimmer in the late night air. Should a traveller be so unfortunate as to come across the famous Mahpun dance, it can be a very educational experience. In the early afternoon, one may typically hear the pleasant song of the *huktu* birds, kept by farmers. The traveller will see the tame *hukpihkinpak* birds. These function as a vestige of the war which recently engulfed the surrounding countryside.

LE TU NA KUP TO LÜP NA TU

Lüp Kü

Approaching the outskirts of Lüp Kü a traveller may discern the mighty counting-house of Me Lun. From such a large distance, one has no way to observe how priests cluster around its limestone walls, dancing. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will hear the bells of the market-hall clock. At last the bouquet of *pit* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Lüp Kü.

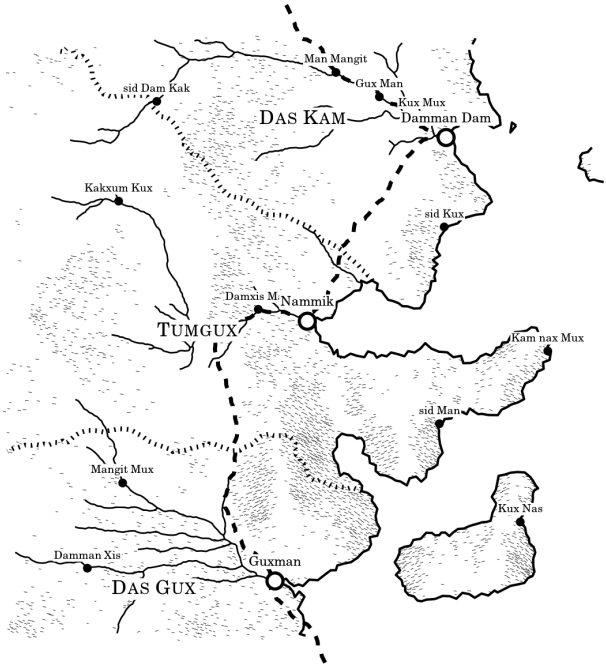
Close to the prison of Sa Ko, the roadways are paved with granite, inlaid with stone. Labourers congregate here, singing and telling stories. In the late morning, one can usually hear the balmy song of the *tap* birds, kept by artisans. The *ta* flowers will be apparent to the traveller. These serve as a warning to harmful influences.

Kü na Lun

From Lüp Kü one may journey north to Kü na Lun. The road is arduous, but scenic, taking some days. At one point the track crosses a broad valley, spotted with *ma* bushes. As a traveller enters Tu Se, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls across the land. Near the roadside, mighty *püt* graze.

A traveller, entering the immense city, may stumble upon horned *püt*, the national animal of Tu Se. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of blissful dejection, sung by writers of Kü na Lun. Eventually the musk of *ma* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller has truly arrived.

Near the temple of Le Ko Pu, the plazas are lined with *ta* flowers, and the sweet aroma fills the early evening air. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to catch sight of a game of *ki*, it can be two hours before escape is possible. In the early afternoon, one may occasionally hear the delicate song of the *tap* birds. Citizens gather here, laughing.



Pa na Kü

Onwards from Kü na Lun the traveller can travel west to Pa na Kü. It is a smooth journey. Along the way the track crosses a deep gorge. When a traveller crosses into Lüp na Tu, the foliage changes, giving way to *ma* bushes and hedgerows. *Ta* trees grow by the verge of the road.

Nearing the walls of the monstrous city of Pa na Kü one can espy the famous university of Le Pu Me. Even though from so far it may appear quaint, the citizens of Pa na Kü find its bulk distasteful, and stay away from it. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the chimes of the fortress clock. Ultimately the scent of *man* fruit fills the wind, and one is undoubtedly in Pa na Kü.

In the Ancient Quarter, the alleyways are paved with sandstone. If a traveller is so fortunate as to find an altercation between two lovers, the traveller might be drawn in, and it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the late morning, one may often hear songs of desolate exuberance, sung by scholars of the Blue District. An inattentive observer will miss the *ma* plants. These betoken the shop of a smith.

Das Kam to Das Gux

Damman Dam

The traveller, outside tremendous Damman Dam, will encounter philosophers, showing off at the game of *nat*. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *xig* birds, kept by actors. In the end the fragrance of *taktan* bushes fills the breeze, and the traveller has surely arrived.

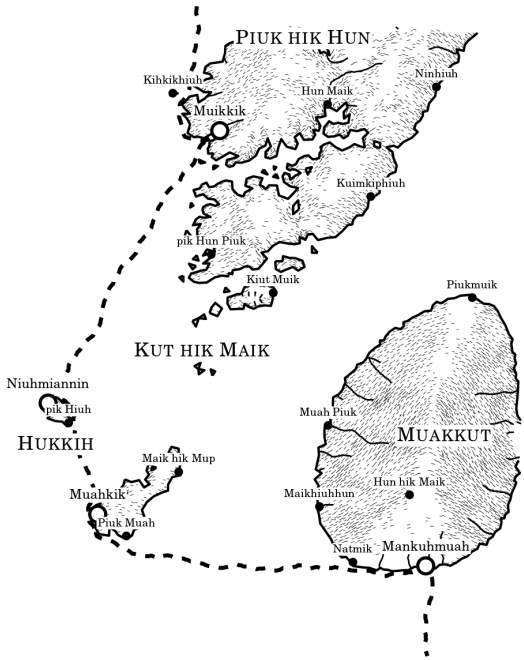
Around the dancing-hall, the roadways are lined with *dax* trees, and the red leaves rustle in the early evening air. The bronze figures which adorn the doorways will be obvious to a traveller. These serve to deter malign spirits. In the event that one is lucky enough to catch sight of a herd of *taxkud*, the national animal of Das Kam, it can be a most instructive experience. In the late night, the traveller can usually hear songs of joyous misery, sung by merchants of a nearby village.

Nammik

From Damman Dam one may journey north-east to Nammik. When the traveller enters Tumgux, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls upon the countryside. *Daxmam* plants grow by the route. At one point the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *susdax* trees.

At the edge of the iniquitous city of Nammik a traveller will come across the idle rich, praying and dancing. Closer to the centre of the city, one will begin to hear the clanging of the palace clock. At last the smell of *kammis* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Nammik.

In the Artisans' Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with basalt, inlaid with marble. Should a traveller be so blessed as to find a game of *kakmas*, one may be drawn in, and unable to leave. The traveller will be humbled by the caged *xakmin* birds. These commemorate the sickness which not long ago troubled the city. In the afternoon, one may sometimes hear songs of mournful pleasure, sung by writers of the surrounding countryside. Merchants mill here, talking.



Guxman

Leaving Nammik a traveller can go north to Guxman. Along the way the route crosses a deep gully, spotted with *taktan* flowers. As the traveller crosses into Das Gux, the vegetation changes, giving way to scrubland and open fields. On the roadside, *xim* graze.

A traveller, on entering the celebrated metropolis, can make out the gargantuan market-hall of Kak nax Max. From here, one is unable to discern how labourers hide from it, telling stories and laughing. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the song of the *xakgin* birds. Finally the aroma of *miskam* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the castle of Max Kak, the plazas are lined with *susdax* bushes, and the sweet musk fills the early morning wind. The granite statues that ornament the balustrades will be conspicuous to one. These denote the place of business of an apothecary. If a traveller is unlucky enough to encounter a quarrel between two lovers, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. The traveller can occasionally hear songs of hopeful gloom, sung by the idle rich of the city. Soldiers swarm here, singing.

PIUK HIK HUN TO MUAKKUT

Muikkik

On reaching the outskirts of great Muikkik a traveller may see a series of merchants, setting out their stalls. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the striking of the university clock. Eventually the smell of *kikmanpim* plants fills the air, and the traveller is without a doubt in Muikkik.

In the Old District of the city, the back-streets are paved with lead, inlaid with limestone. If a traveller is so ill-fated as to stumble upon the intricate Mim Nuim parade, it may be a very humbling experience. Farmers teem here, practising their skill on the *hunmuin* field. A hasty visitor will not notice the *kikmanpim* trees. These are in memory of the plague which twenty years ago ravaged a nearby village. In the late evening, one may often hear the pleasant song of the *takninmian* birds, kept by writers.

Niuhmiannin

Leaving Muikkik the traveller may journey north-east to Niuhmiannin. As this route is well-traficked, a traveller can usually charter a small boat. Despite the fact that the crossing is surprisingly comfortable, craft are often beset by gales. The traveller may see flocks of seabirds the land's edge.

The traveller, passing into Niuhmiannin, will observe the bronze roof of the infamous market-hall of Kap hik Kuin. Though at this distance it may look elegant, denizens of the city find its architecture unsavoury, and avoid it. Nearer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear songs of plaintive delight, sung by philosophers of Niuhmiannin. At last the bouquet of *tan* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has surely arrived.

In the New Quarter, the squares are lined with *him* flowers. The obsidian columns which decorate the walls will be easy to see to the traveller. These function as a caution to hostile influences. In the event that one is lucky enough to come across a herd of hairy *tipmuk*, bred for racing by the actors of the Ancient District, it may be half a day before escape is possible. Scholars cluster here, trying their luck at the game of *hunmuin*. In the early morning, a traveller can typically hear the peal of the watchtower clock.

Muahkik

Onwards from Niuhmiannin one can go to Muahkik. Many ships traffic these waters, so the traveller can sometimes find space on a fishing ship. The shore flocks of seabirds can usually be seen. There are often, in the water nearby, shoals of *tiknatpak* fish, barely visible beneath the surf.

Approaching the edge of the immense city one will catch sight of the bone-white lookout of the gargantuan theatre of Kuin Kap. Even though from here it may seem beautiful, the people of the city find its bulk disagreeable, and shun it. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the gentle song of the *tiukkunhuit* birds, kept by writers. Ultimately the perfume of *pah* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is undoubtedly in Muahkik.

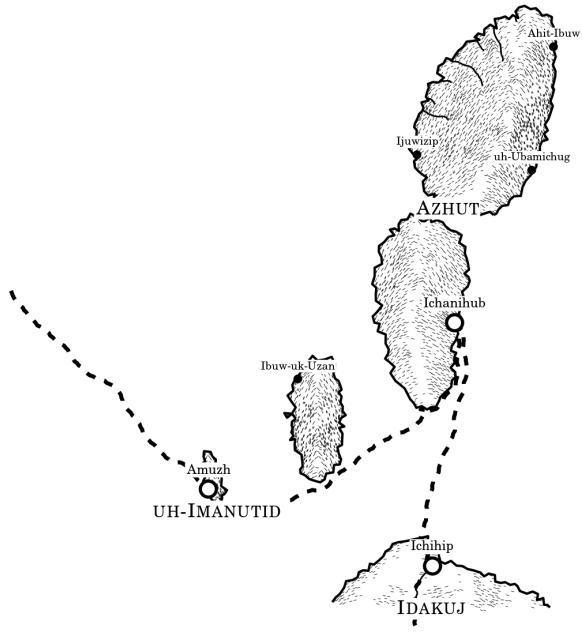
Close to the temple of Kap hik Nim, the streets are lined with *him* trees, and the delicate scent fills the late night wind. One will notice the *muknuh* plants. These indicate the home of a smith. In the afternoon, the traveller may typically hear the bells of the university clock. Should one be so blessed as to find labourers talking, a traveller may be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape.

Mankuhmuah

From Muahkik the traveller may travel west to Mankuhmuah. As this route is busy, a traveller can sometimes obtain passage on a small fishing vessel. Notwithstanding the storms, the crossing is pleasant. *Hihnatmait* birds may occasionally be spotted the coast, circling overhead. One may enjoy dried seaweed, spiced with *tan* berries, as eaten by both crew and passengers. By the side of the boat there are usually vividly striped *kuihpakkiat* fish, glistening in the sunlight.

A traveller, at the outskirts of the city of Mankuhmuah, may catch sight of merchants, dancing. Closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of gleeful dejection, sung by farmers of the city. Finally the aroma of *him* flowers fills the air, and a traveller has truly arrived.

In the Goldsmiths' District of the city, the boulevards are paved with ivory, inlaid with *tian* stone. In the event that one is unlucky enough to stumble upon an argument between two lovers, it can be a most instructive experience. In the night, the traveller can often hear the sweet song of the *piaptikhuit* birds, kept by soldiers. Writers crowd here, laughing and singing.



UH-IMANUTID TO IDAKUJ

Amuzh

Entering the monstrous metropolis one can encounter mighty *itum*, beloved for their milk. Nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the clanging of the mint clock. Eventually the bouquet of *achanipup* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is undeniably in Amuzh.

Around the castle of Inajijas, the roadways are lined with *izis* bushes, and the fragrant blossoms sway in the early evening air. If a traveller is so lucky as to catch sight of a game of *ipadig*, one might be drawn in, and unable to leave. In the late afternoon, the traveller may usually hear songs of sorrowful ecstasy, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. The tame *iwujizh* birds will be clear. These act as a reminder of the revolution which long ago tormented the Old Quarter.

Ichanihub

Leaving Amuzh one can journey south-west to Ichanihub. In these waters, craft are sometimes plagued by foul weather conditions, but the route is easy. A traveller can typically see iridescent *ikawag* fish near the side of the boat, leaping from wave to wave. The shore, the traveller can hear *apijubuz* birds, riding the breeze.

The traveller, nearing the gates of the city of Ichanihub, can see the mighty counting-house of Inuch. From so far, one cannot discern how citizens hide from it, laughing. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of blissful gloom, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. In the end the fragrance of *uzijis* plants fills the breeze, and one has surely arrived.

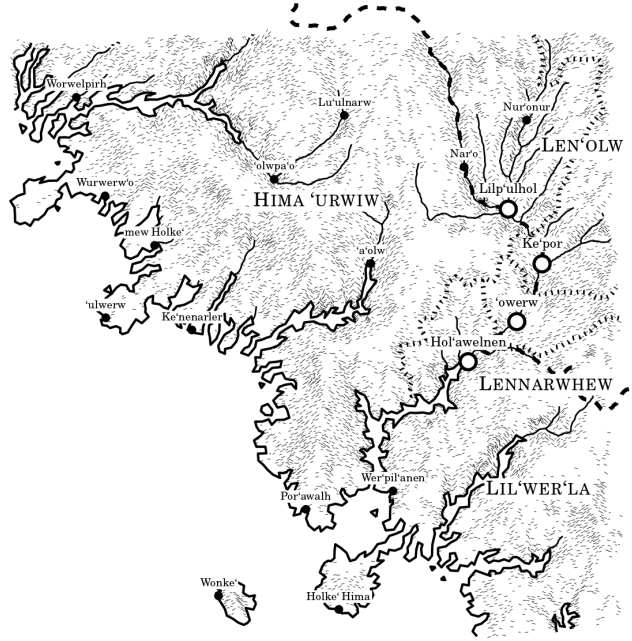
In the Temple District of the city, the squares are paved with obsidian, inlaid with marble. The traveller can usually hear the peal of the watchtower clock. A careless observer will fail to see the basalt gargoyles that grace the eaves. These mark the workplace of an artisan. Should a traveller be fortunate enough to encounter a herd of horned *izuban*, bred for show by the philosophers of a nearby village, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. Artisans congregate here, talking and telling stories.

Ichihip

Onwards from Ichanihub the traveller may travel north to Ichihip. Fishermen and passengers alike eat a hearty stew made of *idizh* bird meat and turtle meat, garnished with *izis* root. A traveller may see flocks of seabirds the land's edge, diving for *izikimaz* fish. Squalls often torment vessels near here, but the crossing is very safe.

Outside the famed city the traveller will come across the bourgeoisie, practising their skill on the *ipadig* board. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the pleasant song of the *izuzaj* birds. Finally the perfume of *imup* fruit fills the air, and a traveller is beyond doubt in Ichihip.

Near the barbican, the alleyways are lined with *izabig* bushes. The *uzijis* flowers will be almost impossible to miss to the traveller. These serve to ward off evil spirits. In the event that one is so blessed as to find the sacred Idituzuz ceremony, it may be an educational experience. Petty criminals teem here, praying.



HIMA ʻURWIW TO LILʻWERʻLA

Lilpʻulhol

A traveller, near the edge of the monumental metropolis of Lilpʻulhol, will catch sight of the gleaming tower of the famous fortress of Hawla. While from here it looks quaint, the natives of Lilpʻulhol find its form repellent, and stay away from it. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the chimes of the dancing-hall clock. At last the aroma of *ʻellonwerw* trees fills the breeze, and a traveller is undeniably in Lilpʻulhol.

In the Grey Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with *warʻwalwu* stone. If one is ill-fated enough to catch sight of labourers laughing, it can be a few hours before escape is possible. The traveller may typically hear songs of sombre bliss, sung by actors of Lilpʻulhol.

Ke'por

Leaving Lilp'ulhol a traveller can go north-west to Ke'por. The road is well-trodden, and the journey takes but half a day. At one point the route crosses a broad rift. As one enters Len'olw, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls over the landscape. *Lonlawworhew* bushes grow on the side of the track.

The traveller, passing into tremendous Ke'por, can see *pilhopkalnur*, the sacred animal of Len'olw. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the balmy song of the *walhlelwma* birds, kept by the bourgeoisie. Ultimately the scent of *'elnulmulwhi* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has truly arrived.

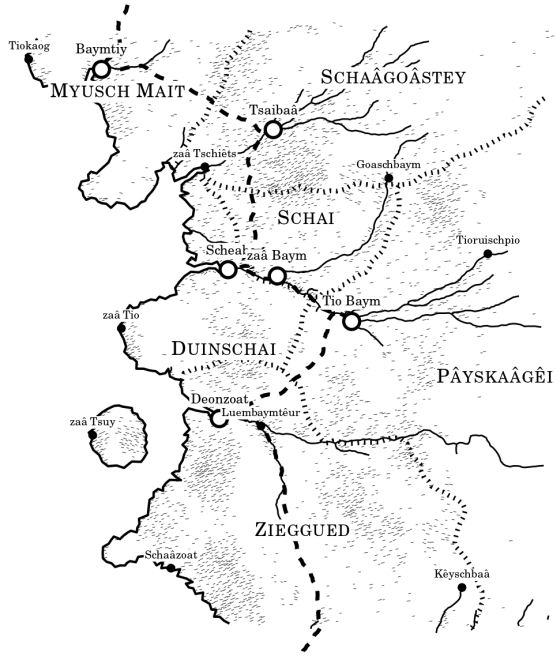
In the vicinity of the university of Harwnurpikmi, the roadways are paved with ivory, inlaid with obsidian. Scholars cluster here, singing and telling stories. In the morning, one can sometimes hear the tolling of the citadel clock. The granite carvings that grace the doorways will be obvious. These call to mind the pestilence which in times past devastated the surrounding countryside. Should the traveller be fortunate enough to stumble upon a herd of hairy *pilhopkalnur*, bred for work by the farmers of the city, a traveller may be drawn in, and it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

'owerw

From Ke'por the traveller may journey to 'owerw. It is an agreeable journey. When one enters Lennarwhew, the greenery changes, giving way to hedgerows and meadows. Along the way the road crosses a deep canyon. By the track, *lamiwame* graze.

Approaching the walls of the immense city one may espy the monstrous prison of Lupik. From so far, the traveller has no way to make out how merchants throng near it, singing. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear songs of exuberant misery, sung by the idle rich of a nearby village. In the end the fragrance of *'ellonwerw* plants fills the air, and one is without a doubt in 'owerw.

In the Artisans' District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *'alplonpoh* flowers. Citizens crowd here, showing off at the game of *wikhemi*. A traveller may occasionally hear the sound of the market-hall clock.



Hol‘awelnen

Onwards from ‘owerw the traveller can journey north-east to Hol‘awelnen. The route is crowded, and the journey takes but two hours. Near the roadside, shaggy *lamiwame* graze. As one crosses the border into Lil‘wer‘la, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the landscape. At one point the road crosses a broad depression, spotted with *lonlawworhew* bushes.

On entering the tremendous city of Hol‘awelnen the traveller will catch sight of crowds of fruit-sellers, setting out their stalls. Somewhat closer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the sweet song of the *hikolp* birds. Eventually the bouquet of *‘alplonpoh* plants fills the breeze, and one has truly arrived.

Around the theatre of ‘Alwlahaw, the back-streets are paved with *war‘walwu* stone. In the early night, the traveller can often hear songs of mournful exuberance, sung by petty criminals of the Blue Quarter. In the event that a traveller is so unlucky as to come across a fight between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. One will see the caged *walhlelwma* birds. These betoken the place of business of an apothecary.

Myusch Mait to Zieggued

Baymtiy

A traveller, nearing the outskirts of Baymtiy, may observe the diamond towers of the celebrated palace of Reyschyus. Despite the fact that from this distance it may appear enchanting, the citizens of the city find its architecture obscene, and steer clear of it. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the striking of the market-hall clock. Ultimately the perfume of *tschiâmdâisuischêosâu* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

Close to the dancing-hall of Ruebschyus, the boulevards are lined with *naischdiêbsuinaetsiât* flowers, and the delicate petals whisper in the late afternoon air. Soldiers flock here, praying and dancing. In the morning, the traveller may usually hear songs of doleful bliss, sung by philosophers of Baymtiy. The caged *toetsch* birds will be apparent to one. These are a relic of the sickness which recently engulfed the city. If the traveller is so lucky as to see the holy Râunbêis ritual, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Tsaibaâ

From Baymtiy a traveller may travel west to Tsaibaâ. When one crosses into Schaâgoâstey, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and copses of *koitschtêurgoêltsiâtschiats* bushes. Along the way the route crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *goêlruischtscheâschkoitschtêur* trees.

Approaching the walls of the famed city of Tsaibaâ the traveller may catch sight of priests, practising their skill on the *diêbtsaitseibuyriâp* field. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear the delicate song of the *goêltoetsch* birds, kept by petty criminals. Finally the aroma of *tschiâmdâisuischêosâu* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is undeniably in Tsaibaâ.

In the Goldsmiths' District, the streets are paved with lead. A distracted traveller will not notice the *goêlruischtscheâschkoitschtêur* plants. These serve as a warning to malign influences. In the afternoon, one can typically hear the bells of the castle clock. Artisans teem here, telling stories and singing. Should the traveller be

charmed enough to come across a game of *gâusch*, it can be a very edifying experience.

Scheab

Leaving Tsaibaâ a traveller can travel to Scheab. At one point the track crosses a broad valley. *Biâgiêkêyschliaschbuy* flowers grow on the track. As one enters Duinschai, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls upon the land.

The traveller, entering monumental Scheab, will find hairy *giêzuaschyegtschia* valued for their meat. A little nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear the balmy song of the *niêbiâgêimoi* birds, kept by labourers. Ultimately the musk of *koitschtêurgoêltsiâtschiats* trees fills the air, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Near the temple of Deonguan, the roadways are lined with *naischdiêbsuinaetsiât* flowers, and the pleasant smell fills the early night breeze. In the late evening, one may usually hear the peal of the theatre clock. The granite figurines which decorate the walls will be clear to a traveller. These signify the home of a fortune-teller. In the event that the traveller is so unlucky as to see the idle rich talking, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. Merchants cluster here, trying their luck at the game of *gâuschkaogkyitschzeêbschiats*.

zaâ Baym

From Scheab one may go west to zaâ Baym. Along the way the road crosses a deep chasm. When a traveller crosses into Schai, the vegetation changes, giving way to *koitschtêurgoêltsiâtschiats* plants and meadows.

A traveller, passing into the immense city, can catch sight of the vast university of Guankêysch. At such a great distance, one is unable to espy how priests gather around its crystal door, telling stories. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear songs of hopeful melancholy, sung by scholars of the surrounding countryside. In the end the perfume of *tiytoischschâescheusch* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is undoubtedly in zaâ Baym.

In the Fishmongers' Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with stone, inlaid with sandstone. Should one be fortunate enough to catch sight of a herd of mighty *giêzuaschyegtschialuâ*, the national animal of Schai, a traveller may be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape. Actors congregate here, trying their luck on the *diêbtsaitseibuyriâp* tables. The tame *niêbiâgêimoi* birds will be easy to see to the traveller. These deter evil spirits.

Tio Baym

Onwards from zaâ Baym one can journey to Tio Baym. It is a smooth journey. Near the edge of the route, horned *schyeg* graze. At one point the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *diêbsaukêyschbiâsoâ* flowers. As a traveller enters Pâyskaâgêi, there is a variation in the light, and a harsh cast falls upon the countryside.

At the gates of infamous Tio Baym one can see merchants, hawking their wares. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of buoyant dejection, sung by artisans of Tio Baym. Eventually the musk of *biâgiêkêyschliaschbuy* trees fills the breeze, and the traveller is without a doubt in Tio Baym.

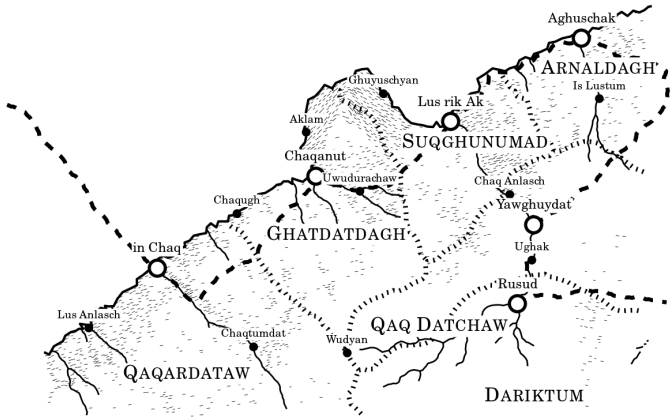
In the Tailors' District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *goêlruischtscheâschkoitschtêur* bushes. If one is so ill-fated as to encounter the revered Kaisau parade, it may be a very instructive experience. One will take note of the *naischdiêbsuinaetsiât* plants. These are in memory of the war which twenty years ago beset a nearby village. Writers mill here, talking and dancing. In the early morning, the traveller can sometimes hear the gentle song of the *toetsch* birds.

Deonzoat

Leaving Tio Baym a traveller may journey north-east to Deonzoat. It is a simple journey. When one crosses into Zieggued, the greenery changes, giving way to groves of *liaschgiêgeotbuy* flowers and hedgerows. Along the way the road crosses a deep gorge. *Schaâsoâ* bushes grow on the verge of the track.

Near to the famed city of Deonzoat the traveller will discern the basalt clock-tower of the colossal mint of Geot lyu Noe. Although from so far it appear alluring, people of Deonzoat find its bulk unsavoury, and avoid it. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the balmy song of the *toetsch* birds. Ultimately the bouquet of *koerpiênneisch* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the citadel of Noekaogrueb, the streets are paved with marble. Scholars swarm here, laughing. Should one be unlucky enough to catch sight of citizens talking, the traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.



QAQARDATAW TO DARIKTUM

in Chaq

The traveller, nearing the outskirts of in Chaq, may come across artisans, practising their skill at the game of *suykich*. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the bells of the market-hall clock. Finally the perfume of *lughalqamrugh* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

Around the prison, the squares are lined with *ghuyuwschislugh* flowers. A careless observer will overlook the caged *qamunkustuk* birds. These function as a memento of the war which long ago devastated the surrounding countryside. If a traveller is so charmed as to encounter a herd of mighty *dabmutyighsugh*, valued for their horns, it may be half a day before escape is possible. Soldiers teem here, praying and dancing. In the late night, the traveller can typically hear songs of desolate delight, sung by priests of a nearby village.

Chaqanut

Leaving in Chaq a traveller can go south-west to Chaqanut. It is a pleasant journey. Near the roadside, *wudghudlablunit* graze. Along the way the road crosses a broad depression. As one enters Ghatdatdagh, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *ghunkuslughghat* plants and scrubland.

A traveller, entering the city, will catch sight of the obsidian spires of the tremendous counting-house of Abnal. Closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of forlorn exuberance, sung by petty criminals of the city. At last the fragrance of *chuch* fruit fills the air, and one is undeniably in Chaqanut.

In the Ancient Quarter of the city, the back-streets are paved with *dabkusichschumaw* stone, inlaid with obsidian. In the late evening, a traveller may sometimes hear the song of the *qamunkustuk* birds, kept by philosophers. The *kuswudyachlughit* flowers will be obvious. These denote the workplace of an apothecary.

Lus rik Ak

From Chaqanut one may travel west to Lus rik Ak. At one point the track crosses a deep canyon. When the traveller crosses the border into Suqghunumad, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls over the terrain. *Lughyigh* trees grow by the route.

On entering the city one can find *kil*, bred for racing by the labourers of a nearby village. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the sound of the bastion clock. Eventually the aroma of *lughalqamrugh* trees fills the breeze, and the traveller is surely in Lus rik Ak.

In the vicinity of the theatre, the alleyways are paved with sandstone. Should one be so fortunate as to stumble upon the famous Kaghyaghdus procession, it can be a most humbling experience. In the afternoon, the traveller can typically hear songs of merry gloom, sung by farmers of the city.

Aghuschak

Leaving Lus rik Ak a traveller can travel south-west to Aghuschak. It is a simple journey. As the traveller enters Arnaldagh, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls across the countryside. Along the way the road crosses a broad rift, spotted with *lughnasch* flowers.

The traveller, on reaching the edge of Aghuschak, can see the monumental dancing-hall of Ghayghudim. From here, one cannot observe how actors shun it. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *uschghuyuschghimnasch* birds, kept by priests. Ultimately the bouquet of *chuch* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Blue District of the city, the streets are lined with *chiyaskaghkus* plants, and the emerald leaves shimmer in the air. In the event that one is lucky enough to catch sight of a game of *latnuschqughchughghad*, a traveller might be drawn in, and it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. The traveller will notice the marble figures that ornament the balustrades. These are a deterrent to harmful influences. In the morning, a traveller may occasionally hear songs of plaintive glee, sung by merchants of the Temple Quarter. Writers mill here, talking and singing.

Yawghuydat

Onwards from Aghuschak one can journey to Yawghuydat. It is a delightful journey. On the side of the track, hairy *wudghudlablunit* graze. When the traveller crosses the border into Qaq Datchaw, the foliage changes, giving way to open fields and pastures.

Near the walls of the famed city of Yawghuydat a traveller will catch sight of the granite dome of the infamous citadel of Daqghay Urab. A little closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the striking of the temple clock. Finally the musk of *isluskuschiydus* trees fills the breeze, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

Near the barbican of Isch Urab, the boulevards are lined with *lughalqamrugh* bushes, and the sweet bouquet fills the early afternoon wind. In the late evening, a traveller can often hear the gentle song of the *tuk* birds, kept by the idle rich. The granite carvings which adorn the archways will be apparent to one. These indicate the shop of a fortune-teller. In the event that the traveller is so unfortunate as to come across a quarrel between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. Actors crowd here, praying.

Rusud

From Yawghuydat one may travel north to Rusud. Shaggy *dabmutyighsugh* graze by the roadside. As the traveller enters Dariktum, there is a shift in the light, and a harsh cast falls upon the terrain. At one point the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *lughnasch* flowers.

Outside the iniquitous metropolis of Rusud a traveller may stumble upon scattered pedlars, setting out their stalls. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of blissful sadness, sung by citizens of Rusud. In the end the musk of *chuchghachkusdus* fruit fills the air, and one is truly in Rusud.

In the Grey District of the city, the squares are paved with lead. If the traveller is blessed enough to find labourers dancing, it may be a most edifying experience. Philosophers congregate here, showing off on the *kiq* court.

LOKSLALPEAK TO PESLOKMUN

Potnukškoop

A traveller, approaching the outskirts of Potnukškoop, may see petty criminals, telling stories. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the chimes of the theatre clock. Ultimately the perfume of *lonmiknuk* fruit fills the breeze, and one is undeniably in Potnukškoop.

Around the market-hall, the streets are lined with *kootstoon-*

mouk bushes, and the golden blossoms rustle in the night air. In the early morning, the traveller may usually hear songs of mournful pleasure, sung by artisans of Potnukškoop. Merchants cluster here, practising their skill at the game of *meakškakseat*. The tame *nukpous* birds will be clear. These act to warn off unwanted spirits.

Smessnip

Onwards from Potnukškoop a traveller may go south-west to Smessnip. It is an enjoyable journey. Along the way the road crosses a deep gully, spotted with *nuksel* trees. Near the track, *kootsmes* flowers grow.

The traveller, passing into the colossal city, will espy the crystal vaulted roof of the celebrated citadel of Peakškoul. From so far, one has no way to make out how writers flock by it, laughing and talking. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the song of the *nukpous* birds, kept by citizens. At last the fragrance of *šletkootmeak* plants fills the wind, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Ancient Quarter, the plazas are paved with basalt, inlaid with limestone. Soldiers throng here, laughing. Should a traveller be fortunate enough to come across a game of *šmoonšlelskouk*, it can be a couple of hours before escape is possible. In the late afternoon, the traveller can typically hear the clanging of the counting-house clock. A hasty visitor will miss the *nuksel* trees. These call to mind the pestilence which in times past troubled the surrounding countryside.

pos-Snipsen

Leaving Smessnip one can journey north-west to pos-Snipsen. It is a smooth journey. *Kootsmes* bushes grow on the roadside. At one point the route crosses a broad valley. When a traveller crosses into Šletspuklok, the greenery changes, giving way to meadows and scrubland.

At the edge of the great metropolis of pos-Snipsen the traveller can catch sight of a series of fishmongers, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear songs of gleeful melancholy, sung by labourers of the Green District. In the end the smell of *kootstoonmouk* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

Close to the castle of Pounspun, the back-streets are lined with *kootstoonmouk* flowers, and the delicate aroma fills the early evening air. The caged *nukpous* birds will be conspicuous to the traveller.

These act to repel malign influences. If one is so ill-fated as to find a squabble between two lovers, the traveller may be drawn in, and find it tricky to escape. In the late morning, one may sometimes hear the pleasant song of the *kealšpeasšnes* birds, kept by the idle rich. The bourgeoisie lounge here, dancing and telling stories.

Stoonsonpot

From pos-Snipsen a traveller may travel to Stoonsonpot. The route is extremely easy, even with the storms which often plague boats in this area. The coast flocks of seabirds may occasionally be observed, circling overhead.

A traveller, entering monstrous Stoonsonpot, may observe the infamous prison of Škoulpeak. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the bells of the watchtower clock. Eventually the smell of *kokslous* fruit fills the wind, and one is undoubtedly in Stoonsonpot.

In the Merchants' Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with marble, inlaid with obsidian. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to stumble upon the sacred Pos-Moussnep ceremony, it may be a very educational experience. Scholars mill here, trying their luck on the *meakškakseat* board. The traveller can usually hear the song of the *nukpous* birds. One will see the *kootstoonmouk* trees. These mark the workplace of a doctor.

Slutpestoop

Onwards from Stoonsonpot a traveller can go south to Slutpestoop. Flocks of *kealšpeasšnes* birds can typically be spotted true the land's edge, riding the breeze. In spite of the stormy weather conditions, the crossing is quite comfortable. In the water nearby *spunsneaksen* fish may often be observed, barely visible beneath the waves. One will enjoy braised *kootsmes* fruit, spiced with *šletkootmeak* flowers, as eaten by sailors and passengers alike. The spicy flavour is enchanting.

Nearing the walls of the tremendous city the traveller will see *stoonsulmip*, the sacred animal of Kistoulkous. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the peal of the university clock. Ultimately the aroma of *kiskil* fruit fills the air, and one has surely arrived.

In the vicinity of the mint of Kissmesskoot, the squares are lined with *kootstoonmouk* bushes, and the yellow petals sway in the early evening wind. In the event that a traveller is so unlucky as to encounter an altercation between two lovers, it may be half

a day before escape is possible. Petty criminals throng here, dancing and laughing. In the late night, the traveller may sometimes hear songs of melancholy joy, sung by merchants of the city.

pos-Koussnip

From Slutpestoop a traveller can journey north-west to pos-Koussnip. Many ships traverse these waters, and one can occasionally find space on a small trading boat. The traveller can hear flocks of seabirds the shore, diving for fish. *Koussneak* fish can usually be seen off the stern, moving in unison. Both crew and passengers snack on grilled turtle meat, garnished with *spuksel* flowers. The flavour is bitter, but spicy.

A traveller, outside the mighty city of pos-Koussnip, can catch sight of the bronze lookout of the immense market-hall of Pounkimspuk. Even though from such a large distance it may look elegant, denizens of the city find its architecture disagreeable, and stay away from it. A little closer to the centre of the city, one will hear the sweet song of the *peatšnes* birds, kept by labourers. In the end the fragrance of *spuksel* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller is truly in pos-Koussnip.

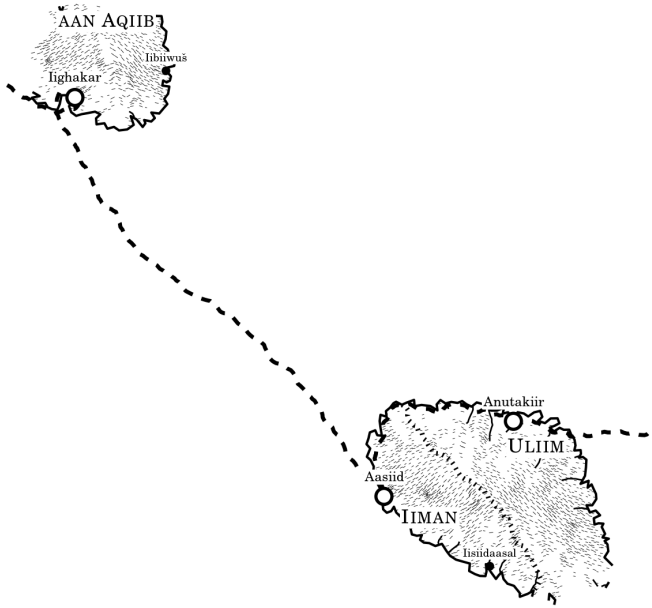
In the Fishmongers' District of the city, the streets are paved with granite, inlaid with limestone. A traveller can occasionally hear the sound of the bastion clock. An inattentive visitor will fail to see the lead gargoyles that adorn the doorways. These act as a caution to evil spirits.

AAN AQIIB TO ULIIM

Iighakar

Near to gargantuan Iighakar the traveller may stumble upon the idle rich, singing. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the song of the *iriiqugh* birds. Eventually the perfume of *uraawiw* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Near the dancing-hall of Iisud, the alleyways are lined with *unaawiirumal* plants. In the morning, the traveller may usually hear songs of ebullient gloom, sung by writers of the Old District. The tame *iwiiliiš* birds will be easy to see. These function as a vestige of the plague which twenty years ago tormented a nearby village.

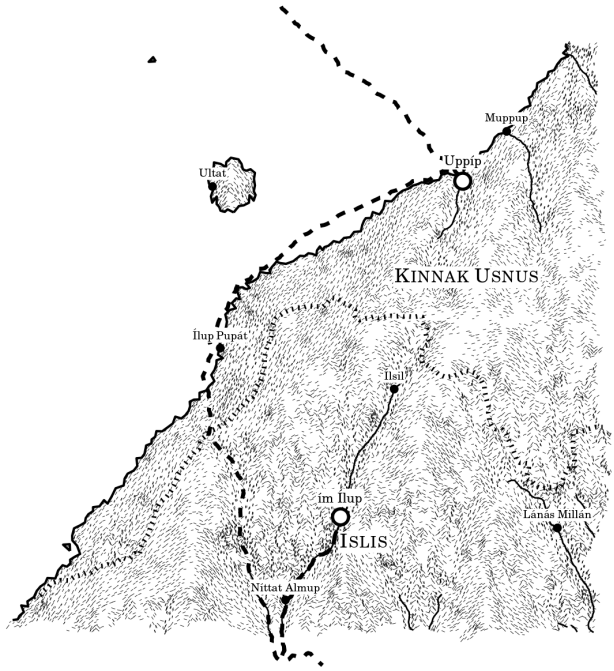


Aasiid

Onwards from Iighakar a traveller may travel north-west to Aasiid. As the route is well-traficked, one can typically obtain passage on a small fishing ship. Flocks of *iiliidiibaaxiix* birds can sometimes be spotted the coast, riding the air. Near here, squalls often beset vessels, but the crossing is pleasant.

Near the outskirts of the great city of Aasiid the traveller will discern the monstrous watchtower of Ubiinišitaam. From here, one cannot make out how citizens steer clear of it, showing off on the *iišuligh* field. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the balmy song of the *iraakarab* birds, kept by petty criminals. Finally the bouquet of *umiit* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller is surely in Aasiid.

In the Blue Quarter of the city, the plazas are paved with stone. If a traveller is lucky enough to catch sight of a game of *aaghusigh*, it can be a most humbling experience. One will be impressed by the *uwis* plants. These betoken the home of an artisan. In the night, the traveller can occasionally hear songs of elegiac delight, sung by priests of the surrounding countryside.



Anutakiir

Leaving Aasiid one can go south-west to Anutakiir. It is an enjoyable journey. Along the way the road crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *iidaadiiqaaq* trees. As a traveller enters Uliim, the vegetation changes, giving way to hedgerows and thickets of *unaawiirumal* flowers. Hairy *iiyabarux* graze by the fringe of the track.

The traveller, at the gates of monumental Anutakiir, may espy the emerald spire of the iniquitous university of Aašiidišaaq. Despite the fact that from so far it may seem magnificent, the citizens of Anutakiir find its form repellent, and hide from it. Closer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the chimes of the counting-house clock. Ultimately the musk of *iidaadiiqaaq* trees fills the air, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

Close to the barbican of Aan Iišudaay, the boulevards are lined with *unaawiirumal* plants. The ivory figurines which ornament the eaves will be hard to miss to a traveller. These signify the shop of an apothecary. The traveller may typically hear songs of mirthful misery, sung by actors of the Tailors' District. Merchants crowd here, laughing. Should one be so ill-fated as to encounter soldiers talking, it can be a very edifying experience.

Kinnak Usnus to Íslis

Uppíp

A traveller, passing into the vast city of Uppíp, can find mighty *átmán*, beloved for their milk. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the delicate song of the *ásmíl* birds. Eventually the aroma of *tapsín* fruit fills the breeze, and one is truly in Uppíp.

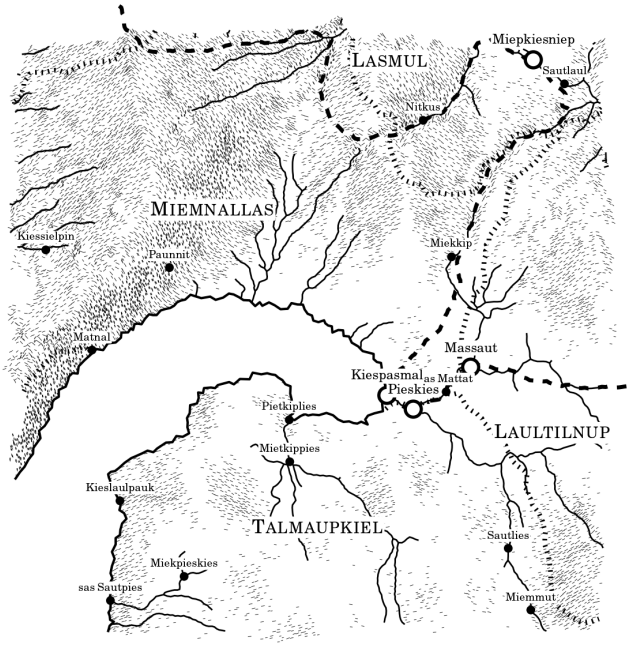
In the Actors' Quarter of the city, the streets are paved with limestone, inlaid with obsidian. The idle rich throng here, practising their skill at the game of *tatkat*. In the late morning, the traveller can often hear the song of the *álmíl* birds, kept by scholars. If one is so unlucky as to come across a herd of horned *átmán*, bred for work by the philosophers of Uppíp, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

ím Ílup

From Uppíp the traveller may journey to ím Ílup. One can see, by the side of the boat, numerous brightly-coloured *ástíp* fish. Although the route is remarkably comfortable, boats are sometimes tormented by gales in this area. The traveller may enjoy a piquant broth made of *íplup* fruit and *mílsil* meat, flavoured with *tanlup* root, as eaten by the fishermen.

Near to the infamous city a traveller may see the jade spires of the gargantuan prison of Puktat. Though at this distance it appear beautiful, people of the city find its bulk obscene, and shun it. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the knell of the fortress clock. Finally the smell of *tapsín* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the temple of Puktan, the squares are lined with *uplup* flowers, and the pleasant scent fills the afternoon wind. In the early evening, one may often hear the clanging of the university clock. Artisans swarm here, praying and singing. A distracted traveller will not notice the *íplup* flowers. These serve to ward off hostile influences. In the event that the traveller is unfortunate enough to see writers telling stories, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.



LASMUL TO LAULTILNUP

Miepkiesniep

On reaching the walls of immense Miepkiesniep a traveller can stumble upon actors, laughing. Nearer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear songs of sorrowful ecstasy, sung by citizens of the city. At last the aroma of *nieppap* trees fills the air, and the traveller is surely in Miepkiesniep.

Near the mint of Nulnip, the streets are lined with *sielpaptulmal* bushes. Artisans flock here, dancing and singing. The caged *laumliesnis* birds will be conspicuous. These commemorate the revolution which not long ago ravaged the New Quarter. A traveller can sometimes hear the peal of the counting-house clock.

Kiespasmal

Leaving Miepkiesniep the traveller can travel north-east to Kiespasmal. The road is long, but rewarding, taking many weeks. At one point the route crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *nieppap* plants. When one enters Miemnallas, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the landscape.

The traveller, passing into the colossal metropolis of Kiespasmal, will come across shaggy *talpiesniet*, prized for their horns. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sweet song of the *nispiek* birds, kept by soldiers. Eventually the musk of *mietniel* trees fills the air, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

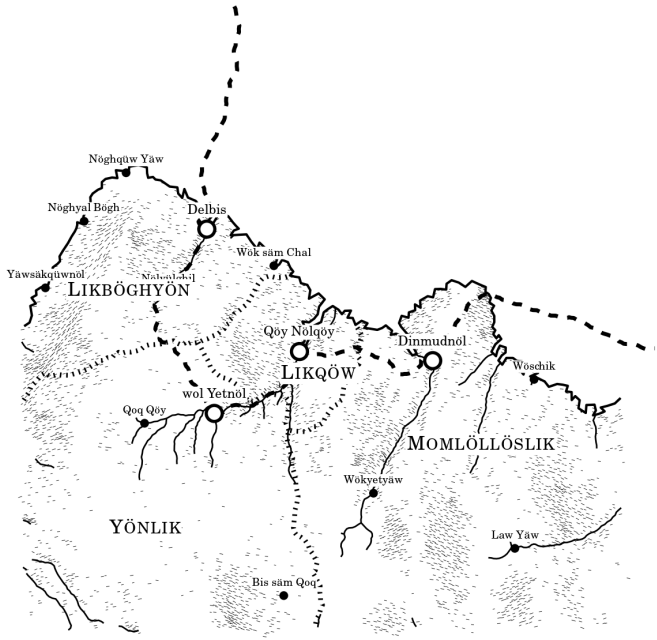
In the Grey District of the city, the back-streets are paved with granite, inlaid with marble. The traveller will take note of the basalt statues that grace the pediments. These denote the home of a smith. In the late night, a traveller can usually hear songs of exuberant melancholy, sung by actors of the city. Should the traveller be blessed enough to catch sight of the famous Liessukpas dance, one may be drawn in, and it may be a few hours before escape is possible.

Pieskies

Onwards from Kiespasmal a traveller may go north-west to Pieskies. The road is busy, and the journey takes but half a day. Near the track, *sielpaptulmal* plants grow. Along the way the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *nielsik* flowers. When the traveller crosses the border into Talmaupkiel, the greenery changes, giving way to meadows and hedgerows.

Near the edge of the city a traveller will catch sight of the marble tower of the vast market-hall of Maulsieskiet. From here, one is unable to make out how the idle rich teem near its doors, trying their luck at the game of *lunlielluttul*. A little closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the tolling of the citadel clock. Ultimately the bouquet of *tatnan* fruit fills the breeze, and one is without a doubt in Pieskies.

In the Artisans' Quarter of the city, the plazas are lined with *sielpaptulmal* bushes. In the event that a traveller is so fortunate as to find a fight between two lovers, it can be three hours before escape is possible. Labourers lounge here, talking. The *musmapnipkik* stone medallions which decorate the rooftops will be easy to see to the traveller. These serve as a relic of the pestilence which long ago engulfed a nearby village. A traveller may occasionally hear the gentle song of the *tielmalmaul* birds, kept by citizens.



Massaut

Onwards from Pieskies one may journey south-west to Massaut. The route is crowded, and the journey takes but half a day. Along the way the track crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *nielmiktal* plants. As the traveller enters Laultilnup, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the countryside. By the edge of the road, *niettitmiemmap* graze.

The traveller, entering the great city of Massaut, can observe the sapphire dome of the colossal castle of Sunpattitkan. Even though at this distance it seems elegant, citizens of Massaut find its bulk distasteful, and avoid it. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear songs of ecstatic dejection, sung by soldiers of Massaut. In the end the perfume of *miektus* trees fills the breeze, and a traveller is undeniably in Massaut.

Close to the palace of Mupmunniep, the alleyways are paved with obsidian, inlaid with sandstone. Should the traveller be unlucky enough to encounter the holy Suklun ritual, one may be drawn in, and unable to leave. A careless observer will overlook the *sikpiespap* trees. These function as a warning to harmful spirits. The traveller may typically hear the sound of the dancing-hall clock.

Likböghyön to Momlöllöslik

Delbis

A traveller, at the outskirts of mighty Delbis, will find crowds of fruit-sellers, hawking their wares. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the balmy song of the *schutchöqlüsdelchal* birds, kept by priests. At last the scent of *yetluylölyülril* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Red District of the city, the streets are lined with *röyghächlis* flowers, and the blue leaves rustle in the early afternoon wind. In the early evening, one can sometimes hear the clanging of the barbican clock. If the traveller is so lucky as to see a game of *delböghghuwqöy*, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. The tame *lüs* birds will be apparent. These act as a deterrent to evil influences. Petty criminals mill here, praying.

wol Yetnöl

Leaving Delbis a traveller can go north to wol Yetnöl. *Qotdüschöqnöwlaq* graze on the roadside. At one point the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *qöymöqyönchew* bushes. As one crosses the border into Yönlik, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the terrain.

On entering the iniquitous city a traveller can discern the tremendous bastion of Molchul. From here, the traveller is unable to catch sight of how the idle rich stay away from it, laughing and singing. Nearer to the centre of the city, one will hear songs of heavy-hearted bliss, sung by farmers of the Old Quarter. Eventually the musk of *röyghächlis* trees fills the air, and a traveller is surely in wol Yetnöl.

In the vicinity of the citadel, the alleyways are paved with granite, inlaid with *düykeghdüslaqyal* stone. In the late morning, the traveller may usually hear songs of melancholy joy, sung by soldiers of the city. One will notice the bronze figures that adorn the pediments. These call to mind the revolution which recently devastated a nearby village.

Qöy Nölqöy

Onwards from wol Yetnöl a traveller may journey to Qöy Nölqöy. At one point the road crosses a broad valley. When the traveller enters Likqöw, the foliage changes, giving way to wild *qöymöqyönchew* plants and open fields. Near the route, *yönmöqchab* flowers grow.

A traveller, on reaching the gates of the metropolis of Qöy Nölqöy, may stumble upon actors, telling stories and dancing. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the song of the *lüs* birds. In the end the scent of *yetluylölyülril* fruit fills the wind, and one has undeniably arrived.

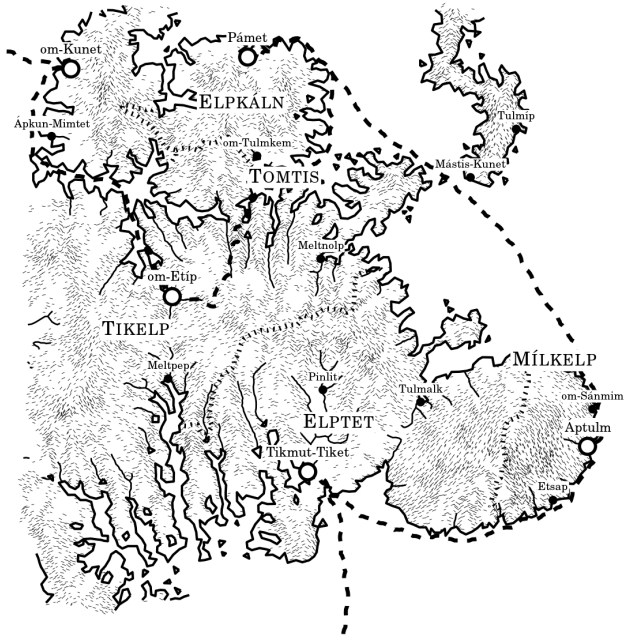
In the Goldsmiths' District of the city, the back-streets are lined with *röyghächlis* bushes, and the sweet aroma fills the early afternoon breeze. The traveller can typically hear the chimes of the castle clock. The idle rich congregate here, laughing. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to encounter an argument between two lovers, it may be a most instructive experience. The *qäkmüychämnäkchul* plants will be clear to the traveller. These mark the workplace of a fortune-teller.

Dinmudnöl

From Qöy Nölqöy one can travel west to Dinmudnöl. It is a pleasant journey. *Yäwchulyönqotnin* graze by the bank of the track. As the traveller crosses into Momlöllöslik, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and scrubland.

At the edge of the infamous city one will see the emerald vaulted roof of the monumental market-hall of Molsatdüs. Though from so far it may seem enchanting, the natives of the city find its architecture unsavoury, and steer clear of it. A little nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear songs of mirthful sadness, sung by scholars of Dinmudnöl. Finally the smell of *nolghäch* trees fills the air, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Near the temple of Yön säm Yäw, the roadways are paved with obsidian. One may often hear the bells of the prison clock. Priests mill here, trying their luck on the *rolboy* tables.



TOMTIS TO ELPTET

om-Kunet

Outside the immense city of om-Kunet the traveller can espy the chryselephantine clock-tower of the famed mint of Om-Kálnaln. From here, one has no way to discern how actors flock by it, praying. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *mílpas* birds, kept by merchants. Eventually the musk of *elnnos* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is surely in om-Kunet.

In the Temple District of the city, the squares are lined with *lélkkam* flowers. If one is so fortunate as to catch sight of the idle rich dancing, the traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. An inattentive traveller will miss the marble figurines which ornament the balustrades. These are a memento of the sickness which not long ago ravaged the surrounding countryside. The bourgeoisie lounge here, practising their skill at the game of *litnalm*.

One can usually hear songs of elegiac exuberance, sung by soldiers of the city.

om-Etíp

From om-Kunet a traveller may go to om-Etíp. Many craft sail these waters, so a traveller can sometimes charter a small trading vessel. Despite the bad weather conditions which torment ships in these waters, the crossing is easy. Near the boat there are often great numbers of *alknelm* fish. Both crew and passengers subsist on a soup made of *nelmpep* fish and seaweed, spiced with *pámlélk* berries. The nutty taste is enchanting.

The traveller, passing into famous om-Etíp, can stumble upon horned *ínsit*, bred for racing by the scholars of om-Etíp. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the knell of the counting-house clock. In the end the fragrance of *kamlélk* bushes fills the breeze, and a traveller is undeniably in om-Etíp.

Around the theatre of Alnpep, the streets are paved with stone, inlaid with ivory. In the event that the traveller is ill-fated enough to see a game of *kunnalm*, it can be a few hours before escape is possible. In the late morning, the traveller may occasionally hear the balmy song of the *késuk* birds.

Pámet

Onwards from om-Etíp one can travel south to Pámet. The route is busy, and a traveller can often charter a fishing boat. Storms occasionally plague boats in these waters, but the crossing is safe. The land's edge *askun* birds may sometimes be observed, circling overhead. The traveller will enjoy salted *mílpas* bird meat, garnished with *millélk* leaves, as eaten by the sailors. The taste is sour, but sweet.

A traveller, nearing the outskirts of the tremendous metropolis of Pámet, will find merchants, talking and dancing. A little nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of mournful pleasure, sung by actors of the Tailors' Quarter. Finally the perfume of *ilptet* fruit fills the air, and one has without a doubt arrived.

In the Artisans' Quarter of the city, the alleyways are lined with *lélkmílp* plants, and the yellow blossoms whisper in the wind. In the evening, the traveller can often hear the sound of the citadel clock. The *peplélk* trees will be conspicuous to one. These indicate the place of business of a doctor.

Áptulm

Leaving Pámet a traveller may journey to Áptulm. As this route is busy, the traveller can typically obtain passage on a small vessel. Both fishermen and passengers eat a thin stew made of turtle meat and *alkam* meat, garnished with *pámlélk* seed. The flavour is rich, but nutty, mingling with the salty air. In the water nearby shoals of iridescent *nelmpep* fish can usually be spotted, leaping from wave to wave. The shore seabirds may occasionally be observed, riding the breeze.

Near to the mighty city one may observe the celebrated watch-tower of Tilktik. While from such a large distance it looks elegant, the citizens of Áptulm find its form disagreeable, and hide from it. Somewhat closer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the song of the *késuk* birds, kept by philosophers. Ultimately the aroma of *tikmelp* flowers fills the wind, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

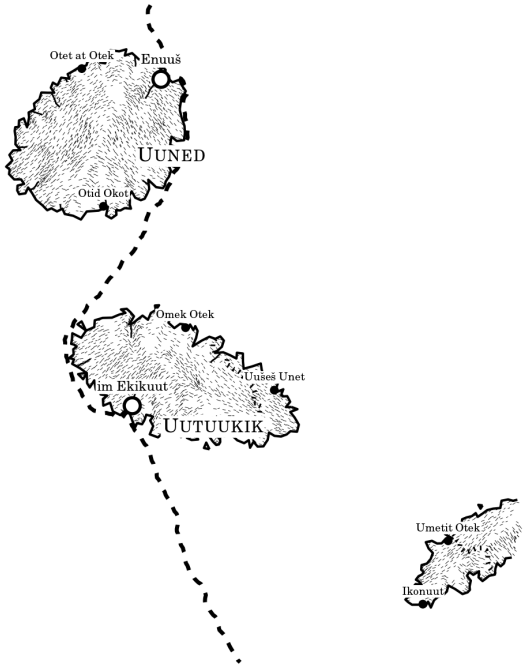
Near the market-hall of Nésaln, the squares are paved with *molnsit* stone, inlaid with lead. If the traveller is so lucky as to catch sight of a herd of hairy *ínsit*, the national animal of Mílkelp, it can be a humbling experience. In the early night, a traveller may usually hear songs of ebullient misery, sung by petty criminals of a nearby village.

Tikmut-Tiket

Onwards from Áptulm one can go to Tikmut-Tiket. The traveller can sometimes find space on a small ship. Although the crossing is surprisingly pleasant, vessels are typically plagued by gales near here. A traveller may see flocks of *ammim* birds the coast. The traveller may enjoy dried *nelmpep* fish, as eaten by sailors and passengers alike. The clean taste is delicious, enriched by the salty air.

The traveller, near the walls of monstrous Tikmut-Tiket, may come across scattered hawkers, setting out their stalls. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the tolling of the barbican clock. Eventually the smell of *ilptet* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is surely in Tikmut-Tiket.

In the Ancient District of the city, the boulevards are lined with *mutmelp* plants, and the delicate aroma fills the morning air. One will see the caged *alkam* birds. These repel hostile spirits. In the evening, the traveller can often hear the gentle song of the *asnés* birds, kept by farmers. Actors teem here, praying.

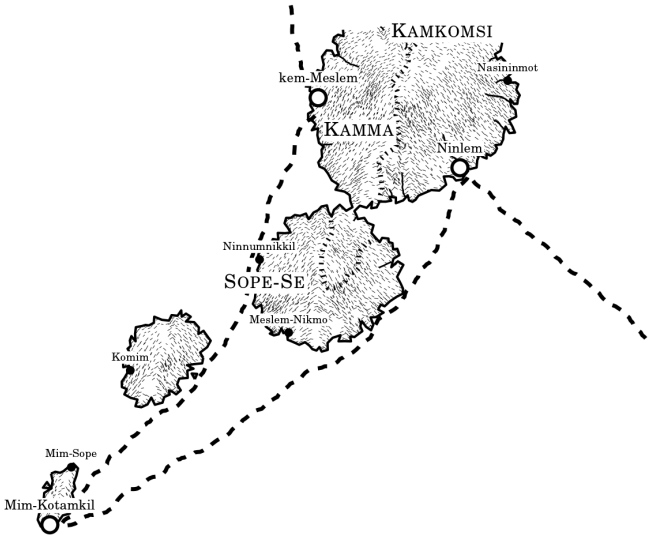


UUNED TO UUTUUKIK

Enuuš

On entering the gargantuan city of Enuuš a traveller will discern the monumental castle of Agam Enam. From so far, one cannot make out how artisans gather around its silver door. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the chimes of the counting-house clock. Ultimately the scent of *esiš* trees fills the wind, and the traveller has truly arrived.

Close to the barbican of Utuudum Unet, the streets are paved with sandstone, inlaid with stone. Priests cluster here, showing off on the *iduugod* court. Should a traveller be blessed enough to find merchants dancing, one may be drawn in, and find it almost impossible to escape. The traveller may usually hear songs of blissful dejection, sung by citizens of the city. The *ešakiš* bushes will be obvious to one. These signify the home of a smith.



im Ekikuut

From Enuuš a traveller may go to im Ekikuut. Many ships traffic these waters, so one can often obtain passage on a trading boat. *Ešošas* fish may usually be seen by the side of the boat, barely visible beneath the surface. Seabirds can occasionally be spotted the shore, diving for *ogošog* fish.

A traveller, on reaching the edge of the monstrous city, will stumble upon a series of silversmiths, setting out their stalls. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of doleful joy, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. At last the perfume of *ukiguut* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is without a doubt in im Ekikuut.

In the Red District of the city, the back-streets are lined with *etadem* plants, and the pleasant smell fills the afternoon breeze. The ivory statues that grace the doorways will be clear to a traveller. These are in memory of the war which in times past troubled the city. If one is so lucky as to see a quarrel between two lovers, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Kamma to Kamkomsi

kem-Meslem

Passing into famed kem-Meslem a traveller may catch sight of the ivory spire of the famous palace of Nasallakki. While at this distance it may seem quaint, the people of the city find its architecture obscene, and avoid it. Nearer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear the sweet song of the *moninmekampu* birds, kept by soldiers. Finally the fragrance of *tepopinasi* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller has truly arrived.

In the Green Quarter, the squares are paved with granite, inlaid with sandstone. An inattentive visitor will overlook the caged *pu* birds. These warn off malign influences. In the late morning, one can typically hear the striking of the watchtower clock. Petty criminals crowd here, talking and praying.

Mim-Kotamkil

Leaving kem-Meslem a traveller can travel north-east to Mim-Kotamkil. The traveller can often charter a trading vessel. The route is remarkably easy, notwithstanding the stormy weather conditions. Crew and passengers alike snack on a piquant stew made of seaweed and *laklokkulakke* bird meat, flavoured with *kis* root. The meaty flavour is delicious, mingling with the salty air. One can hear flocks of *moninmekampu* birds the land's edge, circling overhead.

The traveller, approaching the walls of the city of Mim-Kotamkil, may come across *kusutmokepmo*, valued for their milk. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of merry melancholy, sung by actors of the Temple Quarter. In the end the scent of *konnatikam* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is beyond doubt in Mim-Kotamkil.

In the vicinity of the bastion of Sutpatsokse, the plazas are paved with bronze, inlaid with marble. The *kis* flowers will be tricky to miss to one. These indicate the shop of a fortune-teller. Should the traveller be fortunate enough to encounter scholars talking, a traveller might be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape.

Ninlem

Leaving Mim-Kotamkil one can journey south-west to Ninlem. The traveller can usually obtain passage on a small fishing boat. One will enjoy boiled *ninpom* fish, as eaten by the sailors. The taste is rich, but sour, enriched by the salty air. A traveller can sometimes see jet-black *meknummetpomem* fish near the boat, darting through the water. The coast flocks of seabirds may occasionally be seen, riding the air. Even with the gales which often trouble craft, the route is quite pleasant.

Outside the tremendous city the traveller will espy the ruby roof of the immense theatre of Pamuktam. From so far, one is unable to observe how criminals shun it, showing off on the *mispem* board. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the delicate song of the *sutpusu* birds, kept by artisans. Ultimately the perfume of *kis* plants fills the wind, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

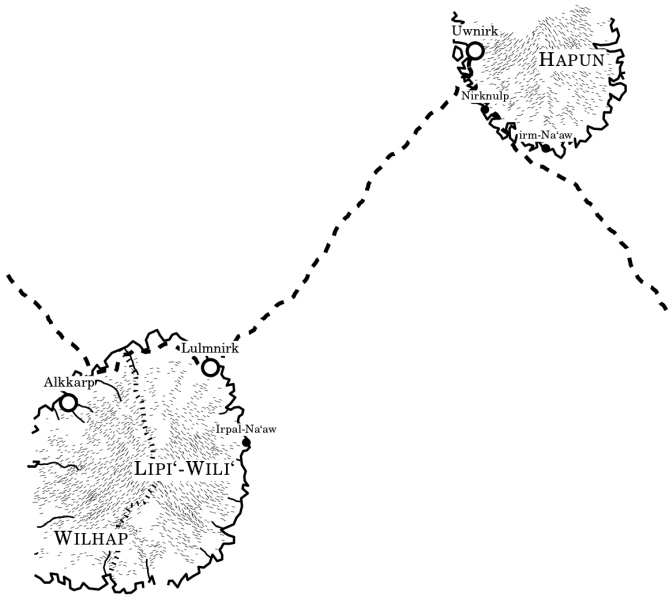
In the vicinity of the barbican of Salmona, the squares are lined with *tepopinasi* trees, and the red petals whisper in the air. Scholars gather here, dancing. One will be humbled by the granite carvings that adorn the rooftops. These serve as a caution to unwanted spirits. In the late night, a traveller may typically hear songs of desolate bliss, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. In the event that one is so unfortunate as to catch sight of a game of *numnestam*, it may be a very instructive experience.

Wilhap to Hapun

Alkkarp

A traveller, nearing the outskirts of Alkkarp, can come across *narhuw*, bred for show by the actors of a nearby village. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the pleasant song of the *murkap* birds, kept by merchants. At last the bouquet of *pa'nirw* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller is undoubtedly in Alkkarp.

In the New District, the roadways are paved with lead. If the traveller is so blessed as to find the revered Unha' dance, it can be a couple of hours before escape is possible. A traveller can sometimes hear the knell of the market-hall clock. The bourgeoisie mill here, telling stories and laughing.

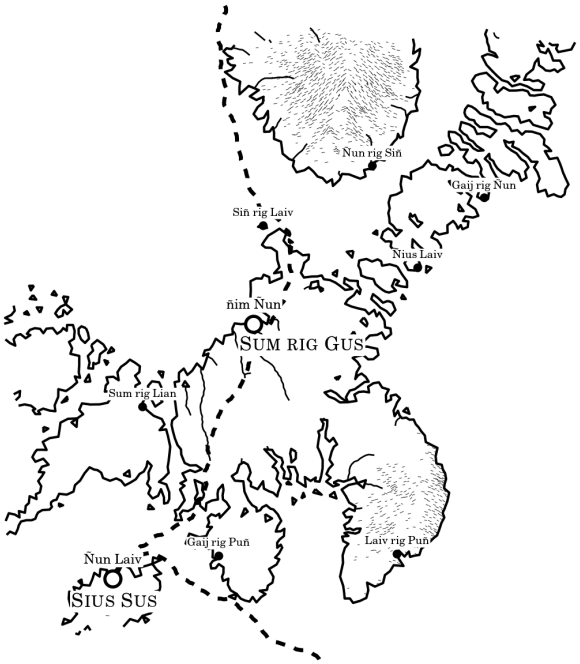


Lulmnirk

Onwards from Alkkarp the traveller may go west to Lulmnirk. It is an agreeable journey. *Inup* bushes grow on the roadside. When one enters Lipi'-Wili', there is a change in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls over the landscape. Along the way the route crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *akurm* flowers.

Entering the infamous city a traveller can see the jade lookout of the monumental mint of Arwkarp. Despite the fact that from here it may appear beautiful, citizens of Lulmnirk find its form repellent, and steer clear of it. A little nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will hear songs of mirthful gloom, sung by labourers of the city. In the end the aroma of *inarp* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

Around the barbican of Karparw, the back-streets are lined with *ina'* trees, and the emerald leaves sway in the early morning air. Farmers teem here, trying their luck at the game of *kak'u'*. The tame *apmurk* birds will be obvious to the traveller. These denote the workplace of an apothecary. A traveller may often hear the tolling of the citadel clock.



Uwnirk

From Lulmnirk one can journey south-west to Uwnirk. In this area, squalls usually beset boats, but the crossing is very comfortable. Fishermen and passengers alike eat a broth made of *'anun* bird meat and turtle meat, spiced with *ina'* flowers. Off the sides there are occasionally numerous fish, barely visible beneath the surface.

The traveller, approaching the gates of the metropolis of Uwnirk, will encounter crowds of pedlars, hawking their wares. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of melancholy exuberance, sung by artisans of the Merchants' Quarter. Ultimately the perfume of *a"irk* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Uwnirk.

In the Artisans' District, the roadways are paved with ivory, inlaid with stone. The bourgeoisie lounge here, talking. Should a traveller be charmed enough to stumble upon a herd of hairy *irhnulp*, the national animal of Hapun, the traveller may be drawn in, and it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the early afternoon, a traveller can often hear the gentle song of the *murkap* birds, kept by citizens.

SUM RIG GUS TO SIUS SUS

ñim Ñun

Outside great ñim Ñun one will catch sight of the marble dome of the gargantuan market-hall of Juas rig Vul. Even though from such a great distance it may look enchanting, the denizens of the city find its bulk unsavoury, and stay away from it. Nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the striking of the dancing-hall clock. Finally the smell of *las* bushes fills the wind, and a traveller has truly arrived.

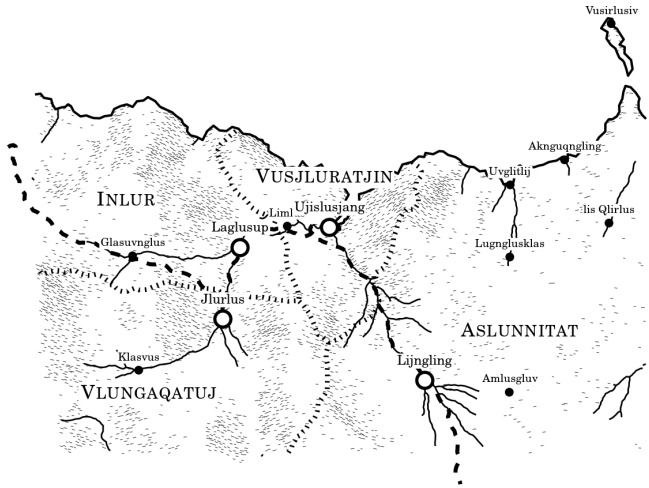
Close to the theatre of Ñim Juas, the boulevards are lined with *ñaun* flowers, and the balmy perfume fills the night air. In the late morning, one may typically hear the sweet song of the *lauj* birds, kept by merchants. If the traveller is unfortunate enough to see a game of *sun*, it can be a most edifying experience. Artisans crowd here, praying.

Ñun Laiv

Leaving ñim Ñun a traveller may travel to Ñun Laiv. By the track, *mum* graze. At one point the road crosses a broad depression, spotted with *ñaun* plants. As one crosses the border into Sius Sus, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the land.

A traveller, nearing the gates of the vast city, may find writers, talking and dancing. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of ecstatic dejection, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. At last the bouquet of *ñiuv* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Old Quarter of the city, the alleyways are paved with bronze. In the evening, one can sometimes hear the clanging of the prison clock. A distracted visitor will fail to see the lead medallions which decorate the eaves. These act as a reminder of the pestilence which twenty years ago beset a nearby village. The idle rich congregate here, laughing and telling stories.



Vlungaqatuj to Aslunnitat

Jlurlus

Entering tremendous Jlurlus the traveller may make out the celebrated castle of Nitpipuj. From so far, a traveller has no way to observe how scholars flock near it. Nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear songs of sombre bliss, sung by labourers of the city. Ultimately the fragrance of *klutlang* trees fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Jlurlus.

In the vicinity of the bastion, the plazas are lined with *amlugamjlik* flowers, and the yellow petals shimmer in the late afternoon breeze. In the evening, a traveller may occasionally hear the delicate song of the *slusamliggluv* birds, kept by writers. The tame *slitanslitngluslig* birds will be conspicuous to one. These serve as a warning to malign spirits. Citizens lounge here, dancing.

Laglusup

Onwards from Jlurlus one may go south to Laglusup. The route is busy, and the journey takes but an afternoon. When the traveller enters Inlur, the vegetation changes, giving way to hedgerows and wild *luvataj* plants. Near the side of the road, *qaplulsunsunnlap* bushes grow.

The traveller, at the edge of the city, can catch sight of actors, laughing and singing. Closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the chimes of the university clock. Finally the musk of *mlivslutlakag* fruit fills the air, and one has surely arrived.

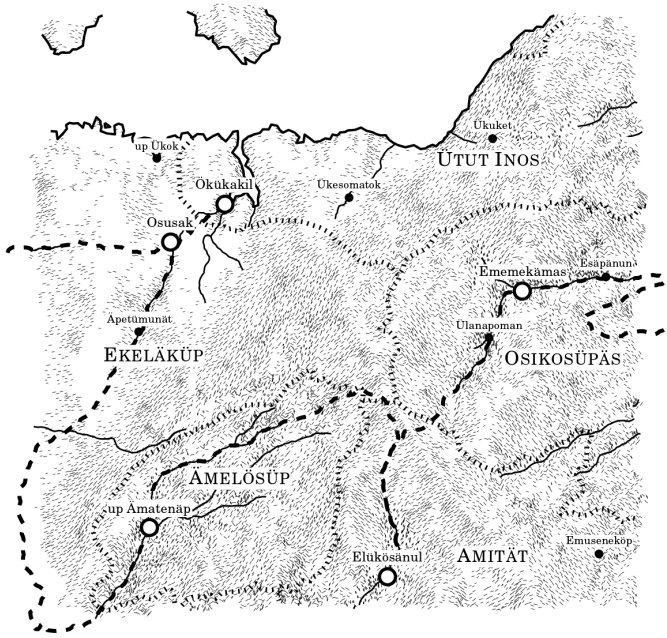
In the Goldsmiths' District of the city, the streets are lined with *glurklut* flowers, and the pleasant smell fills the early morning wind. The traveller can often hear the song of the *ngisslusag* birds, kept by labourers. A traveller will see the caged *slusluglas* birds. These betoken the shop of a smith. The bourgeoisie throng here, practising their skill at the game of *nglusnitgluvgapmut*. Should one be so ill-fated as to encounter petty criminals telling stories, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Ujislusjang

Leaving Laglusup the traveller can travel to Ujislusjang. It is a delightful journey. Along the way the track crosses a deep gully, spotted with *amlugamjlik* plants. Shaggy *qlajagtlagklukvin* graze on the road. As a traveller crosses the border into Vusjluratjin, the greenery changes, giving way to clumps of *glaninulmut* trees and open fields.

Near to the city of Ujislusjang the traveller can catch sight of the diamond roof of the mighty barbican of Likpipup. From here, one cannot espy how priests hide from it. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one will hear the peal of the dancing-hall clock. At last the perfume of *qaplulsunsunnlap* bushes fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Ujislusjang.

In the Temple District of the city, the plazas are paved with granite, inlaid with ivory. In the event that the traveller is unlucky enough to stumble upon a squabble between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the afternoon, a traveller may typically hear songs of blissful sadness, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. A careless observer will not notice the basalt figures that ornament the archways. These act to ward off harmful influences. Artisans teem here, practising their skill on the *nglusnitgluvgapmut* field.



Lijngling

From Ujislusjang one can journey north-west to Lijngling. It is a pleasant journey. When a traveller enters Aslunnitat, there is a change in the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the land. By the route, *urglitlunngluslul* trees grow. At one point the track crosses a broad valley, spotted with *jlikplij* bushes.

A traveller, near the walls of gargantuan Lijngling, will see *glanlas*, the sacred animal of Aslunnitat. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of dirgeful delight, sung by writers of the Ancient Quarter. Eventually the bouquet of *mlivslutlakag* fruit fills the wind, and one has undeniably arrived.

Near the temple of Liglamlim, the squares are paved with marble, inlaid with sandstone. The *amlugamjlik* flowers will be apparent to the traveller. These signify the place of business of a doctor. If a traveller is so blessed as to stumble upon the sacred Slitunisuj procession, the traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

EKELÄKÜP TO OSIKOSÜPÄS

Osusak

The traveller, approaching the outskirts of the monstrous city of Osusak, will see the bone-white tower of the famed palace of Akipapüs. Though at this distance it seems quaint, the natives of Osusak find its architecture distasteful, and stay away from it. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the sound of the theatre clock. Ultimately the fragrance of *ananis* trees fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Osusak.

In the Artisans' District of the city, the back-streets are lined with *inökis* plants, and the blue leaves rustle in the late night air. A traveller can usually hear the song of the *epötäm* birds, kept by citizens. One will take note of the obsidian medallions which decorate the doorways. These are a memento of the war which not long ago engulfed a nearby village.

Ökükakil

Onwards from Osusak the traveller may go south-west to Ökükakil. The road is well-trodden, and the journey takes but two hours. As one crosses the border into Ütut Inos, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the countryside. Horned *ünosop* graze on the roadside. At one point the route crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *üton* plants.

Passing into celebrated Ökükakil a traveller will see scattered fishmongers, setting out their stalls. A little nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of gleeful melancholy, sung by actors of the surrounding countryside. At last the bouquet of *unolumülät* fruit fills the breeze, and one is surely in Ökükakil.

Around the mint of Alas Alulak, the roadways are lined with *üton* trees, and the balmy scent fills the early evening wind. In the event that the traveller is so lucky as to find a game of *öpüm*, it may be an educational experience. In the late night, one can sometimes hear the knell of the fortress clock. Petty criminals swarm here, praying. The tame *epötäm* birds will be easy to see. These mark the home of an artisan.

up Ämatenäp

From Ökükakil a traveller can journey north to up Ämatenäp. *Öpis* flowers grow near the roadside. Along the way the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *ananis* bushes. When the traveller enters Ämelösüp, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and meadows.

Nearing the walls of the vast metropolis of up Ämatenäp a traveller may discern the gleaming towers of the great bastion of Alulak Inos. From here, one has no way to observe how philosophers flock around its copper doors. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the delicate song of the *elukepäköp* birds, kept by farmers. In the end the perfume of *ananis* flowers fills the air, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Tailors' Quarter, the boulevards are paved with *äkolosös* stone, inlaid with bronze. Actors crowd here, dancing and telling stories. In the early morning, one may often hear the bells of the barbican clock. Should a traveller be ill-fated enough to encounter a herd of mighty *ütop*, beloved for their leather, the traveller may be drawn in, and it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Elükösänul

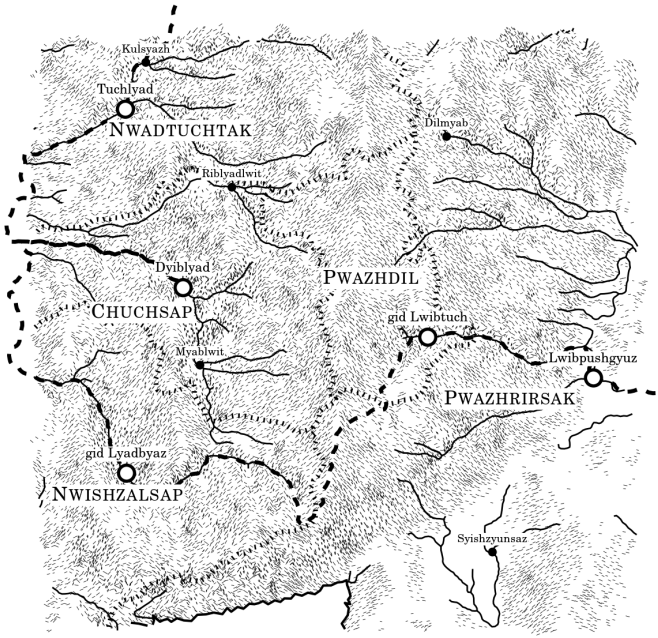
Leaving up Ämatenäp one may travel west to Elükösänul. At one point the road crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *akütäkätis* trees. As the traveller crosses into Amität, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the terrain.

A traveller, entering the city, may catch sight of hairy *ünosop*, prized for their meat. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of heavy-hearted glee, sung by priests of Elükösänul. Finally the aroma of *okülötakom* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

Near the market-hall of Ütalut, the squares are lined with *üton* plants, and the gentle musk fills the late night air. A hasty traveller will miss the *öpis* bushes. These act as a caution to evil spirits. One can usually hear the balmy song of the *epöm* birds, kept by writers.

Ememekämas

Onwards from Elükösänul one can journey south-west to Ememekämas. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking two days. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *änukon* flowers. When the traveller enters Osikosüpäs, the vegetation changes,



giving way to *ekanänöpon* plants and hedgerows. On the route, *onosömapat* trees grow.

At the edge of famed Ememekämas a traveller can espy the golden spires of the mighty palace of Up Alulak. Even though from so far it may look alluring, denizens of the city find its bulk repellent, and shun it. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the peal of the prison clock. At last the aroma of *änukon* flowers fills the breeze, and a traveller is truly in Ememekämas.

In the Merchants' District of the city, the alleyways are paved with granite, inlaid with limestone. In the early evening, the traveller may typically hear songs of mournful exuberance, sung by artisans of the surrounding countryside. If one is so unfortunate as to find the bourgeoisie singing, it can be a humbling experience. Merchants gather here, showing off at the game of *ümöpäl*. The caged *epötäm* birds will be hard to miss. These commemorate the revolution which long ago devastated the city.

Nwadtuchtak to Pwazhrirsak

Tuchlyad

The traveller, outside the celebrated city of Tuchlyad, will come across a series of silversmiths, hawking their wares. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sweet song of the *chibchuchmyalchat* birds, kept by soldiers. Ultimately the bouquet of *zwupmirtak* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

Around the citadel of Chwuchrach, the roadways are lined with *ryappwissimchib* bushes. In the afternoon, one may often hear songs of joyous gloom, sung by labourers of the New Quarter. In the event that the traveller is unlucky enough to see a herd of mighty *tablyumlwudbyash*, the sacred animal of Nwadtuchtak, it can be three hours before escape is possible.

Dyiblyad

From Tuchlyad a traveller may go to Dyiblyad. It is a simple journey. At one point the road crosses a deep gorge. *Swutchwuchlyum* graze by the bank of the road.

Nearing the outskirts of the famous metropolis one will make out the ruby dome of the gargantuan castle of Lyagrach. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the song of the *mwibzyunmyal* birds, kept by farmers. Finally the smell of *kichzwup* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Dyiblyad.

In the Green District, the squares are paved with sandstone, inlaid with marble. The idle rich lounge here, dancing and laughing. Should one be so unfortunate as to catch sight of a game of *lwudswal*, a traveller might be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape. The traveller can sometimes hear the chimes of the temple clock. The ivory carvings that adorn the eaves will be clear to one. These serve to warn off unwanted spirits.

gid Lyadbyaz

Leaving Dyiblyad a traveller can travel to gid Lyadbyaz. It is a smooth journey. When the traveller crosses the border into Nwishzal-

sap, the vegetation changes, giving way to scrubland and woods of *nwishmarchibnib* trees. Near the track, *tuchchik* graze. Along the way the route crosses a broad rift.

A traveller, on entering monumental gid Lyadbyaz, can find writers, telling stories. Nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of elegiac ecstasy, sung by actors of gid Lyadbyaz. Eventually the perfume of *ryappwissimchib* bushes fills the breeze, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

Close to the university of Tublazhtazh, the alleyways are lined with *ryappwissimchib* plants. In the early evening, the traveller may occasionally hear songs of ecstatic misery, sung by philosophers of the surrounding countryside. Artisans swarm here, singing and laughing.

gid Lwibtuch

Onwards from gid Lyadbyaz a traveller may travel south-west to gid Lwibtuch. Along the way the route crosses a deep gully, spotted with *marmwibsaz* flowers. As one enters Pwazhdil, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls across the land. *Markwas* trees grow on the roadside.

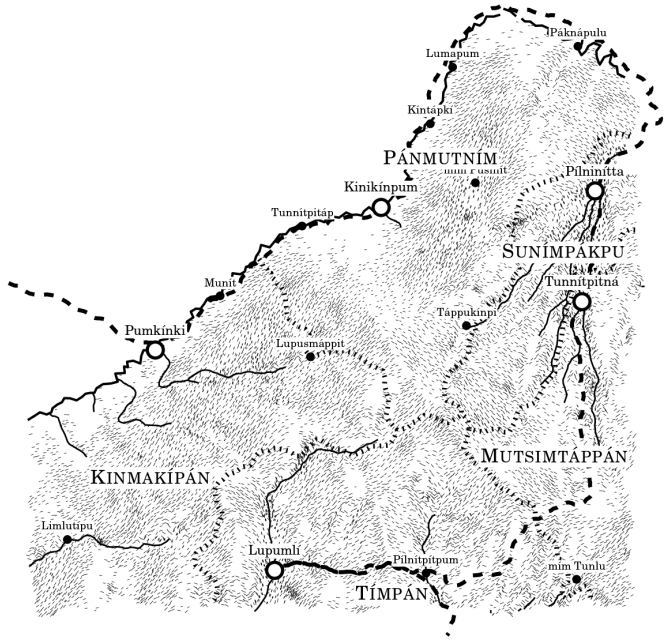
Passing into the city a traveller may stumble upon hairy *tuchchik*, bred for work by the labourers of a nearby village. Nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *chibchuchmyalchat* birds, kept by farmers. Finally the scent of *takzwupsaz* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in gid Lwibtuch.

In the Grey Quarter of the city, the plazas are paved with basalt. In the late morning, a traveller can usually hear the balmy song of the *dilshat* birds, kept by soldiers. If the traveller is blessed enough to see a game of *mwazhdyib*, it may be a very educational experience. One will be inspired by the *nwishmarchibnib* bushes. These indicate the workplace of a fortune-teller.

Lwibpushgyuz

Leaving gid Lwibtuch the traveller can journey to Lwibpushgyuz. It is an enjoyable journey. At one point the track crosses a broad valley. By the side of the road, *martuchtachkwish* plants grow. When a traveller crosses the border into Pwazhrirsak, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and wild *takmwibmar* bushes.

The traveller, near the gates of the immense city of Lwibpushgyuz, may discern the tremendous market-hall of Rachswutpush. From such a great distance, one is unable to espy how scholars



steer clear of it, trying their luck on the *sippush* court. Closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear songs of ebullient dejection, sung by petty criminals of the city. Ultimately the aroma of *marmwibsaz* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the temple of Zyunlazh, the streets are lined with *takmwibmar* trees, and the emerald blossoms whisper in the night wind. In the event that a traveller is so fortunate as to catch sight of a herd of *swutchwuchlyum*, beloved for their milk, it can be a most instructive experience. An inattentive observer will overlook the marble columns which ornament the walls. These deter harmful influences. In the afternoon, one may typically hear the sweet song of the *chibchuchmyalchat* birds.

KINMAKÍPÁN TO TÍMPÁN

Pumkínki

A traveller, entering the city, will catch sight of the granite lookout of the monstrous bastion of Sipák. Although from so far it appear

enchanting, citizens of Pumkínki find its form unsavoury, and stay away from it. Nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of sorrowful joy, sung by writers of Pumkínki. At last the perfume of *mapímlala* plants fills the wind, and a traveller is surely in Pumkínki.

In the Temple District of the city, the squares are lined with *máptítsikpit* flowers, and the delicate blossoms shimmer in the air. Priests mill here, laughing and talking. In the early evening, one can often hear the striking of the watchtower clock. The caged *tánni* birds will be obvious to one. These function as a reminder of the plague which recently tormented the surrounding countryside. Should a traveller be charmed enough to find a fight between two lovers, the traveller may be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Kinikínpum

From Pumkínki one can go south-west to Kinikínpum. As the traveller enters Pánmutním, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls upon the terrain. Horned *látpámpákpup* graze on the route. At one point the track crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *títsat* bushes.

At the walls of gargantuan Kinikínpum a traveller can come across scattered merchants, setting out their stalls. Somewhat closer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear the pleasant song of the *límpám* birds. In the end the fragrance of *páklakukin* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

Around the theatre of Kumpussimá, the plazas are paved with *sákkití* stone, inlaid with stone. If a traveller is blessed enough to encounter a quarrel between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. One will take note of the *títsat* trees. These signify the place of business of a doctor. In the morning, a traveller may usually hear songs of doleful exuberance, sung by soldiers of Kinikínpum. Citizens teem here, telling stories.

Pílninítta

Onwards from Kinikínpum one may journey west to Pílninítta. The traveller can occasionally find space on a vessel. A traveller can sometimes see, in the water nearby, turquoise fish, leaping from wave to wave. The route is surprisingly safe, in spite of the gales. One may enjoy braised *típimpus* fish, garnished with *máptítsikpit* root, as eaten by both crew and passengers. The land's edge, a traveller may see flocks of *tántímmutpit* birds, diving for *pimkinmakum* fish.

On entering the city of Pílninítta a traveller will discern the diamond roof of the colossal market-hall of Pitsispílpit. Though from here it may appear magnificent, the people of the city find its architecture obscene, and hide from it. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear the tolling of the temple clock. Eventually the musk of *máptítsikpit* plants fills the wind, and the traveller is truly in Pílninítta.

In the Goldsmiths' Quarter of the city, the back-streets are lined with *mapímlala* flowers, and the delicate smell fills the late night breeze. In the event that one is so lucky as to see actors praying, it may be a very humbling experience. Scholars lounge here, dancing. A traveller can often hear songs of exuberant melancholy, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside.

Tunnítpitná

From Pílninítta the traveller may travel north to Tunnítpitná. It is a simple journey. Along the way the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *títsat* trees. Near the fringe of the road, shaggy *támláttís* graze. As one crosses into Mutsimtáppán, there is a change in the light, and a golden cast falls over the landscape.

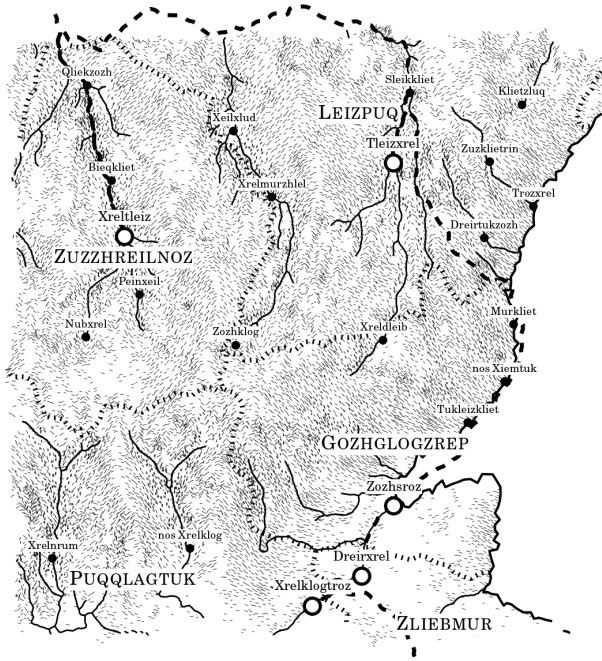
The traveller, approaching the edge of the metropolis, can encounter *puppus*, the national animal of Mutsimtáppán. A little closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the balmy song of the *tastánmamtím* birds, kept by petty criminals. Finally the scent of *páklakukin* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

Close to the counting-house, the alleyways are paved with ivory, inlaid with lead. Writers crowd here, trying their luck on the *pinisín* tables. If one is unfortunate enough to see the intricate Látnamuspi parade, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Lupumlí

Leaving Tunnítpitná the traveller can journey north-east to Lupumlí. The route is long, but rewarding, taking three weeks. When a traveller enters Tímpán, the greenery changes, giving way to pastures and scrubland. At one point the track crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *títsat* bushes.

A traveller, nearing the gates of vast Lupumlí, may see the limestone dome of the iniquitous dancing-hall of Mampun. At this distance, one is unable to make out how merchants throng by it. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will hear



the bells of the university clock. Finally the smell of *mapímlala* flowers fills the air, and one is beyond doubt in Lupumlí.

Around the bastion of Nipitsismí, the roadways are lined with *kínupímmás* plants. In the early evening, a traveller may usually hear songs of sombre pleasure, sung by actors of the city. The tame *tánni* birds will be apparent to the traveller. These betoken the shop of a smith.

ZUZZHREILNOZ TO PUQQLAGTUK

Xreltleiz

Entering the city a traveller may encounter the bourgeoisie, singing. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear the gentle song of the *peinnlespeiszhed* birds, kept by philosophers. In the end the perfume of *lirzuzpein* bushes fills the breeze, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Old District of the city, the streets are paved with stone, inlaid with *koxproszaum* stone. Should a traveller be so unlucky as to stumble upon a herd of shaggy *soqplotqraun*, bred for racing by

the the idle rich of Xreltleiz, the traveller might be drawn in, and it may be a few hours before escape is possible. Scholars congregate here, showing off at the game of *zienleiz*.

Tleizxrel

Onwards from Xreltleiz one may travel west to Tleizxrel. The road is arduous, but scenic, taking many days. As one enters Leizpuq, the vegetation changes, giving way to hedgerows and wild *nrumtukkoxgieg* trees. *Giegmlak* bushes grow on the roadside.

The traveller, on reaching the outskirts of the famous city of Tleizxrel, will espy the colossal mint of Loqxlud. While from here it may seem beautiful, the natives of Tleizxrel find its bulk distasteful, and shun it. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the clanging of the citadel clock. Eventually the aroma of *qizhpirgokzhlel* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has surely arrived.

In the vicinity of the castle of Zhreilloqxoz, the boulevards are lined with *nlotgieg* trees, and the yellow petals rustle in the late night air. Artisans cluster here, practising their skill at *zeikbuzzlebpir*. A distracted traveller will fail to see the *nrumtukkoxgieg* plants. These call to mind the pestilence which twenty years ago ravaged the Blue Quarter. In the event that one is charmed enough to find a game of *tukzien*, it may be a most educational experience. A traveller can typically hear the song of the *zagsoqklogqred* birds, kept by citizens.

Zozhsroz

Leaving Tleizxrel the traveller can go north to Zozhsroz. As the crossing is well-traficked, a traveller can sometimes obtain passage on a small ship. Near the side of the boat there are usually brightly-coloured *xozzuszleb* fish, bobbing and weaving in unison. The shore flocks of seabirds can typically be observed, riding the air. The fishermen snack on a soup made of *nlotgieg* fruit and turtle meat, flavoured with *tloqnod* leaves. The bitter flavour is tasty. Vessels are occasionally tormented by storms near here, but the route is pleasant.

Near to the metropolis the traveller can catch sight of crowds of goldsmiths, hawking their wares. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of blissful gloom, sung by labourers of a nearby village. At last the smell of *tukqizh* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is without a doubt in Zozhsroz.

In the Green District of the city, the squares are paved with granite, inlaid with stone. In the afternoon, one may often hear the knell of the market-hall clock. Writers crowd here, telling stories.

Dreirxrel

From Zozhsroz the traveller may journey north-east to Dreirxrel. The route is crowded, and the journey takes but an afternoon. When a traveller crosses into Zliebmur, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls upon the countryside. Along the way the road crosses a broad depression, spotted with *sleizrinleizgieg* flowers. By the track, *giegrin* plants grow.

A traveller, at the edge of the city of Dreirxrel, can observe the bronze tower of the infamous theatre of Leidmur. From so far, the traveller cannot see how philosophers avoid it. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, one will hear the song of the *zagsoqklogqred* birds, kept by the idle rich. Ultimately the musk of *tloqnod* trees fills the wind, and a traveller is surely in Dreirxrel.

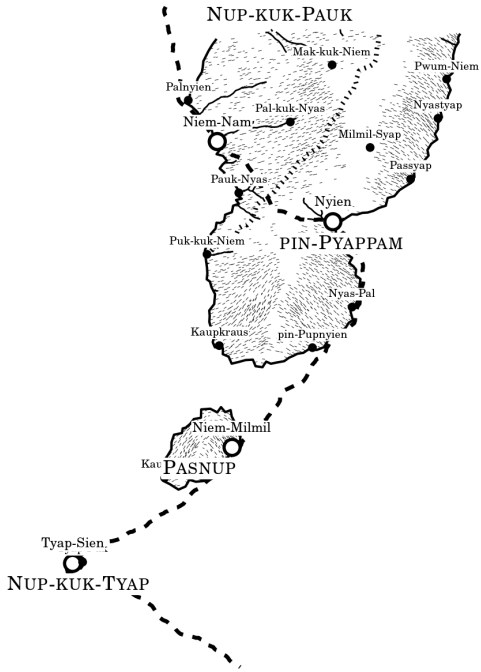
Close to the counting-house of Plelqogmlak, the back-streets are lined with *sleizrinleizgieg* bushes, and the pleasant scent fills the late evening air. The ivory figurines that decorate the balustrades will be easy to see to one. These mark the workplace of an apothecary. The traveller can usually hear songs of dirgeful glee, sung by merchants of the city. Actors gather here, talking and laughing. If a traveller is so ill-fated as to stumble upon an argument between two lovers, it can be half a day before escape is possible.

Xrelklogtroz

Leaving Dreirxrel one can go north-east to Xrelklogtroz. At one point the road crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *nlotgieg* flowers. By the roadside, hairy *napzeb* graze. As a traveller crosses the border into Puqqlagtuk, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls over the land.

Passing into mighty Xrelklogtroz one may espy the monstrous prison of Loqxaszeb. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the peal of the barbican clock. Eventually the aroma of *sleizrinleizgieg* trees fills the breeze, and one has without a doubt arrived.

In the Grey Quarter of the city, the roadways are paved with sandstone. Writers mill here, praying. Should a traveller be blessed enough to encounter the famous Zhleimxoz ceremony, it can be a very instructive experience. A traveller may typically hear the song of the *zebtrozzhlelson* birds, kept by philosophers.



NUP-KUK-PAUK TO NUP-KUK-TYAP

Niem-Nam

The traveller, approaching the gates of Niem-Nam, may see *nikpliel*, the sacred animal of Nup-kuk-Pauk. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear the sound of the bastion clock. At last the perfume of *praus* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Around the dancing-hall of Milsak, the alleyways are lined with *pyupsyiel* bushes, and the blue leaves sway in the early morning air. The bourgeoisie flock here, showing off on the *kyap* board. One will notice the caged *lus* birds. These function as a deterrent to hostile influences.

Nyien

From Niem-Nam the traveller may travel north-west to Nyien. It is a smooth journey. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *syielmliem* plants. Horned *suktyap* graze near the edge of the road. When a traveller enters pin-Pyappam, the foliage changes, giving way to open fields and groves of *pyupsyiel* plants.

Entering the metropolis of Nyien one will observe the colossal temple of Pyapsak. Though from such a large distance it looks elegant, the denizens of the city find its architecture repellent, and hide from it. A little nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear songs of gleeful sadness, sung by citizens of Nyien. Ultimately the bouquet of *praus* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is surely in Nyien.

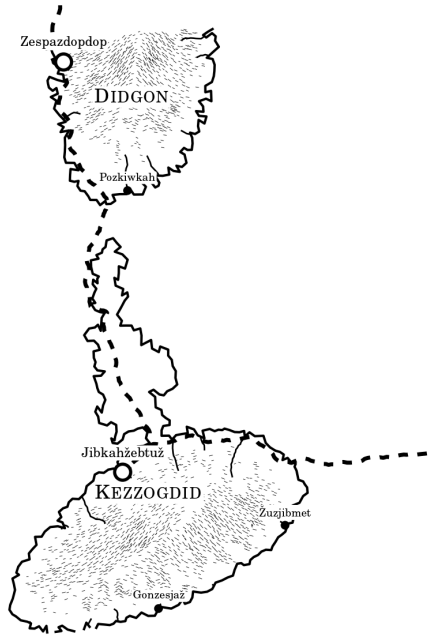
Near the mint of Kiestlup, the squares are paved with *milpaup* stone, inlaid with basalt. The *syieltwap* trees will be conspicuous. These are a relic of the sickness which long ago troubled the city. In the event that one is so unfortunate as to stumble upon the idle rich singing, a traveller may be drawn in, and find it tricky to escape.

Niem-Milmil

Onwards from Nyien one can journey north-east to Niem-Milmil. The traveller can often charter a small fishing boat. A traveller can hear flocks of *lus* birds the shore, diving for fish. The traveller can usually see fish by the side of the boat, darting through the water. In these waters, foul weather conditions sometimes trouble ships, but the route is remarkably safe. One will enjoy a thin stew made of *lus* bird meat and seaweed, spiced with *pupsyiel* flowers, as eaten by sailors and passengers alike.

On reaching the walls of the tremendous city a traveller can come across a series of fishmongers, setting out their stalls. Closer to the heart of the city, one will hear the gentle song of the *lusnriel* birds. Finally the musk of *pyupsyiel* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

In the Goldsmiths' District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *syiel* bushes, and the delicate aroma fills the early afternoon air. Artisans teem here, telling stories and laughing. If a traveller is so fortunate as to catch sight of a herd of *mup*, bred for show by the petty criminals of the Tailors' Quarter, it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the late evening, the traveller can occasionally hear the song of the *lus* birds, kept by labourers.



A distracted visitor will overlook the tame *myatnin* birds. These indicate the home of an artisan.

Tyap-Sien

Leaving Niem-Milmil the traveller can travel north-east to Tyap-Sien. Many craft cross these waters, and one can often obtain passage on a small trading vessel. There are typically, off the stern, shoals of *pun* fish, barely visible beneath the waves. Seabirds can usually be spotted the coast. Notwithstanding the squalls which often plague boats in this area, the crossing is very comfortable.

A traveller, on entering the city, will find writers, trying their luck at the game of *kyapmil*. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear songs of heavy-hearted delight, sung by soldiers of a nearby village. Eventually the scent of *praus* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Tyap-Sien.

In the vicinity of the citadel of Milmil-Sien, the boulevards are paved with granite. The idle rich lounge here, praying and telling stories. In the late morning, the traveller may sometimes hear the pleasant song of the *lus* birds.

Didgon to Kezzogdid

Zespazdopdop

Outside the great city of Zespazdopdop one may see the golden spires of the immense castle of Koszugčoh. Although from here it seems alluring, the citizens of Zespazdopdop find its bulk distasteful, and stay away from it. A little closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the bells of the prison clock. In the end the bouquet of *žizseh* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

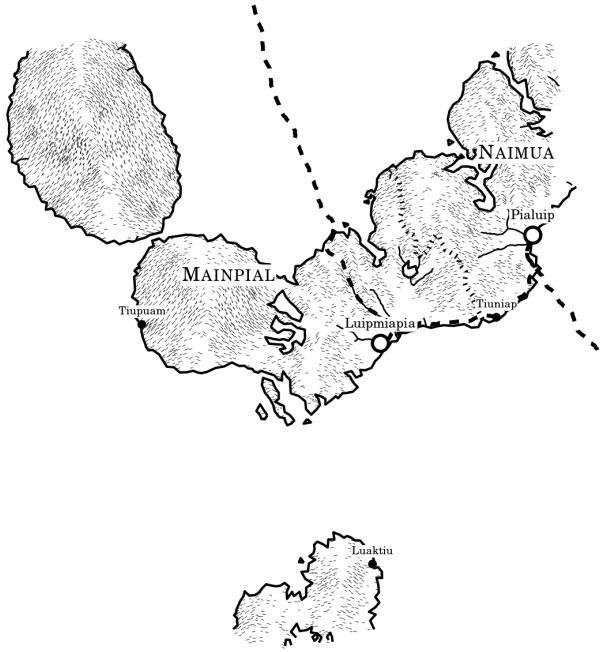
In the Old District of the city, the streets are lined with *hih* trees. In the evening, the traveller can typically hear songs of ecstatic misery, sung by farmers of the city. Merchants crowd here, singing. The *sehmetgon* flowers will be clear to one. These serve as a deterrent to malign spirits.

Jibkahžebtuž

Leaving Zespazdopdop a traveller may go to Jibkahžebtuž. At one point the route crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *hihžig* plants. As the traveller crosses the border into Kezzogdid, the greenery changes, giving way to pastures and meadows. On the track, *jumtozjeg* trees grow.

A traveller, at the outskirts of famed Jibkahžebtuž, may stumble upon actors, dancing. Closer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the song of the *dužžojdobbah* birds. At last the musk of *žečmetdop* fruit fills the breeze, and one is beyond doubt in Jibkahžebtuž.

Close to the dancing-hall, the back-streets are paved with lead. In the early afternoon, the traveller may occasionally hear songs of forlorn bliss, sung by philosophers of Jibkahžebtuž. The bourgeoisie gather here, showing off on the *koszub* field.

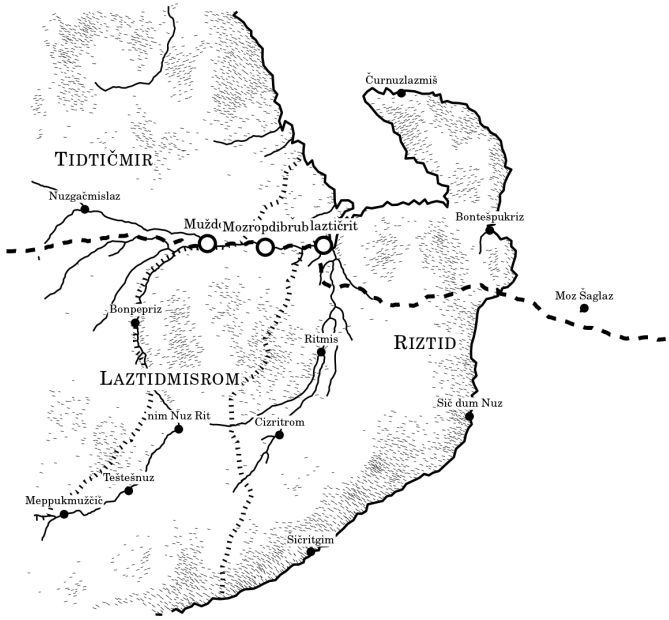


MAINPIAL TO NAIMUA

Luipmiapia

Outside the monstrous city a traveller will catch sight of the tremendous market-hall of Mautainpuip. From so far, the traveller has no way to make out how scholars throng near its basalt walls, laughing and talking. Nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the clanging of the barbican clock. In the end the fragrance of *puimiak* bushes fills the air, and one has surely arrived.

In the Artisans' Quarter of the city, the roadways are paved with limestone, inlaid with marble. Should one be ill-fated enough to catch sight of priests singing, a traveller may be drawn in, and it can be two hours before escape is possible. The traveller will see the obsidian figures which adorn the pediments. These denote the shop of a doctor. Criminals cluster here, laughing.



Pialuip

Onwards from Luipmiapia a traveller can travel to Pialuip. It is a delightful journey. When one enters Naimua, there is a change in the light, and a bluish cast falls across the terrain. Along the way the route crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *niatainluat* flowers. Mighty *pai* graze near the roadside.

The traveller, nearing the gates of Pialuip, can espy the sapphire roof of the colossal fortress of Miamuap. While at this distance it appear beautiful, the natives of the city find its form disagreeable, and avoid it. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller begins to hear the song of the *miu* birds, kept by citizens. Eventually the bouquet of *luakmaukuak* fruit fills the breeze, and one is truly in Pialuip.

In the Red District of the city, the streets are lined with *puimiak* plants, and the golden blossoms whisper in the wind. In the event that the traveller is so blessed as to stumble upon the holy Puiniamnaus dance, it can be half a day before escape is possible. The *niapaup* bushes will be almost impossible to miss to a traveller. These commemorate the plague which recently ravaged the surrounding countryside.

Tidtičmir to Riztid

Muždor

Nearing the edge of the celebrated metropolis one may see horned *narčesrom*, valued for their leather. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the chimes of the mint clock. Finally the smell of *zan* plants fills the air, and one has undeniably arrived.

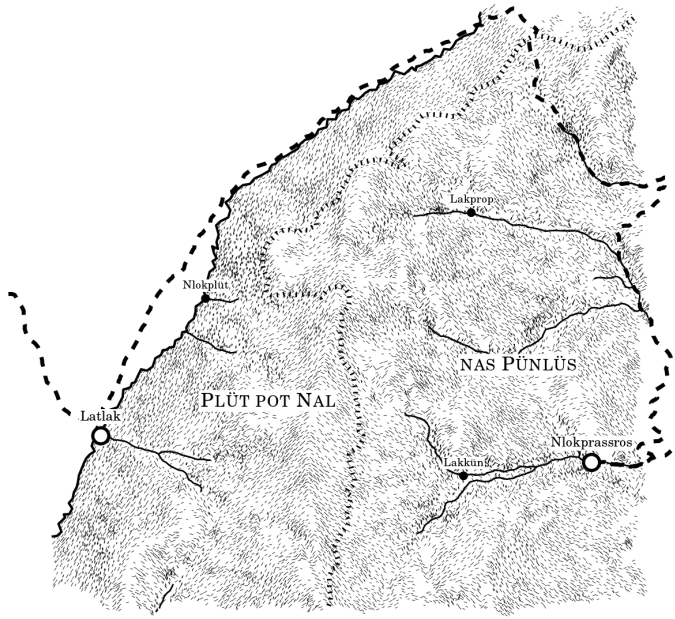
Near the citadel of Šičrirtib, the alleyways are lined with *pubroprorčuršiž* trees, and the red petals shimmer in the late morning wind. Labourers congregate here, telling stories and dancing. In the night, the traveller may often hear songs of buoyant dejection, sung by writers of Muždor. An inattentive observer will miss the caged *rorrimlaz* birds. These act to ward off unwanted influences. If one is ill-fated enough to catch sight of an altercation between two lovers, it may be a most educational experience.

Mozropdibrub

Onwards from Muždor a traveller may journey to Mozropdibrub. The road is well-trodden, and the journey takes but a few hours. As the traveller crosses the border into Laztidmisrom, the foliage changes, giving way to open fields and hedgerows. At one point the route crosses a broad depression. *Širbetkobpit* flowers grow by the bank of the track.

The traveller, passing into iniquitous Mozropdibrub, will find scattered hawkers, setting out their stalls. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the sweet song of the *mučrim* birds, kept by soldiers. Ultimately the perfume of *gikgimdorčad* fruit fills the air, and one is beyond doubt in Mozropdibrub.

In the Actors' District of the city, the squares are paved with bronze. The basalt medallions that grace the archways will be easy to see. These betoken the home of a smith. Should the traveller be so charmed as to come across a herd of *žimlazlaz*, bred for racing by the priests of the Blue Quarter, the traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.



Žežlaztičrit

Leaving Mozropdibrub a traveller can go west to Žežlaztičrit. Along the way the road crosses a deep gully, spotted with *zan* bushes. When a traveller enters Riztid, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls over the landscape. On the roadside, *žim* graze.

A traveller, approaching the outskirts of the monumental city, may catch sight of the granite lookout of the great prison of Rusgutgačkeb. From here, the traveller is unable to see how the idle rich shun it. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the tolling of the university clock. At last the aroma of *pubroprorčuršiž* plants fills the breeze, and one has without a doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the temple of Mirtib, the roadways are lined with *kep* trees. A traveller will be impressed by the tame *mučrim* birds. These signify the shop of a fortune-teller. In the event that the traveller is lucky enough to see a game of *rormutčarmuč*, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. Actors mill here, praying. In the early afternoon, one can sometimes hear the gentle song of the *rorrimlaz* birds, kept by petty criminals.

Plüt pot Nal to nas Pünlüs

Latlak

Near to the colossal metropolis of Latlak a traveller will discern the famed counting-house of Platsop. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of doleful ecstasy, sung by labourers of a nearby village. Eventually the musk of *slos* fruit fills the wind, and one has surely arrived.

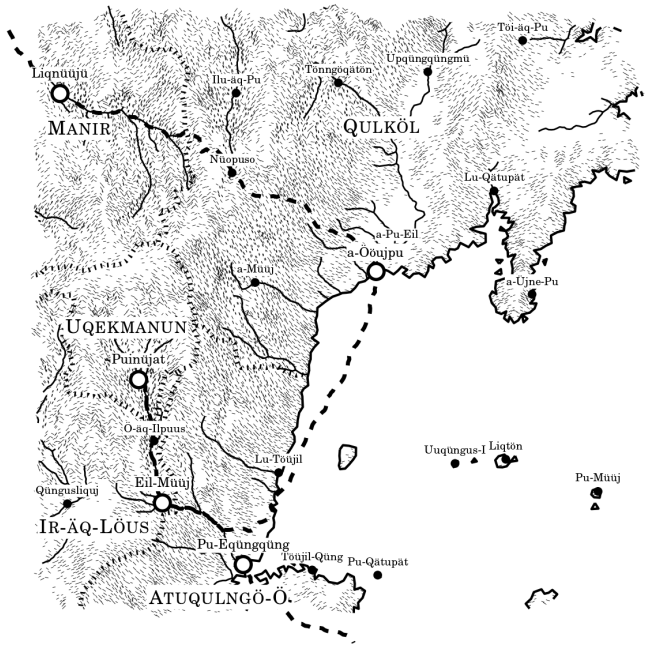
In the Tailors' Quarter of the city, the plazas are paved with marble, inlaid with lead. In the event that a traveller is fortunate enough to stumble upon the bourgeoisie talking, it can be a very edifying experience. The *ples* flowers will be apparent to one. These are a memento of the sickness which not long ago devastated the surrounding countryside. Actors crowd here, practising their skill at *loskip*. In the evening, the traveller can occasionally hear songs of plaintive glee, sung by labourers of a nearby village.

Nlokprassros

From Latlak one may travel west to Nlokprassros. As this crossing is busy, a traveller can often find space on a small trading ship. There are typically great numbers of fish in the water nearby. The land's edge, the traveller can see flocks of *mratsop* birds. The route is quite pleasant, despite the storms which plague vessels near here.

A traveller, on reaching the gates of monumental Nlokprassros, can find hairy *sümtampup*, the sacred animal of nas Pünlüs. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the knell of the mint clock. In the end the bouquet of *ples* trees fills the wind, and one is undoubtedly in Nlokprassros.

Around the temple of Münlassam, the back-streets are lined with *ples* bushes, and the balmy musk fills the late morning breeze. Should the traveller be so unlucky as to come across the revered Soppras Plüt ritual, a traveller might be drawn in, and it can be half a day before escape is possible. Soldiers gather here, singing and telling stories. A careless traveller will not notice the obsidian statues which adorn the eaves. These act as a caution to hostile spirits. In the evening, the traveller may sometimes hear songs of joyous gloom, sung by philosophers of the New District.



MANIR TO ATUQULNGÖ-Ö

Liqnüüjü

On entering the gargantuan city a traveller can make out the marble dome of the infamous watchtower of Lerö-Teömit. Even though from so far it may seem enchanting, the natives of Liqnüüjü find its architecture unsavoury, and hide from it. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear the song of the *ätkö* birds, kept by the idle rich. Ultimately the scent of *äk* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

In the Fishmongers' Quarter of the city, the alleyways are paved with limestone. The *ujöqölöj* plants will be conspicuous. These are in memory of the war which twenty years ago beset the city. In the early afternoon, one may occasionally hear the pleasant song of the *uqkö* birds. If a traveller is blessed enough to catch sight of a herd of mighty *nu*, valued for their horns, it may be three hours before escape is possible.

a-Ööujpu

Onwards from Liqnüüjü one may journey to a-Ööujpu. The track is long, but rewarding, taking two weeks. As the traveller crosses the border into Qulköl, the greenery changes, giving way to pastures and clumps of *qö* flowers. At one point the road crosses a broad valley, spotted with *regin* trees.

Near the outskirts of the famous city of a-Ööujpu a traveller will stumble upon scattered fruit-sellers, hawking their wares. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the chimes of the palace clock. At last the smell of *ujöqölöj* bushes fills the breeze, and one is truly in a-Ööujpu.

Close to the mint of Öqüjqul, the plazas are lined with *miiptön* plants, and the yellow blossoms rustle in the night air. A traveller will see the caged *ol* birds. These indicate the workplace of an artisan. Should one be so ill-fated as to catch sight of merchants dancing, it may be a humbling experience. The traveller can often hear songs of sombre exuberance, sung by citizens of the surrounding countryside. Artisans swarm here, dancing.

Eil-Müüj

Leaving a-Ööujpu a traveller can go north-east to Eil-Müüj. Many ships traverse these waters, so one can typically charter a small fishing boat. Near the boat the traveller can usually see great numbers of silver *niipmiqö* fish, gleaming in the sunlight. In this area, craft are occasionally troubled by gales, but the crossing is extremely safe.

The traveller, passing into iniquitous Eil-Müüj, will observe the emerald clock-tower of the monumental castle of A-Teömit. From here, the traveller cannot see how philosophers steer clear of it, trying their luck on the *üjarqoil* court. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear the tolling of the citadel clock. Finally the scent of *qö* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Red Quarter of the city, the streets are paved with granite, inlaid with basalt. Criminals throng here, showing off at the game of *nürömitöl*. The tame *uqkö* birds will be easy to see to a traveller. These function as a vestige of the revolution which long ago engulfed the Temple District.

Puinüjat

Onwards from Eil-Müüj one can travel south to Puinüjat. *Regin* flowers grow by the route. Along the way the route crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *ujöqölöj* trees. When the traveller enters Uqekmanun, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls upon the countryside.

The traveller, approaching the edge of the mighty city, can encounter the bourgeoisie, singing and laughing. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will hear songs of merry sadness, sung by scholars of Puinüjat. At last the bouquet of *äk* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Puinüjat.

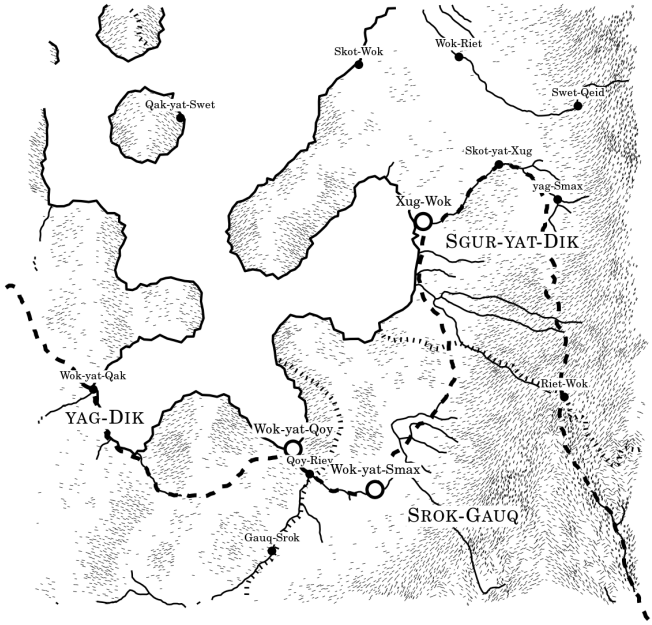
Around the market-hall of Qongätatüj, the back-streets are lined with *misoüj* bushes. Farmers teem here, telling stories. The obsidian carvings that decorate the doorways will be obvious to one. These warn off harmful influences.

Pu-Eqüngqüng

From Puinüjat the traveller may journey to Pu-Eqüngqüng. As a traveller crosses the border into Atuqulngö-Ö, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls across the terrain. At one point the road crosses a broad rift, spotted with *eür* bushes.

Outside infamous Pu-Eqüngqüng the traveller may make out the ivory vaulted roof of the famous dancing-hall of Neööq-Ööq. Despite the fact that from so far it may look alluring, the citizens of the city find its form disagreeable, and avoid it. Closer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the sweet song of the *ätkö* birds. Ultimately the musk of *ngültönüj* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has surely arrived.

In the Green District of the city, the boulevards are paved with marble, inlaid with lead. One may sometimes hear the balmy song of the *ol* birds, kept by labourers. Citizens congregate here, practising their skill on the *üjarqoil* tables. If a traveller is so fortunate as to find a game of *nürömitöl*, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. An inattentive visitor will overlook the granite medallions which ornament the rooftops. These denote the home of an artisan.



YAG-DIK TO SGUR-YAT-DIK

Wok-yat-Qoy

Entering the vast city of Wok-yat-Qoy one can encounter crowds of pedlars, setting out their stalls. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the clanging of the castle clock. Finally the fragrance of *xuq* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the barbican of Yag-Rum, the plazas are lined with *rec* trees, and the delicate bouquet fills the morning air. Should one be blessed enough to catch sight of a herd of *leic*, bred for show by the philosophers of a nearby village, it may be a most edifying experience. The *neir* plants will be clear to the traveller. These betoken the shop of a doctor. In the afternoon, a traveller can occasionally hear songs of mournful delight, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside.

Wok-yat-Smax

Onwards from Wok-yat-Qoy one may go north-west to Wok-yat-Smax. It is a pleasant journey. Along the way the route crosses a deep gully, spotted with *sriew* trees. When the traveller enters Srok-Gauq, the foliage changes, giving way to open fields and wild *sriew* bushes.

A traveller, on reaching the gates of the metropolis, may espy the sapphire roof of the monstrous temple of Rum-yat-Xug. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sound of the watchtower clock. Eventually the scent of *dier* fruit fills the wind, and one is undoubtedly in Wok-yat-Smax.

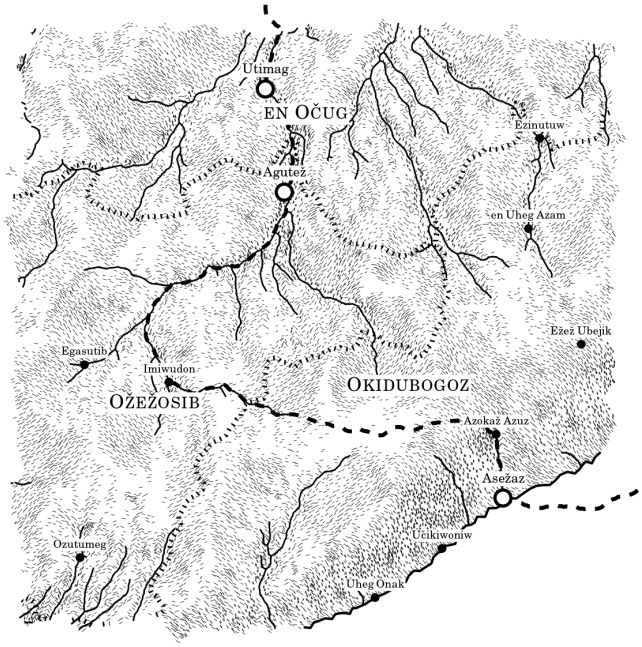
In the Old Quarter, the streets are paved with ivory, inlaid with stone. In the event that the traveller is so lucky as to stumble upon a fight between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the evening, a traveller may usually hear the sweet song of the *smeix* birds, kept by writers.

Xug-Wok

From Wok-yat-Smax one can travel south to Xug-Wok. It is a simple journey. Near the roadside, horned *leic* graze. When the traveller crosses the border into Sgur-yat-Dik, the vegetation changes, giving way to thickets of *neir* flowers and scrubland. At one point the track crosses a broad rift.

Passing into Xug-Wok a traveller will see artisans, praying and dancing. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, one will hear songs of exuberant misery, sung by labourers of the Merchants' District. In the end the aroma of *xuq* trees fills the air, and the traveller has undeniably arrived.

Close to the prison of Gauq-Rum, the squares are lined with *rec* plants. In the morning, a traveller can often hear the striking of the citadel clock. Farmers mill here, practising their skill at the game of *scor*. In the event that a traveller is unfortunate enough to find the intricate Ker-Bic parade, one may be drawn in, and find it hard to escape.



EN OČUG TO OKIDUBOGOZ

Utimag

A traveller, nearing the walls of the mighty city of Utimag, can catch sight of the bronze tower of the great fortress of Ukopih. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the song of the *anumajak* birds. Finally the smell of *ahipik* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is truly in Utimag.

In the Grey Quarter of the city, the back-streets are paved with bronze, inlaid with sandstone. Merchants flock here, singing and telling stories. A traveller may sometimes hear the knell of the castle clock. One will notice the tame *anow* birds. These serve to repel evil spirits.

Agutež

Leaving Utimag a traveller can go north to Agutež. *Itohasig* bushes grow by the route. As the traveller enters Ožežosib, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls upon the countryside. At one point the track crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *otažažoh* flowers.

Near to the famed city one may come across shaggy *unewasapuž*, the national animal of Ožežosib. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of sorrowful pleasure, sung by scholars of the surrounding countryside. At last the fragrance of *ežekugamum* fruit fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in Agutež.

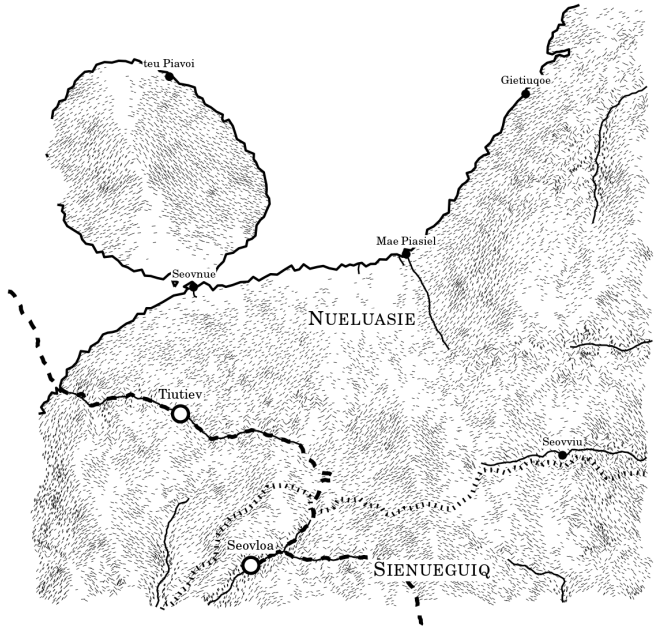
In the vicinity of the market-hall of Učisažebož, the boulevards are lined with *itohasig* trees, and the gentle perfume fills the late night air. The *otažažoh* flowers will be apparent to the traveller. These function as a relic of the sickness which twenty years ago troubled a nearby village. If one is so lucky as to catch sight of a herd of hairy *amuzowoweh*, prized for their leather, it can be a very educational experience. Soldiers crowd here, dancing. The traveller can typically hear the clanging of the prison clock.

Asežaz

Onwards from Agutež a traveller may journey to Asežaz. The road is arduous, but rewarding, taking some weeks. On the side of the route, *esežupot* plants grow. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression. As one crosses the border into Okidubogoz, the greenery changes, giving way to open fields and hedgerows.

The traveller, approaching the gates of Asežaz, will espy the crystal lookout of the immense temple of Ihebizumup. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear songs of dirgeful glee, sung by labourers of the Tailors' District. Eventually the bouquet of *itohasig* bushes fills the breeze, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Artisans' Quarter, the plazas are paved with marble, inlaid with basalt. Priests mill here, trying their luck on the *ačodoj* board. Should the traveller be ill-fated enough to find a game of *upihij*, one might be drawn in, and it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. In the early evening, a traveller may usually hear the delicate song of the *anumajak* birds, kept by criminals.

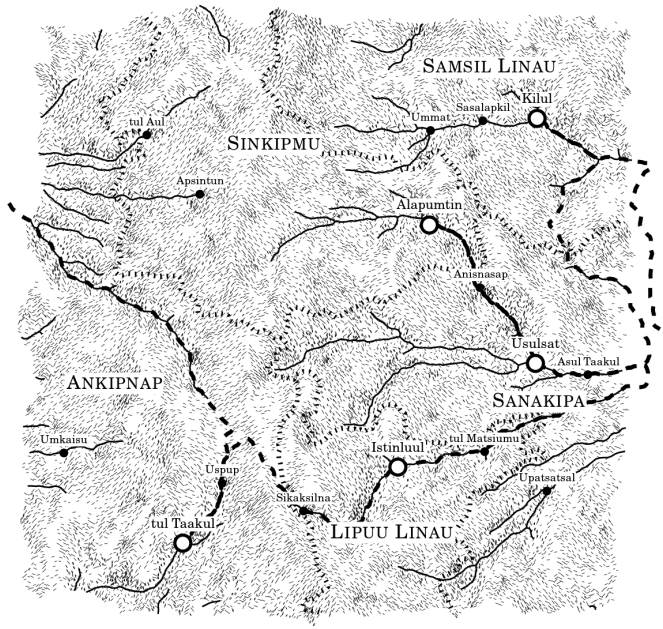


NUELUASIE TO SIENUEGUIQ

Tiutiev

Outside the vast metropolis of Tiutiev one can observe the ivory dome of the celebrated palace of Voivoijoi. From such a great distance, the traveller has no way to discern how labourers congregate around it, singing and laughing. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the balmy song of the *tai* birds, kept by farmers. Ultimately the musk of *jaek* plants fills the wind, and one has truly arrived.

In the Merchants' District of the city, the streets are lined with *giepjeutjaekvoingeim* flowers, and the emerald leaves sway in the air. Philosophers throng here, talking. If a traveller is so blessed as to see citizens dancing, it can be a couple of hours before escape is possible. A careless traveller will fail to see the stone statues that grace the doorways. These act as a warning to unwanted influences.



Seovloa

From Tiutiev the traveller can travel north-west to Seovloa. It is an agreeable journey. When a traveller enters Sienueguiq, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls over the land. By the roadside, horned *jieviu* graze.

A traveller, near the walls of monumental Seovloa, may encounter crowds of merchants, hawking their wares. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, one will hear the peal of the watchtower clock. Finally the scent of *jaekqoemiokjeut* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller is undeniably in Seovloa.

Around the bastion of Qiationg, the roadways are paved with granite, inlaid with *maesues* stone. Should a traveller be fortunate enough to catch sight of a herd of *jieviu*, the sacred animal of Sienueguiq, the traveller may be drawn in, and find it almost impossible to escape. In the early morning, one can occasionally hear songs of mirthful melancholy, sung by scholars of the surrounding countryside. A traveller will take note of the *gieneimteug* trees. These call to mind the plague which recently devastated a nearby village.

ANKIPNAP TO SAMSIL LINAU

tul Taakul

Passing into the great city the traveller will see actors, telling stories and singing. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear the bells of the counting-house clock. In the end the fragrance of *lanapkil* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has surely arrived.

In the Red Quarter of the city, the squares are lined with *kaniplusna* bushes, and the emerald blossoms whisper in the late afternoon air. In the event that the traveller is so charmed as to find the sacred Mitkunakan procession, it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the morning, one can sometimes hear the gentle song of the *lisanas* birds.

Istinluul

Leaving tul Taakul a traveller may journey to Istinluul. It is a smooth journey. At one point the track crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *nalusip* flowers. *Papsaskilal* trees grow on the road. As the traveller enters Lipuu Linau, the foliage changes, giving way to clumps of *kaniplusna* plants and meadows.

The traveller, on reaching the edge of the city of Istinluul, can see the infamous citadel of Kaam Taulus. Although from so far it may appear quaint, the people of Istinluul find its bulk unsavoury, and shun it. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear songs of ecstatic gloom, sung by the idle rich of the city. Eventually the perfume of *napla* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Istinluul.

Near the fortress of Masuuppu, the streets are paved with ivory, inlaid with limestone. The caged *lisanas* birds will be obvious. These mark the workplace of a smith. In the early evening, one may typically hear the striking of the temple clock.

Usulsat

Onwards from Istinluul a traveller can go south-west to Usulsat. It is an enjoyable journey. When the traveller crosses the border into Sanakipa, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a

grey cast falls upon the landscape. Hairy *mapuiksi* graze near the roadside. Along the way the track crosses a broad valley, spotted with *papsaskilal* flowers.

A traveller, entering immense Usulsat, may catch sight of the gleaming towers of the mighty barbican of Sastaam. From here, one cannot espy how merchants stay away from it, trying their luck at *salitalam*. Closer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear songs of heavy-hearted exuberance, sung by petty criminals of Usulsat. Finally the smell of *nalusip* bushes fills the breeze, and the traveller has truly arrived.

In the Grey District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *kaniplusna* trees, and the pleasant aroma fills the late night wind. A distracted visitor will not notice the obsidian columns which adorn the balustrades. These betoken the place of business of an apothecary. If the traveller is unlucky enough to catch sight of writers praying, it can be a most instructive experience. The bourgeoisie gather here, dancing. In the morning, one may occasionally hear the tolling of the mint clock.

Alapumtin

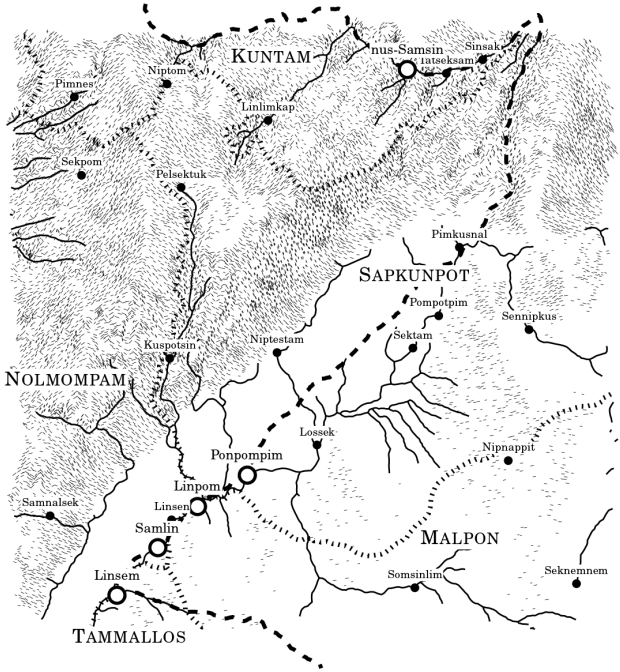
From Usulsat a traveller may travel south-east to Alapumtin. By the verge of the road, *ipmas* bushes grow. As the traveller enters Sinkipmu, the vegetation changes, giving way to woods of *papsaskilal* plants and scrubland.

At the walls of vast Alapumtin one may encounter labourers, telling stories and praying. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear the peal of the university clock. In the end the scent of *salapi* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is undeniably in Alapumtin.

Close to the theatre of Tamtuakkan, the back-streets are paved with ivory. In the early afternoon, a traveller can sometimes hear the song of the *pumkun* birds, kept by artisans. Should one be so fortunate as to come across a game of *sinatis*, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. The caged *lisanas* birds will be difficult to miss. These commemorate the plague which not long ago troubled the city.

Kilul

Onwards from Alapumtin a traveller may journey south-west to Kilul. Along the way the route crosses a deep ravine. As the traveller crosses the border into Samsil Linau, the greenery changes, giving way to wild *ipmas* flowers and open fields.



Passing into the city of Kilul one can see *animpiskul*, bred for work by the farmers of the surrounding countryside. A little closer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of merry misery, sung by writers of the Tailors' Quarter. Finally the aroma of *papsaskilal* bushes fills the air, and the traveller has surely arrived.

Around the citadel of Pimisal Tusa, the plazas are paved with stone. Soldiers flock here, talking. In the event that one is blessed enough to find an argument between two lovers, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. The traveller will notice the *papsaskilal* trees. These act to ward off hostile spirits. In the late evening, one can often hear songs of mournful joy, sung by petty criminals of the Green District.

KUNTAM TO TAMMALLOS

nus-Samsin

The traveller, approaching the outskirts of the metropolis, will make out the gargantuan market-hall of Pitmansit. While from

here it appear enchanting, denizens of the city find its form repellent, and hide from it. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the sweet song of the *semtos* birds. Ultimately the fragrance of *ponpomsan* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is without a doubt in nus-Samsin.

In the Actors' District, the roadways are lined with *sipmam* flowers, and the delicate smell fills the early night breeze. In the late morning, a traveller may usually hear the chimes of the barbican clock. Artisans cluster here, practising their skill at the game of *sosteskek*. If one is so unfortunate as to stumble upon the holy Nupnemsas ritual, it may be an instructive experience.

Ponpompim

Leaving nus-Samsin a traveller can go north to Ponpompim. The track is long, but scenic, taking three days. When one crosses the border into Sapkunpot, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls across the countryside. Near the road, *soknit* graze. At one point the route crosses a broad rift, spotted with *saklosnet* trees.

Outside the tremendous city the traveller will espy the copper spires of the infamous theatre of Nalmottus. Closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the song of the *nalnos* birds. In the end the bouquet of *saklosnet* plants fills the air, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the dancing-hall of Loknup, the squares are lined with *moppok* bushes, and the delicate petals shimmer in the early afternoon breeze. The *tomsuknet* flowers will be conspicuous. These denote the home of a smith. In the late evening, one can typically hear songs of blissful sadness, sung by scholars of the surrounding countryside.

Linpom

Leaving Ponpompim the traveller may travel to Linpom. The track is well-trodden, and the journey takes but three hours. *Mamsem* plants grow on the roadside. At one point the road crosses a deep gorge. As one enters Malpon, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the landscape.

A traveller, entering famed Linpom, can see a series of silversmiths, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of plaintive glee, sung by philosophers of the city. At last the perfume of *nolpop* fruit fills the air, and a traveller is undeniably in Linpom.

In the New Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with bronze, inlaid with lead. A hasty observer will fail to see the *talnelmom* stone gargoyles that decorate the walls. These are a vestige of the war which long ago beset a nearby village. In the event that the traveller is lucky enough to find a game of *keklis*, one may be drawn in, and it may be two hours before escape is possible. The bourgeoisie gather here, telling stories.

Samlin

From Linpom a traveller can go north-east to Samlin. When one crosses the border into Nolmompam, the vegetation changes, giving way to scrubland and pastures. Along the way the road crosses a deep gully, spotted with *mamsuk* trees. Near the edge of the route, horned *soknit* graze.

At the gates of the city of Samlin the traveller can catch sight of shaggy *sosmekkes*, prized for their meat. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the bells of the bastion clock. Ultimately the scent of *nolpop* fruit fills the wind, and one has surely arrived.

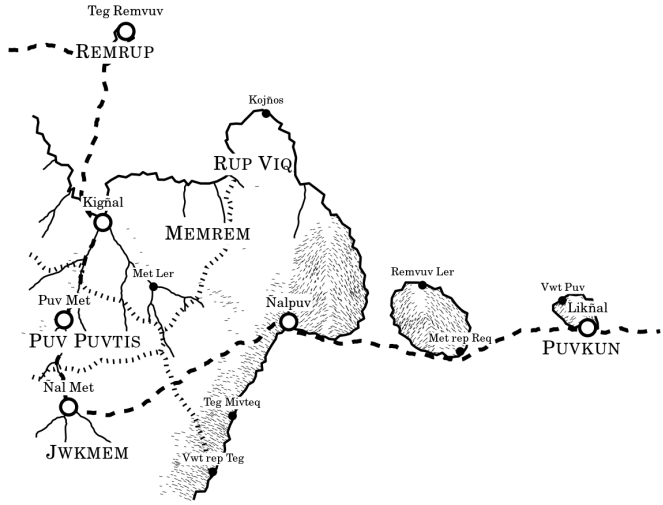
Near the university, the alleyways are lined with *mamsem* bushes, and the balmy fragrance fills the afternoon wind. In the early night, the traveller may occasionally hear songs of mirthful melancholy, sung by farmers of Samlin. Should a traveller be so unlucky as to come across a herd of shaggy *soknit*, bred for racing by the criminals of the Merchants' Quarter, it can be an educational experience.

Linsem

Leaving Samlin the traveller can travel to Linsem. The track is crowded, and the journey takes but an afternoon. *Moppok* plants grow by the roadside. At one point the route crosses a broad depression. When a traveller enters Tammallos, there is a change in the light, and a golden cast falls across the countryside.

The traveller, passing into the celebrated metropolis, will discern the mighty mint of Tusmanpet. Nearer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the delicate song of the *semtos* birds, kept by the idle rich. Finally the aroma of *tomsuknet* flowers fills the breeze, and the traveller is without a doubt in Linsem.

In the Blue District, the plazas are paved with stone, inlaid with ivory. The tame *petpontos* birds will be clear to the traveller. These serve as a caution to harmful influences. Merchants lounge here, trying their luck on the *keklis* field.



REMRUP TO PUVKUN

Teg Remvuv

Approaching the walls of gargantuan Teg Remvuv one may espy the famous fortress of Ler Jwgjam. From so far, a traveller has no way to discern how writers swarm by its sapphire gates, dancing. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the sound of the citadel clock. At last the perfume of *luñrwg* fruit fills the air, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the castle, the back-streets are lined with *pip* bushes, and the blue blossoms rustle in the evening breeze. An inattentive visitor will overlook the *pip* trees. These function as a memento of the revolution which twenty years ago devastated the surrounding countryside. Priests teem here, singing and telling stories. In the late night, the traveller can sometimes hear the pleasant song of the *junnit* birds, kept by artisans. If a traveller is fortunate enough to find a quarrel between two lovers, it can be

half a day before escape is possible.

Kigñal

Onwards from Teg Remvuv one may journey to Kigñal. The fishermen subsist on boiled *rwñ* fruit, garnished with *rwñ* seed. In the water nearby shoals of vividly striped *jus* fish may often be seen, bobbing and weaving in unison. Despite the fact that the route is quite easy, squalls typically beset ships. Flocks of seabirds can occasionally be observed the coast, circling overhead.

Near to the city of Kigñal the traveller may catch sight of crowds of fruit-sellers, setting out their stalls. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear songs of ebullient gloom, sung by farmers of the city. Eventually the smell of *pip* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller is without a doubt in Kigñal.

In the Actors' District of the city, the squares are paved with granite, inlaid with sandstone. Citizens gather here, showing off at *geljom*. In the event that a traveller is so unfortunate as to see a game of *tum*, one may be drawn in, and find it hard to escape. The basalt statues which decorate the lintels will be easy to see to a traveller. These indicate the shop of a doctor.

Puv Met

From Kigñal the traveller can go to Puv Met. It is a pleasant journey. Along the way the road crosses a deep canyon. As a traveller enters Puv Puvtis, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and open fields. On the route, mighty *nitnwm* graze.

A traveller, on reaching the gates of the city, may see the famed barbican of Naq Vuñ. Though at this distance it seems beautiful, the people of Puv Met find its bulk distasteful, and steer clear of it. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the peal of the fortress clock. Ultimately the bouquet of *luñrwg* fruit fills the breeze, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

Close to the citadel of Ruv rep Peñ, the alleyways are lined with *jwgpip* bushes, and the balmy musk fills the morning wind. If a traveller is blessed enough to come across the revered Jwgtav ceremony, it may be a very edifying experience. The traveller can sometimes hear the gentle song of the *jun* birds, kept by writers. Scholars cluster here, praying and talking.

Ñal Met

Leaving Puv Met a traveller may travel north to Ñal Met. It is a delightful journey. *Pip* trees grow by the fringe of the track. Along the way the road crosses a broad rift, spotted with *pipgel* plants. When the traveller crosses into Jwkmem, the greenery changes, giving way to scrubland and wild *pipjuj* flowers.

The traveller, outside colossal Ñal Met, can find priests, practising their skill on the *peñjom* court. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear songs of doleful pleasure, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. Eventually the smell of *rwñ* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

In the Goldsmiths' Quarter, the boulevards are paved with ivory, inlaid with bronze. In the early afternoon, the traveller may typically hear the song of the *jun* birds. A traveller will be humbled by the *rwñ* trees. These act as a deterrent to malign spirits. The idle rich lounge here, singing and dancing. Should one be so ill-fated as to catch sight of a fight between two lovers, it may be a couple of hours before escape is possible.

Ñalpuv

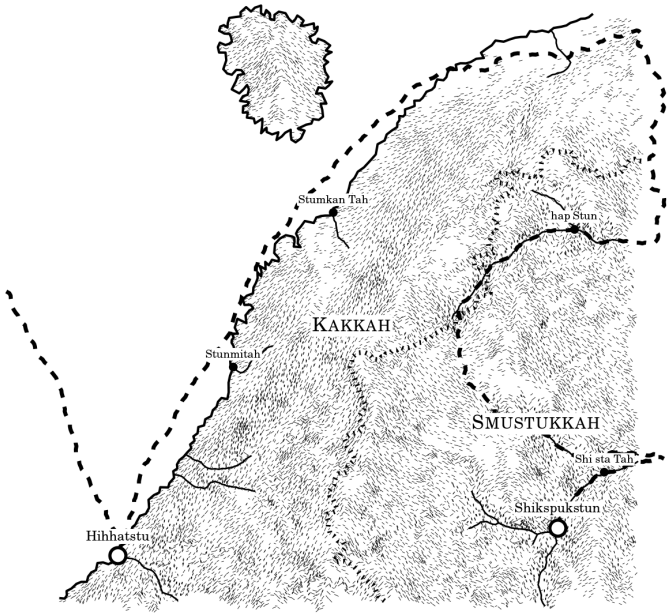
From Ñal Met one can journey west to Ñalpuv. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking two weeks. As a traveller crosses the border into Rup Viq, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls upon the terrain. At one point the road crosses a deep ravine. Near the track, hairy *qumkoj* graze.

Nearing the outskirts of the iniquitous city of Ñalpuv the traveller will observe the bone-white clock-tower of the monumental temple of Sevruv. Closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the tolling of the palace clock. In the end the fragrance of *vwjlik* fruit fills the air, and one is surely in Ñalpuv.

Near the dancing-hall of Ruvteq, the streets are lined with *rwñ* flowers. In the event that the traveller is unlucky enough to come across the famous Ler rep Rem procession, it may be a most humbling experience. The marble columns that grace the archways will be clear. These are in memory of the pestilence which long ago tormented a nearby village.

Likñal

Onwards from Ñalpuv one may go west to Likñal. A traveller can often find space on a ship. The shore flocks of *pirtañ* birds may



occasionally be spotted. The traveller can see, by the side of the boat, numerous jet-black *togjus* fish.

At the edge of Likñal one can see *qumkoj*, the national animal of Puvkun. A little closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the chimes of the prison clock. At last the aroma of *rwñ* bushes fills the air, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Red District of the city, the back-streets are paved with ivory, inlaid with granite. One will notice the *pip* plants. These mark the place of business of an apothecary. Petty criminals mill here, showing off at the game of *kej*. A traveller may typically hear the sweet song of the *junnit* birds, kept by soldiers.

KAKKAH TO SMUSTUKKAH

Hihhatstu

A traveller, on entering the metropolis, may see the infamous temple of Nutahka. From here, one is unable to espy how merchants crowd around it. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of elegiac delight, sung by farmers of the

Fishmongers' Quarter. Finally the scent of *hitikaspumspi* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is truly in Hihhatstu.

Around the citadel, the plazas are lined with *shumantanhishum* trees, and the yellow leaves shimmer in the late morning breeze. One can occasionally hear the delicate song of the *tamstup* birds. Writers throng here, telling stories. The limestone gargoyles which adorn the eaves will be apparent to the traveller. These serve to deter unwanted influences. If a traveller is charmed enough to encounter priests praying, one might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Shikspukstun

Leaving Hihhatstu the traveller may travel west to Shikspukstun. The road is long, but rewarding, taking several days. When one enters Smustukkah, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and scrubland. *Spimsmikanshum* bushes grow by the roadside. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *smi* flowers.

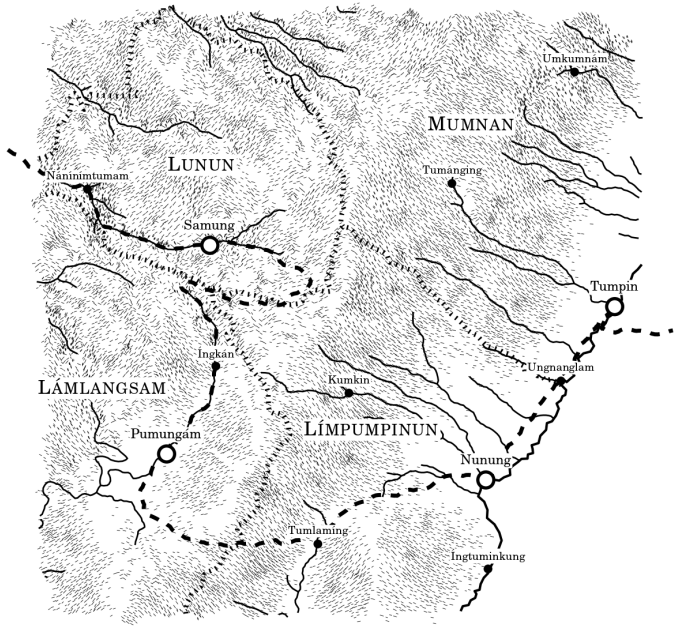
Passing into the metropolis a traveller may stumble upon scattered hawkers, hawking their wares. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear songs of joyous melancholy, sung by scholars of a nearby village. In the end the bouquet of *shumantanhishum* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Actors' District of the city, the alleyways are paved with marble, inlaid with *smuhspu* stone. The idle rich lounge here, trying their luck on the *stisminshustukstih* board. A hasty observer will miss the *spimsmikanshum* flowers. These are a relic of the revolution which recently engulfed the city. In the early evening, one may sometimes hear the bells of the watchtower clock. Should the traveller be so lucky as to find a game of *stikanhip*, it can be a very instructive experience.

LUNUN TO MUMNAN

Samung

The traveller, near the walls of the tremendous city of Samung, can observe the vast palace of Námlíngnun. A little closer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the gentle song of the *línum*



birds, kept by writers. Ultimately the musk of *sumpumnunamnám* fruit fills the air, and a traveller is surely in Samung.

Near the barbican, the plazas are lined with *sámkang* bushes, and the pleasant perfume fills the morning breeze. The bronze figures that grace the rooftops will be obvious to the traveller. These denote the workplace of a fortune-teller. In the afternoon, a traveller can often hear the knell of the castle clock.

Pumungám

Onwards from Samung the traveller can journey north to Pumungám. It is an enjoyable journey. As a traveller enters Lámlangsam, there is a shift in the light, and a golden cast falls across the land. On the verge of the track, horned *ánnámkímmám* graze.

A traveller, entering the immense city, will come across *mámángtunumtun*, beloved for their milk. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear songs of melancholy ecstasy, sung by actors of the surrounding countryside. Eventually the aroma of *imsámáng* trees fills the wind, and a traveller is undeniably in Pumungám.

In the Ancient Quarter of the city, the roadways are paved with basalt. One will see the *amsám* plants. These serve as a warning to

evil spirits. The traveller may typically hear the song of the *lunlín* birds, kept by labourers. Artisans gather here, telling stories and singing.

Nunung

From Pumungám a traveller can go west to Nunung. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking three weeks. When one crosses the border into Límpumpinun, there is a change in the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the countryside. At one point the road crosses a deep chasm. *Ámpinsámmum* flowers grow by the track.

Approaching the gates of famous Nunung a traveller will catch sight of the silver clock-tower of the colossal prison of Pumningím. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, one will hear the sound of the fortress clock. Finally the musk of *imsámáng* plants fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

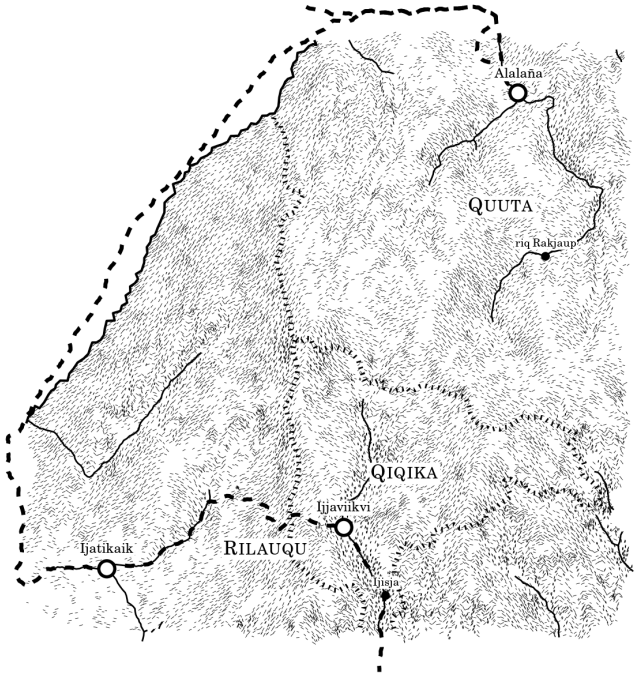
Close to the counting-house of Língámlum, the boulevards are lined with *sámkang* trees, and the delicate blossoms sway in the late night breeze. Farmers flock here, laughing and telling stories. The tame *sanámnang* birds will be conspicuous to a traveller. These act to warn off hostile influences.

Tumpin

Onwards from Nunung a traveller may travel to Tumpin. It is an agreeable journey. Near the side of the road, mighty *mámángtunumtun* graze. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *imsámáng* flowers.

Near to the iniquitous city of Tumpin one can encounter soldiers, talking. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of hopeful dejection, sung by philosophers of the Merchants' District. At last the fragrance of *sumpumnunamnám* fruit fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in Tumpin.

In the Grey Quarter of the city, the streets are paved with marble. In the event that the traveller is so fortunate as to stumble upon the sacred Pam-Limpán parade, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. The idle rich teem here, laughing and talking.



QUUTA TO QIQIKA

Alalaña

The traveller, on reaching the walls of vast Alalaña, may discern the bronze towers of the immense palace of Turuk. Although from so far it may appear elegant, the natives of the city find its architecture distasteful, and avoid it. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the song of the *jalip* birds. In the end the perfume of *aakril* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has truly arrived.

Near the dancing-hall of I ñal Ansina, the squares are lined with *puim* bushes, and the gentle aroma fills the morning wind. If the traveller is ill-fated enough to see an altercation between two lovers, a traveller might be drawn in, and it may be half a day before escape is possible. Scholars crowd here, singing.

Ijatikaik

Leaving Alalaña one may go to Ijatikaik. As this crossing is well-traficked, the traveller can sometimes obtain passage on a small trading boat. In spite of the gales which occasionally torment vessels in this area, the crossing is surprisingly comfortable. A traveller may enjoy a soup made of seaweed and *ilug* bird meat, flavoured with *ninaaganpu* leaves, as eaten by both crew and passengers. The taste is meaty, but clean, mingling with the salty air. Near the side of the boat there are often great numbers of brightly-coloured *upun* fish, shining in the sunlight. The land's edge, the traveller may hear flocks of seabirds, riding the air.

On entering the monumental city one may find *pi*, the sacred animal of Rilauqu. Nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of desolate bliss, sung by the bourgeoisie of the city. Finally the scent of *puim* plants fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Ijatikaik.

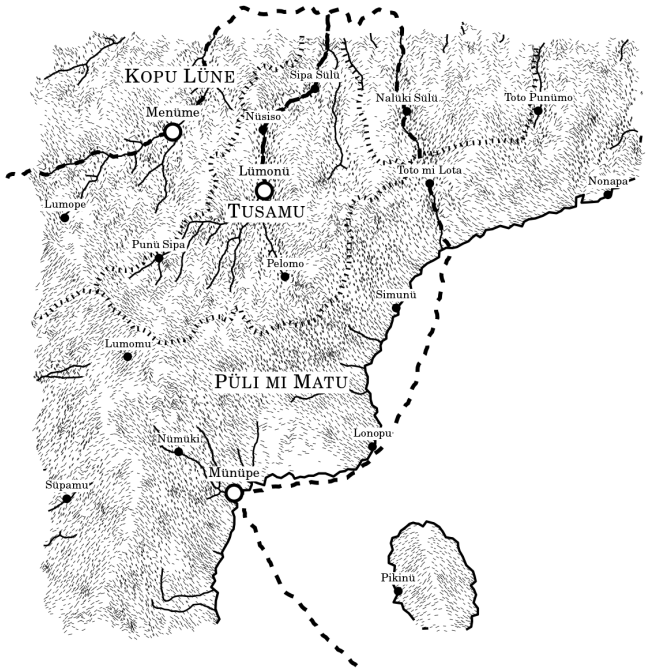
In the Artisans' District of the city, the boulevards are lined with *puijaj* flowers. Philosophers lounge here, showing off on the *pisugipgais* tables. In the afternoon, one can sometimes hear the sweet song of the *jalip* birds, kept by petty criminals. Should a traveller be so unfortunate as to stumble upon a herd of shaggy *pi*, bred for show by the merchants of a nearby village, it can be a most edifying experience.

Ijjaviikvi

From Ijatikaik one can journey to Ijjaviikvi. The route is long, but scenic, taking some days. As the traveller enters Qiqika, the greenery changes, giving way to hedgerows and wild *puim* plants. *Varkuq* trees grow by the roadside. At one point the road crosses a deep gorge.

A traveller, approaching the outskirts of the infamous metropolis of Ijjaviikvi, will catch sight of the basalt spire of the mighty theatre of Riltaan. From such a large distance, a traveller cannot see how scholars steer clear of it, praying and laughing. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear the tolling of the citadel clock. In the end the bouquet of *niimaksi* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the mint of Upturiqlutiq, the back-streets are paved with lead, inlaid with limestone. In the night, a traveller may typically hear songs of merry misery, sung by farmers of the surrounding countryside. A careless traveller will not notice the basalt figurines which ornament the pediments. These call to mind the sickness which not long ago ravaged Ijjaviikvi. Writers



gather here, practising their skill at the game of *pisugipgais*. In the event that a traveller is unlucky enough to catch sight of a game of *impis*, it can be a few hours before escape is possible.

Kopu Lüne to Püli mi Matu

Menüme

Passing into monstrous Menüme the traveller will see priests, telling stories and dancing. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the song of the *tüke* birds, kept by merchants. At last the perfume of *potepü* bushes fills the wind, and one has truly arrived.

Around the university, the alleyways are lined with *kotekü* trees. The caged *sekuno* birds will be clear to the traveller. These signify the shop of an artisan. Should one be so ill-fated as to encounter the idle rich talking, it may be a very humbling experience. The bourgeoisie teem here, laughing.

Lümonü

Onwards from Menüme a traveller can travel north-west to Lümonü. It is a simple journey. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *komusü* plants. When the traveller crosses the border into Tusamu, the foliage changes, giving way to copses of *sünate* flowers and meadows.

The traveller, at the gates of the famous city of Lümonü, can encounter pedlars, setting out their stalls. A little closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the peal of the fortress clock. Eventually the smell of *meso* fruit fills the air, and one is beyond doubt in Lümonü.

In the Blue Quarter, the streets are paved with sandstone, inlaid with marble. Writers mill here, singing and talking. In the event that the traveller is fortunate enough to catch sight of an argument between two lovers, a traveller may be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Münüpe

Leaving Lümonü the traveller may journey north to Münüpe. The road is arduous, but rewarding, taking two weeks. On the track, mighty *tonosa* graze. When a traveller enters Püli mi Matu, there is a variation in the light, and a pale cast falls over the landscape. At one point the route crosses a deep gully.

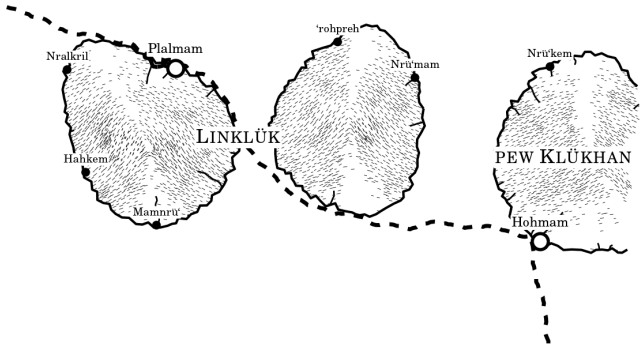
Outside the gargantuan metropolis one can observe the sandstone roof of the infamous barbican of Meseku. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear the balmy song of the *kase* birds, kept by labourers. Finally the aroma of *süpuku* trees fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in Münüpe.

In the Ancient District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *kotekü* plants. If a traveller is so blessed as to see the holy Kunopo ceremony, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. Priests swarm here, showing off on the *letisi* tables.

LINKLÜK TO PEW KLÜKHAN

Plalmam

A traveller, near the walls of vast Plalmam, may find artisans, praying and singing. A little closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of heavy-hearted ecstasy, sung by



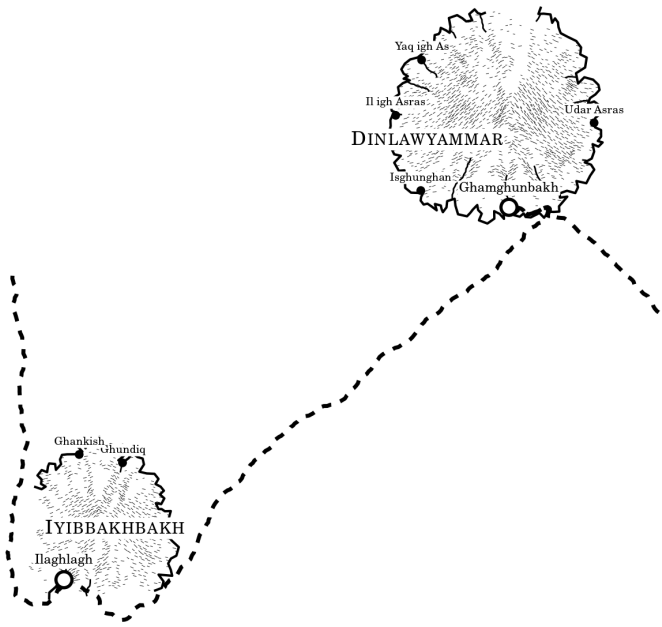
citizens of the Green Quarter. At last the scent of *nrahklap* fruit fills the breeze, and one has undeniably arrived.

Close to the watchtower of Mrülwen, the squares are lined with *nrüwnre'* bushes, and the red leaves whisper in the evening breeze. If the traveller is fortunate enough to stumble upon a game of *hanka'*, one may be drawn in, and it can be half a day before escape is possible. The bourgeoisie flock here, laughing. In the morning, the traveller can occasionally hear the clanging of the theatre clock.

Hohmam

Onwards from Plalmam a traveller may go north-west to Hohmam. Boats are sometimes beset by bad weather conditions near here, but the route is easy. Numerous *krakklip* fish can typically be seen off the sides. The traveller may see flocks of *ki'nol* birds the coast, circling overhead. Sailors and passengers alike eat grilled *lupnrüw* fish.

Near to the great city of Hohmam one may discern the infamous counting-house of Wankün. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the delicate song of the



nuwnrü' birds, kept by actors. Eventually the fragrance of *plen-waw* flowers fills the air, and the traveller is truly in Hohmam.

In the Fishmongers' District, the plazas are paved with bronze, inlaid with granite. Should one be so lucky as to come across petty criminals dancing, it may be three hours before escape is possible. Scholars mill here, trying their luck at the game of *hanka'*. The traveller may often hear the chimes of the fortress clock. A hasty traveller will overlook the *ha'plen* trees. These are a deterrent to malign influences.

IYIBBAKHBAKH TO DINLAWYAMMAR

Ilaghlagh

The traveller, nearing the edge of the iniquitous city, can make out the marble clock-tower of the famous citadel of Imsidaghqat. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one will hear the gentle song of the *qughyawar* birds. Ultimately the scent of *ghaghghak* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has surely arrived.

In the vicinity of the watchtower, the boulevards are paved

with ivory. A traveller can occasionally hear songs of joyous sadness, sung by labourers of a nearby village. The marble medallions that decorate the balustrades will be easy to see to one. These indicate the place of business of a doctor. Farmers teem here, telling stories and singing. Should a traveller be unlucky enough to see a herd of *udmarsiw*, the national animal of Iyibbakhbakh, it can be an educational experience.

Ghamghunbakh

From Ilaghlagh the traveller can travel south-west to Ghamghunbakh. One will enjoy a hearty broth made of seaweed and turtle meat, spiced with *lawshad* berries, as eaten by both fishermen and passengers. The nutty flavour is enchanting. In the water nearby there are typically turquoise *ir* fish, barely visible beneath the surf. The shore, a traveller can hear seabirds.

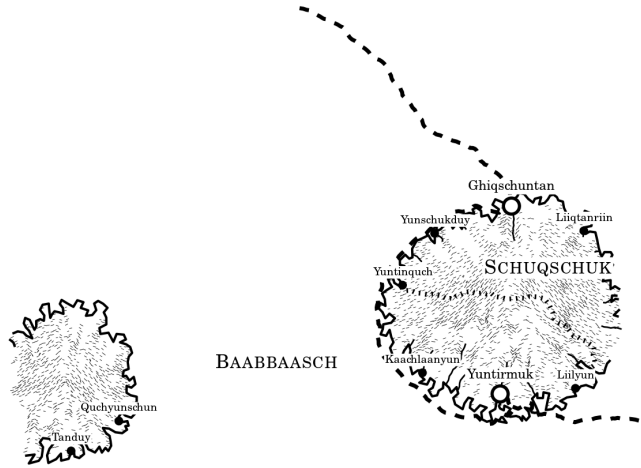
Passing into monumental Ghamghunbakh one will come across shaggy *arghamsiw*, bred for work by the citizens of Ghamghunbakh. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sound of the bastion clock. In the end the smell of *khilghagh* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Ghamghunbakh.

In the Merchants' Quarter of the city, the streets are lined with *alwughrik* bushes, and the pleasant bouquet fills the early afternoon wind. In the evening, one may often hear songs of doleful joy, sung by writers of the city. A traveller will be inspired by the tame *abyaw* birds. These function as a memento of the plague which long ago tormented the surrounding countryside. Petty criminals throng here, practising their skill on the *yamghumbin* court. In the event that the traveller is so fortunate as to encounter actors telling stories, the traveller might be drawn in, and find it tricky to escape.

SCHUQSCHUK TO BAABBAASCH

Ghiqschuntan

A traveller, outside the famed city of Ghiqschuntan, will catch sight of the glistening lookout of the celebrated temple of Yiimtin. While from here it looks magnificent, the denizens of Ghiqschuntan find its architecture disagreeable, and shun it. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the balmy song of



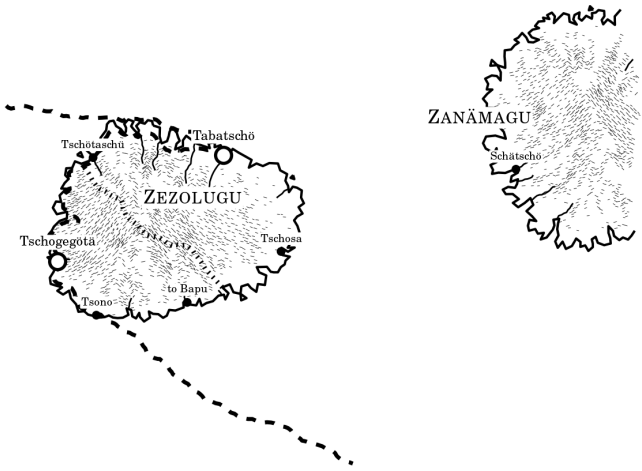
the *wultin* birds, kept by the idle rich. Eventually the fragrance of *yaawmughsaw* flowers fills the breeze, and a traveller has truly arrived.

Near the prison of Yiimmughligh, the back-streets are paved with limestone. An inattentive observer will fail to see the *daatkitschaktin* bushes. These deter unwanted spirits. In the afternoon, one can usually hear the clanging of the palace clock.

Yuntirmuk

Leaving Ghiqschuntan the traveller can travel to Yuntirmuk. One can typically find space on a small fishing vessel. Even though the route is remarkably pleasant, squalls sometimes trouble vessels in these waters. A traveller can see flocks of *taanbiinrib* birds the coast, riding the air. The traveller can occasionally see, near the side of the boat, vermillion *schurschakghulqiim* fish.

On reaching the walls of the iniquitous metropolis a traveller may stumble upon a series of fishmongers, setting out their stalls. Closer to the centre of the city, one will hear songs of buoyant sadness, sung by scholars of Yuntirmuk. Finally the musk of *qiqyaawschukschuk* trees fills the wind, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.



In the Tailors' Quarter of the city, the roadways are lined with *yaawmughsaw* plants, and the golden petals sway in the breeze. If a traveller is unfortunate enough to see a quarrel between two lovers, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. One may often hear the sweet song of the *yuwbun* birds. The stone gargoyles which decorate the doorways will be apparent to the traveller. These commemorate the pestilence which not long ago engulfed the surrounding countryside. Farmers congregate here, dancing.

ZEZOLUGU TO ZANÄMAGU

Tabatschö

The traveller, on entering tremendous Tabatschö, may discern the emerald tower of the colossal counting-house of Gadaka. From so far, a traveller has no way to espy how merchants gather near its diamond base, talking and singing. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear the striking of the watchtower clock. At last the bouquet of *tschaze* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Tabatschö.

Close to the theatre, the alleyways are paved with marble. Artisans crowd here, praying. In the late evening, a traveller can usually hear songs of sombre delight, sung by the idle rich of a nearby village.

Tschogegötä

Onwards from Tabatschö one may journey north-east to Tschogegötä. It is a pleasant journey. Along the way the road crosses a broad rift, spotted with *schebi* trees. *Sazatsuzo* flowers grow by the roadside. As the traveller crosses the border into Zanämagu, the vegetation changes, giving way to scrubland and open fields.

Approaching the edge of the famous city of Tschogegötä a traveller can come across horned *tüba*, valued for their horns. Nearer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the gentle song of the *bädegü* birds, kept by soldiers. Eventually the smell of *zögekö* bushes fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in Tschogegötä.

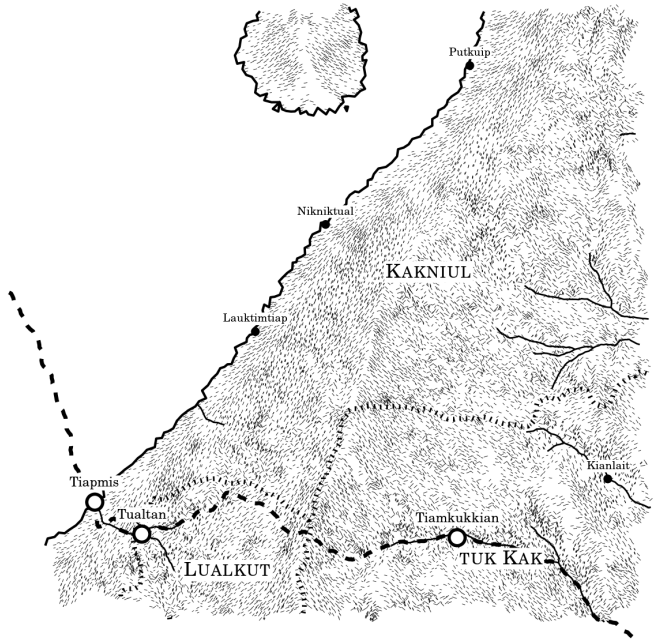
In the Artisans' District of the city, the plazas are lined with *düge* plants. The traveller may sometimes hear songs of blissful gloom, sung by scholars of Tschogegötä. In the event that a traveller is so unlucky as to stumble upon a herd of *tüba*, the sacred animal of Zanämagu, it may be a most educational experience. Citizens flock here, dancing and telling stories.

KAKNIUL TO TUK KAK

Tiapmis

A traveller, entering great Tiapmis, can make out the ivory vaulted roof of the gargantuan castle of Laukpunlin. Despite the fact that at this distance it may seem quaint, the citizens of the city find its form repellent, and stay away from it. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the bells of the dancing-hall clock. Finally the aroma of *kuiptimlauklintip* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has surely arrived.

Around the watchtower, the back-streets are paved with *tunsauspiut* stone, inlaid with bronze. Should a traveller be lucky enough to find a game of *kaitpal*, the traveller may be drawn in, and unable to leave. Actors swarm here, trying their luck at *tanlinpalnikpuak*.

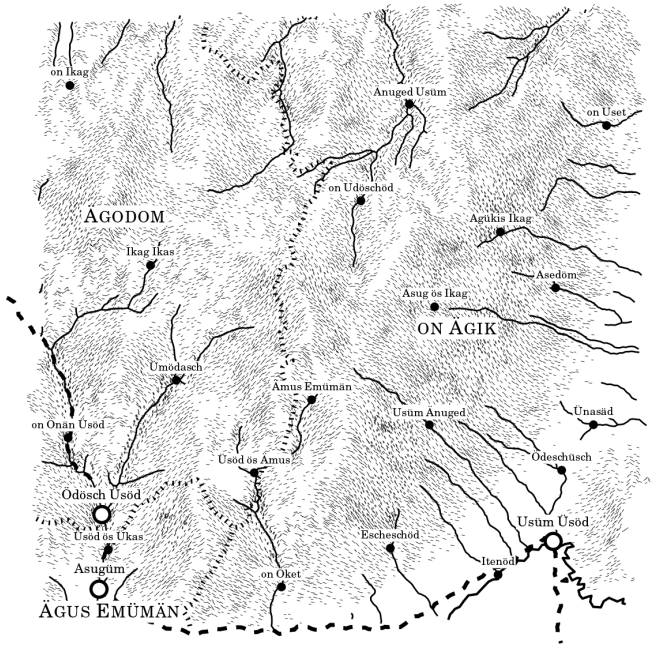


Tualtan

Leaving Tiapmis one can go to Tualtan. As a traveller enters Lualkut, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls across the terrain. At one point the track crosses a deep canyon. Near the bank of the road, *sauspukmuin* graze.

Nearing the gates of infamous Tualtan one may encounter scattered goldsmiths, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the balmy song of the *tium* birds, kept by labourers. In the end the scent of *suaslinniulnutlat* bushes fills the breeze, and a traveller is undeniably in Tualtan.

In the Ancient Quarter of the city, the squares are lined with *suaspiutpuak* flowers, and the blue leaves rustle in the early morning wind. Farmers lounge here, talking. In the night, the traveller can typically hear songs of mournful joy, sung by actors of the Green District. Should a traveller be ill-fated enough to see a squabble between two lovers, it may be two hours before escape is possible. A distracted visitor will miss the *naukpiastuilmissan* plants. These denote the workplace of a fortune-teller.



Tiamkukkian

From Tualtan one may journey to Tiamkukkian. The track is long, but rewarding, taking several days. When a traveller crosses the border into tuk Kak, the greenery changes, giving way to pastures and meadows. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *tutlinkiut* flowers.

The traveller, on entering the city, will catch sight of *nuklinnutsumlaut*, beloved for their meat. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *kilpipnaumkiatmas* birds. Ultimately the aroma of *luallaitsiaplaukmiul* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has truly arrived.

Near the palace of Nuiktiuk, the roadways are paved with obsidian, inlaid with marble. In the afternoon, one can usually hear songs of joyous dejection, sung by philosophers of the city. Priests mill here, showing off at the game of *tanlinpalnikpuak*. In the event that the traveller is so charmed as to stumble upon merchants singing, it can be a humbling experience.

Ägodom to on Ägik

Ödösch Üsöd

At the outskirts of the monumental city of Ödösch Üsöd one will observe the vast citadel of Ikukäs. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the knell of the counting-house clock. At last the smell of *adätis* plants fills the breeze, and one is beyond doubt in Ödösch Üsöd.

In the Fishmongers' Quarter, the plazas are lined with *otät* bushes, and the delicate musk fills the late morning wind. If the traveller is unlucky enough to see a fight between two lovers, the traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. Artisans flock here, praying and talking. The caged *ekan* birds will be clear. These act as a reminder of the sickness which twenty years ago beset a nearby village. A traveller may often hear the song of the *edudeg* birds, kept by writers.

Asugüm

Onwards from Ödösch Üsöd one can travel north to Asugüm. The route is busy, and the journey takes but half a day. As a traveller enters Ägus Emümän, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls over the countryside. On the side of the route, *ätotim* trees grow. At one point the track crosses a broad valley.

Outside the great city the traveller can come across priests, practising their skill on the *ökog* board. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear songs of plaintive delight, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. In the end the smell of *ugunesch* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the university of On Ides, the alleyways are paved with granite, inlaid with basalt. In the early morning, a traveller may sometimes hear the song of the *edötug* birds, kept by merchants. Should the traveller be so ill-fated as to find a game of *äsedok*, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Usüm Üsöd

Leaving Asugüm one may go west to Usüm Üsöd. The road is arduous, but scenic, taking three weeks. Hairy *adenin* graze by the roadside. Along the way the route crosses a deep chasm. When a traveller crosses into on Ägik, the vegetation changes, giving way to groves of *otät* flowers and wild *adätis* bushes.

A traveller, approaching the walls of celebrated Usüm Üsöd, can espy the colossal prison of Änuk ös Ides. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of exuberant sadness, sung by the bourgeoisie of Usüm Üsöd. Ultimately the fragrance of *adätis* plants fills the wind, and one is surely in Usüm Üsöd.

In the Goldsmiths' District, the roadways are lined with *ätotim* flowers, and the yellow blossoms shimmer in the air. The ivory statues that grace the lintels will be conspicuous. These are a caution to evil spirits. In the afternoon, a traveller can typically hear the sound of the theatre clock. Farmers teem here, laughing. If a traveller is charmed enough to see priests singing, it may be half a day before escape is possible.

Ngwyg to Nyoksuj

Ngap-Kyyg

Passing into the infamous city of Ngap-Kyyg one will encounter a series of fruit-sellers, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the sweet song of the *nênkwun* birds, kept by artisans. Finally the bouquet of *twêrjuq* fruit fills the wind, and one has without a doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the palace, the boulevards are paved with stone, inlaid with obsidian. Should a traveller be so lucky as to stumble upon the revered Pâskweg ritual, it may be a most instructive experience. A traveller will take note of the *vwykvij* trees. These call to mind the war which recently devastated the city. Actors swarm here, showing off at the game of *jruj*.

Tlujngaptlyt

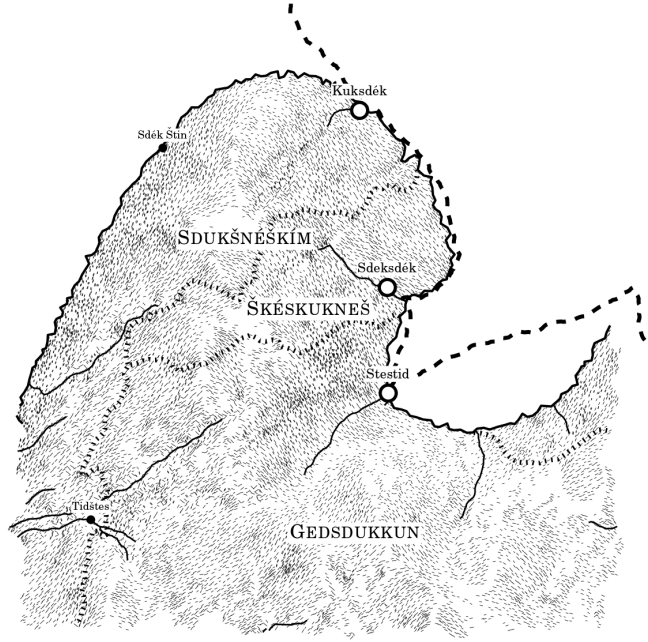
From Ngap-Kyyg the traveller can journey north-west to Tlujngaptlyt. Many craft sail these waters, and one can often charter a small fishing vessel. By the side of the boat shoals of *sujtâkvlat* fish may typically be observed, moving in unison. Boats are plagued by storms in this area.

The traveller, near the outskirts of the city, will catch sight of the ruby spire of the famous castle of Jyaqqluntlyt. Closer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear songs of doleful bliss, sung by citizens of Tlujngaptlyt. Eventually the aroma of *vwyk* bushes fills the air, and a traveller is truly in Tlujngaptlyt.

In the Tailors' Quarter of the city, the streets are lined with *vwykvlat* flowers, and the balmy fragrance fills the late night breeze. Labourers flock here, dancing and praying. The tame *nênkwun* birds will be almost impossible to miss. These betoken the shop of a smith. In the early morning, one can sometimes hear the peal of the fortress clock.

poq-Ngap

Leaving Tlujngaptlyt the traveller may travel north-west to poq-Ngap. The crossing is busy, so a traveller can often obtain passage on a small trading ship. The land's edge flocks of seabirds



can sometimes be spotted, circling overhead. The route is pleasant, despite the foul weather conditions which occasionally beset ships.

On entering immense poq-Ngap one may catch sight of hawkers, setting out their stalls. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will hear songs of heavy-hearted ecstasy, sung by criminals of the Blue District. In the end the bouquet of *twêrjuq* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Near the dancing-hall of Mygngyq-Ngyq, the squares are paved with *kêj* stone, inlaid with sandstone. One will see the obsidian carvings which ornament the walls. These serve to warn off hostile influences. In the event that a traveller is so fortunate as to find a herd of shaggy *susqrujkyyp*, bred for racing by the farmers of the city, it can be a few hours before escape is possible. The traveller may usually hear the gentle song of the *nênkwun* birds, kept by scholars.

SDUKŠNÉŠKÍM TO GEDSDUKKUN

Kuksdék

A traveller, nearing the gates of the monstrous city, may see the basalt spires of the mighty palace of Kátšnendéš. At such a great distance, a traveller cannot make out how artisans avoid it, laughing. Closer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear songs of merry melancholy, sung by the bourgeoisie of Kuksdék. Ultimately the musk of *kašmoš* trees fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Kuksdék.

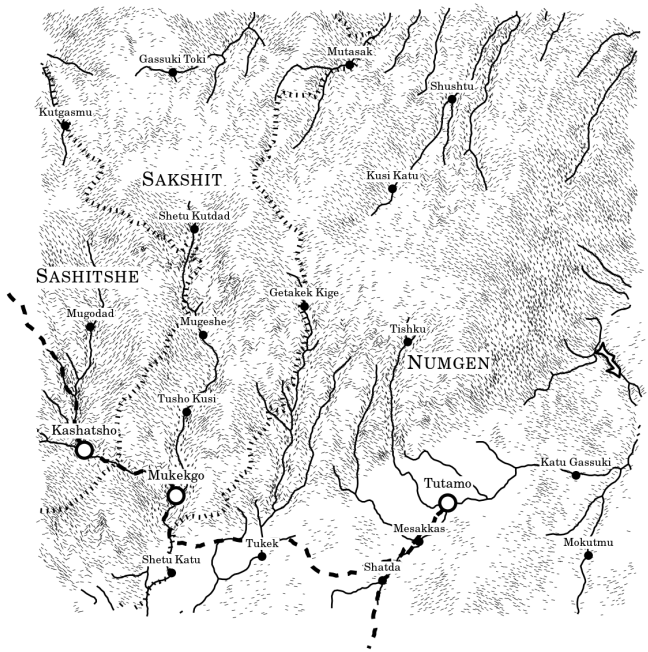
In the New Quarter of the city, the back-streets are lined with *šteskaškuk* flowers. An inattentive traveller will not notice the *gímskatšmátkag* plants. These indicate the home of an apothecary. A traveller can typically hear the chimes of the barbican clock. Writers congregate here, telling stories and praying. Should one be blessed enough to see an argument between two lovers, the traveller may be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape.

Sdeksdék

From Kuksdék a traveller can go north to Sdeksdék. The crew subsist on salted turtle meat. The taste is sour, but rich. In these waters, storms plague vessels, but the crossing is very safe.

Passing into the vast metropolis of Sdeksdék the traveller can find priests, laughing. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear songs of buoyant melancholy, sung by labourers of the surrounding countryside. Finally the smell of *stídsed* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

Around the theatre of Gom Kagsed, the boulevards are paved with granite. Scholars lounge here, trying their luck on the *skatkukmándéšštin* field. In the event that one is unfortunate enough to come across merchants talking, it can be an educational experience. The caged *šták* birds will be obvious to the traveller. These serve as a warning to harmful influences.



Štestid

Onwards from Sdeksdék the traveller may travel north to Štestid. A traveller can often find space on a small boat. The shore, one may hear *mošštákgedtemneš* birds, riding the wind. Though the route is quite easy, craft are troubled by squalls near here.

A traveller, on reaching the edge of the city of Štestid, can espy the colossal bastion of Gom Gomtem. Even though from here it looks enchanting, people of Štestid find its architecture unsavoury, and hide from it. Closer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the song of the *šták* birds, kept by farmers. Eventually the aroma of *stídsed* fruit fills the air, and one is undeniably in Štestid.

In the Temple District of the city, the squares are paved with bronze, inlaid with obsidian. Philosophers gather here, praying and telling stories. If the traveller is so unlucky as to encounter a herd of *maškímškíškes*, prized for their leather, one might be drawn in, and it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Sashitshe to Numgen

Kashatsho

Near to Kashatsho the traveller may catch sight of the obsidian roof of the celebrated watchtower of Daskeg. From this distance, a traveller has no way to observe how scholars lounge by it, laughing. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will hear the tolling of the theatre clock. In the end the perfume of *gemasak* bushes fills the wind, and one has surely arrived.

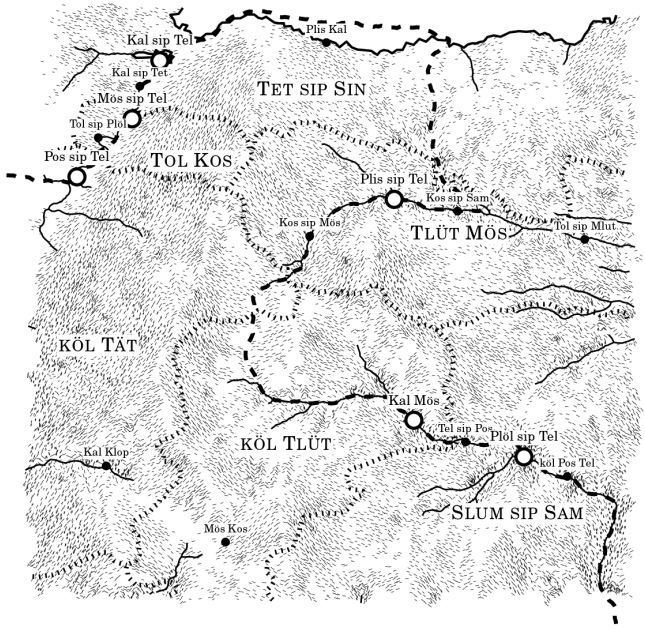
Close to the university of Te Shekaksi, the roadways are lined with *tinkeg* plants, and the delicate fragrance fills the late evening air. Should a traveller be so fortunate as to see the intricate Sita Komgan procession, it can be three hours before escape is possible. In the afternoon, one may occasionally hear the sound of the castle clock. Artisans throng here, practising their skill on the *katamak* court.

Mukekgo

From Kashatsho the traveller can journey north-west to Mukekgo. As a traveller enters Sakshit, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls upon the land. Near the road, horned *todantad* graze. At one point the track crosses a deep gully.

Entering the tremendous city a traveller will stumble upon shaggy *tadshodek*, the national animal of Sakshit. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear songs of desolate exuberance, sung by the bourgeoisie of a nearby village. Finally the smell of *gemasak* trees fills the breeze, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Merchants' Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with ivory, inlaid with limestone. The lead medallions that grace the eaves will be apparent to the traveller. These function as a relic of the plague which long ago troubled the surrounding countryside. Priests swarm here, dancing. In the event that one is charmed enough to catch sight of petty criminals talking, it may be a very edifying experience. A traveller can typically hear songs of elegiac delight, sung by labourers of the city.



Tutamo

Onwards from Mukekgo one may go to Tutamo. *Magangas* flowers grow on the road. When the traveller crosses into Numgen, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and open fields. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *masim* plants.

The traveller, near the edge of the great city of Tutamo, may find the idle rich, singing and talking. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the sweet song of the *maskeg* birds, kept by soldiers. Ultimately the bouquet of *kane* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Tutamo.

In the vicinity of the prison, the plazas are lined with *tinkeg* bushes, and the fragrant petals sway in the air. If the traveller is so unfortunate as to see an altercation between two lovers, one may be drawn in, and unable to leave. In the night, the traveller may often hear the striking of the mint clock. Farmers mill here, showing off at the game of *samak*. A traveller will notice the *gemasak* bushes. These denote the workplace of an artisan.

KÖL TÄT TO SLUM SIP SAM

Pos sip Tel

On entering the city a traveller can espy the infamous dancing-hall of Let sip Plöl. Although from so far it may look magnificent, the denizens of the city find its form disagreeable, and stay away from it. Closer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear the pleasant song of the *küm* birds. Eventually the fragrance of *kok* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has truly arrived.

In the Fishmongers' District of the city, the streets are lined with *kok* flowers, and the delicate smell fills the early evening air. In the event that the traveller is blessed enough to stumble upon the famous Köl Mlüs ritual, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. A hasty visitor will overlook the tame *sok* birds. These commemorate the plague which in times past ravaged Pos sip Tel. A traveller can usually hear songs of mirthful dejection, sung by writers of the Artisans' District. The bourgeoisie gather here, telling stories.

Mös sip Tel

Leaving Pos sip Tel one can travel south-west to Mös sip Tel. At one point the road crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *kok* flowers. As the traveller enters Tol Kos, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls over the terrain. Horned *kit* graze by the roadside.

A traveller, approaching the outskirts of the famed city, will catch sight of fishmongers, setting out their stalls. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the clanging of the fortress clock. In the end the scent of *pet* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Mös sip Tel.

Close to the market-hall of Mös Sin, the squares are paved with *not* stone. In the late afternoon, one may sometimes hear the gentle song of the *sok* birds, kept by philosophers. Should a traveller be so ill-fated as to encounter a herd of mighty *kit*, bred for show by the actors of a nearby village, it can be half a day before escape is possible.

Kal sip Tel

From Mös sip Tel one may go to Kal sip Tel. The route is well-trodden, and the journey takes but a couple of hours. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression. When the traveller crosses into Tet sip Sin, the greenery changes, giving way to woods of *kok* bushes and meadows. Near the edge of the track, *nlek* trees grow.

The traveller, at the edge of colossal Kal sip Tel, can catch sight of the iniquitous palace of Nlon Tol. From here, a traveller is unable to make out how priests avoid it, dancing and praying. A little closer to the heart of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the chimes of the bastion clock. At last the musk of *kok* plants fills the breeze, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

Near the theatre, the streets are lined with *tlot* trees, and the blue leaves whisper in the early morning wind. In the night, the traveller may occasionally hear songs of mournful glee, sung by the idle rich of the city. Scholars congregate here, practising their skill at the game of *klun*. If one is lucky enough to stumble upon a game of *nlap*, it can be an instructive experience. The stone figurines which adorn the pediments will be hard to miss to a traveller. These act to ward off malign spirits.

Plis sip Tel

Onwards from Kal sip Tel the traveller can journey north-west to Plis sip Tel. It is an agreeable journey. *Nlek* flowers grow by the fringe of the road. At one point the route crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *släs* bushes. As a traveller crosses the border into Tlüt Mös, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls upon the countryside.

Outside the metropolis of Plis sip Tel one may see the gargantuan citadel of Kos Plöl. While from so far it may seem alluring, the people of Plis sip Tel find its bulk repellent, and steer clear of it. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the peal of the watchtower clock. Finally the scent of *pet* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Plis sip Tel.

In the Goldsmiths' Quarter of the city, the back-streets are paved with sandstone, inlaid with bronze. Should one be so fortunate as to catch sight of a fight between two lovers, one might be drawn in, and find it tricky to escape. Soldiers lounge here, talking. In the evening, a traveller can usually hear the delicate song of the *küm* birds, kept by farmers.

Kal Mös

Leaving Plis sip Tel the traveller may travel north to Kal Mös. The track is long, but scenic, taking many days. On the roadside, horned *kit* graze. As a traveller enters köl Tlüt, the foliage changes, giving way to hedgerows and pastures. Along the way the route crosses a broad rift.

A traveller, passing into the vast city, can come across *klas*, the sacred animal of köl Tlüt. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of joyous gloom, sung by writers of Kal Mös. Eventually the fragrance of *tlot* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has surely arrived.

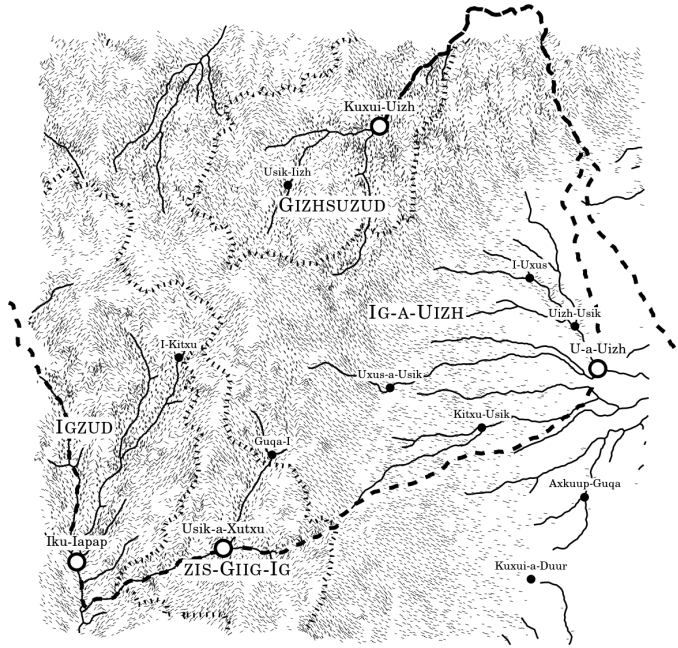
Around the temple, the plazas are paved with limestone, inlaid with granite. One will be impressed by the caged *sok* birds. These signify the place of business of a doctor. Actors gather here, trying their luck on the *klun* board. The traveller can occasionally hear songs of melancholy exuberance, sung by merchants of the surrounding countryside.

Plöl sip Tel

From Kal Mös a traveller can go west to Plöl sip Tel. Hairy *klas* graze near the track. Along the way the route crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *nlek* bushes. When one enters Slum sip Sam, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls across the terrain.

Approaching the walls of tremendous Plöl sip Tel a traveller will see the mighty barbican of Tlol Let. At such a large distance, the traveller cannot catch sight of how priests teem near it, singing and dancing. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear the balmy song of the *küm* birds. In the end the aroma of *man* fruit fills the wind, and one is without a doubt in Plöl sip Tel.

In the Merchants' District, the alleyways are lined with *släs* trees, and the red petals shimmer in the morning air. In the night, a traveller may usually hear the clanging of the dancing-hall clock. The *kok* flowers will be clear. These act as a reminder of the pestilence which in times past devastated the Blue Quarter. Philosophers mill here, praying.



IGZUD TO GIZHSUZUD

Iku-Iapap

The traveller, near to the famed city of Iku-Iapap, may encounter farmers, showing off on the *kadi* court. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will hear songs of gleeful misery, sung by soldiers of the city. At last the smell of *xutrut* bushes fills the breeze, and one has truly arrived.

Near the market-hall of Um-a-Us, the boulevards are lined with *rus* plants, and the sweet scent fills the late afternoon air. Labourers crowd here, laughing. The *pubrul* stone statues which ornament the walls will be conspicuous. These are in memory of the sickness which twenty years ago troubled a nearby village. If one is unfortunate enough to catch sight of a herd of hairy *put*, prized for their milk, it may be an educational experience.

Usik-a-Xutxu

Onwards from Iku-Iapap a traveller may journey to Usik-a-Xutxu. At one point the road crosses a broad depression, spotted with *rusaxlu* trees. When the traveller crosses the border into zis-Giig-Ig, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *xutrut* flowers and pastures. By the verge of the route, *upizhug* trees grow.

On reaching the gates of the monstrous city a traveller can see crowds of silversmiths, hawking their wares. A little closer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear the tolling of the university clock. Eventually the perfume of *mi* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Usik-a-Xutxu.

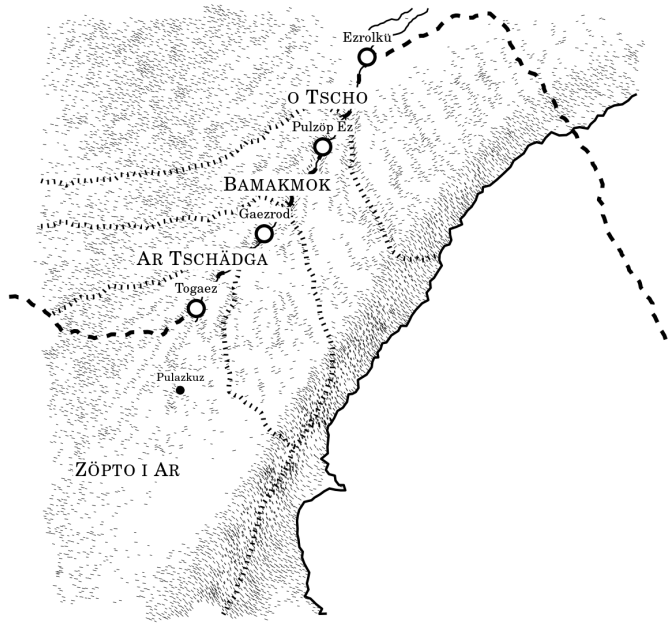
In the Green Quarter of the city, the back-streets are paved with basalt, inlaid with ivory. In the event that one is so ill-fated as to come across the sacred Tar-a-Lutar ceremony, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. Artisans congregate here, telling stories and dancing. A careless observer will miss the caged *un* birds. These are a caution to unwanted spirits. In the early afternoon, a traveller may sometimes hear songs of desolate bliss, sung by petty criminals of the surrounding countryside.

U-a-Uizh

Leaving Usik-a-Xutxu the traveller can go south-west to U-a-Uizh. It is a delightful journey. As one enters Ig-a-Uizh, the vegetation changes, giving way to open fields and clumps of *rus* bushes. *Rusaxlu* plants grow on the track. At one point the road crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *rut* flowers.

A traveller, passing into the city of U-a-Uizh, may observe the chryselephantine towers of the famous citadel of Ap-Appizh. Though from this distance it seems beautiful, the citizens of the city find its architecture obscene, and avoid it. Somewhat nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the knell of the dancing-hall clock. In the end the bouquet of *mi* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

Close to the mint, the roadways are lined with *rusaxlu* bushes. In the morning, the traveller can often hear songs of hopeful gloom, sung by scholars of U-a-Uizh. Should a traveller be so unfortunate as to find a herd of mighty *urkuquk*, bred for work by the merchants of a nearby village, it can be a most humbling experience. Labourers cluster here, talking and dancing. One will see the bronze carvings that grace the lintels. These betoken the shop of a smith.



Kuxui-Uizh

Onwards from U-a-Uizh a traveller may travel south-east to Kuxui-Uizh. The route is arduous, but rewarding, taking several weeks. By the roadside, *quk* graze. Along the way the road crosses a deep gully, spotted with *rut* plants. As the traveller crosses the border into Gizhsuzud, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls over the land.

At the outskirts of the gargantuan city one can espy the copper clock-tower of the celebrated watchtower of Um-a-Xubduum. Closer to the heart of the city, one will begin to hear the song of the *pix* birds, kept by criminals. Finally the scent of *rusaxlu* bushes fills the air, and a traveller is surely in Kuxui-Uizh.

In the Artisans' District of the city, the streets are paved with stone, inlaid with sandstone. In the late night, the traveller may occasionally hear the chimes of the palace clock. In the event that a traveller is ill-fated enough to see a quarrel between two lovers, one may be drawn in, and it can be two hours before escape is possible. The *rus* trees will be obvious. These serve as a vestige of the war which not long ago engulfed the surrounding countryside. The idle rich gather here, praying.

Zöpto i Ar to o Tscho

Togaez

The traveller, on entering immense Togaez, can find artisans, practising their skill at the game of *schopö*. A little nearer to the heart of the city, one will hear songs of plaintive ecstasy, sung by scholars of the city. Ultimately the smell of *üts* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

Around the temple, the alleyways are lined with *zotsüts* flowers, and the delicate fragrance fills the early evening wind. Philosophers cluster here, laughing and telling stories. The traveller can sometimes hear songs of mirthful dejection, sung by priests of Togaez. The tame *ip* birds will be easy to see to the traveller. These repel harmful influences. If one is fortunate enough to catch sight of the holy Eschakrol dance, it may be half a day before escape is possible.

Gaezrod

Leaving Togaez a traveller can journey to Gaezrod. The track is busy, and the journey takes but an afternoon. At one point the road crosses a broad valley, spotted with *üts* trees. *Ütsgoob* bushes grow near the bank of the track. When one enters Ar Tschädga, there is a shift in the light, and a pale cast falls upon the landscape.

Nearing the walls of the tremendous city of Gaezrod a traveller may stumble upon horned *a*, bred for racing by the citizens of the Grey Quarter. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the pleasant song of the *tomkü* birds, kept by the bourgeoisie. Finally the bouquet of *zotszöpam* fruit fills the air, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Tailors' District of the city, the plazas are paved with bronze. Labourers lounge here, trying their luck on the *schopö* field. A distracted traveller will fail to see the *da* plants. These call to mind the plague which recently tormented the surrounding countryside. Should the traveller be so unfortunate as to come across scholars singing, it may be a very instructive experience. In the morning, a traveller may typically hear the bells of the market-hall clock.

Pulzöp Ez

From Gaezrod one may go to Pulzöp Ez. It is a smooth journey. On the side of the route, hairy *a* graze. Along the way the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *zotsüts* trees. As a traveller crosses into Bamakmok, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and pastures.

A traveller, outside the great city, will make out the limestone lookout of the monstrous prison of Ponü i Gala. From here, one has no way to observe how farmers shun it. Somewhat closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the gentle song of the *ip* birds, kept by actors. Eventually the smell of *amö* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is undoubtedly in Pulzöp Ez.

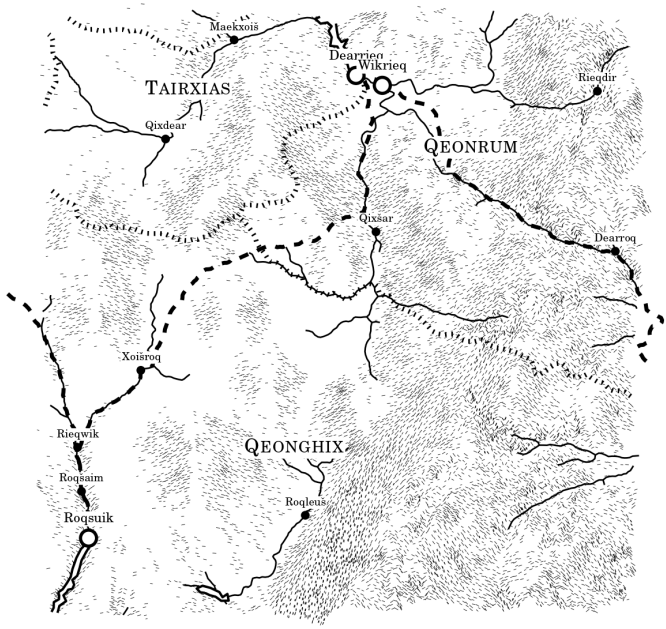
Near the fortress of Nüzusga, the roadways are lined with *sommä* flowers, and the fragrant leaves rustle in the wind. Philosophers congregate here, laughing. In the event that one is charmed enough to stumble upon a herd of mighty *aörga*, the sacred animal of Bamakmok, a traveller might be drawn in, and find it almost impossible to escape. In the evening, one can usually hear the peal of the market-hall clock. The granite gargoyles which adorn the archways will be apparent to a traveller. These indicate the workplace of an artisan.

Ezrolkü

From Pulzöp Ez the traveller can travel to Ezrolkü. The road is crowded, and the journey takes but three hours. At one point the route crosses a deep canyon. *Zotsüts* bushes grow by the track. When the traveller enters o Tscho, there is a change in the light, and a bluish cast falls across the countryside.

Near the edge of famed Ezrolkü a traveller will find horned *ommotsol*, bred for show by the the bourgeoisie of Ezrolkü. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of sorrowful delight, sung by criminals of the Temple Quarter. In the end the perfume of *üts* flowers fills the breeze, and a traveller is truly in Ezrolkü.

In the Merchants' District, the back-streets are paved with basalt, inlaid with stone. One may often hear the sweet song of the *ip* birds. Writers flock here, practising their skill at the game of *scho*. If the traveller is so unlucky as to catch sight of scholars talking, it may be a very edifying experience. One will notice the tame *ipschakkuz* birds. These act as a warning to evil influences.



QEONGHIX TO QEONRUM

Roqsuik

The traveller, entering the mighty metropolis of Roqsuik, can discern the bronze tower of the gargantuan bastion of Sayruq. Despite the fact that from so far it may appear enchanting, the denizens of Roqsuik find its form unsavoury, and hide from it. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the sound of the counting-house clock. Ultimately the aroma of *babrum* fruit fills the wind, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the university of Meidqiuy, the roadways are paved with ivory, inlaid with bronze. Should the traveller be blessed enough to come across a game of *šarrex*, the traveller may be drawn in, and it can be half a day before escape is possible. Artisans gather here, telling stories. In the morning, one can occasionally hear songs of ecstatic misery, sung by merchants of a nearby village. The granite figures that ornament the eaves will

be hard to miss to a traveller. These denote the place of business of an apothecary.

Dearrieq

Leaving Roqsuik the traveller may travel to Dearrieq. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking two days. Near the roadside, shaggy *timšaim* graze. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley, spotted with *šioxmiar* plants.

At the gates of the famous city of Dearrieq one can stumble upon the bourgeoisie, singing and dancing. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the clanging of the barbican clock. At last the bouquet of *quikmiar* bushes fills the air, and a traveller is without a doubt in Dearrieq.

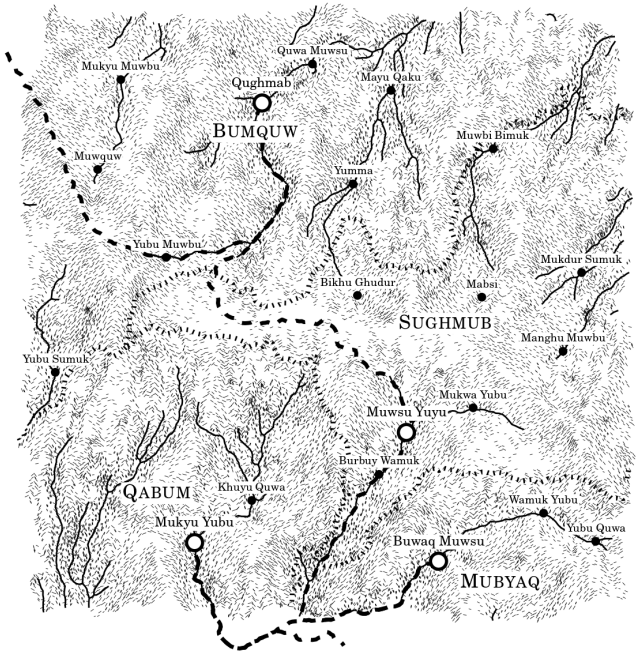
In the Green Quarter of the city, the boulevards are lined with *leurxoiš* trees. Petty criminals swarm here, talking. One can typically hear songs of ebullient gloom, sung by scholars of the city. A distracted observer will miss the *ghiešleur* plants. These are a memento of the revolution which long ago beset the surrounding countryside.

Wikrieq

Onwards from Dearrieq a traveller can journey west to Wikrieq. At one point the road crosses a deep gorge. As one enters Qeonrum, the greenery changes, giving way to copses of *šioxmiar* flowers and wild *leursuis* plants.

A traveller, on entering the city, may see the immense citadel of Teoywik. From here, the traveller cannot observe how citizens lounge by its diamond door. Closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the delicate song of the *rioldir* birds, kept by merchants. In the end the scent of *babghieš* fruit fills the breeze, and one has truly arrived.

Around the dancing-hall of Leušmeid, the back-streets are paved with *boenrial* stone, inlaid with limestone. In the late afternoon, the traveller may often hear songs of mournful glee, sung by actors of a nearby village. In the event that a traveller is so unfortunate as to see the intricate Qiatsiuy procession, it may be a few hours before escape is possible. The idle rich crowd here, praying and telling stories. The *leurxoiš* flowers will be clear to one. These serve to ward off unwanted spirits.



BUMQUW TO QABUM

Qughmab

Near the outskirts of Qughmab a traveller may find scattered hawkers, setting out their stalls. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will hear the pleasant song of the *rimwu* birds, kept by scholars. Ultimately the smell of *shitu* plants fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Qughmab.

In the Red District, the plazas are lined with *kawaq* flowers, and the balmy scent fills the early night wind. If a traveller is so unlucky as to encounter an argument between two lovers, it can be a most instructive experience. Labourers cluster here, showing off at *lilmi*.

Muwsu Yuyu

Leaving Qughmab the traveller may go north-west to Muwsu Yuyu. It is a pleasant journey. When one crosses into Sughmub, there is a variation in the light, and a pale cast falls over the terrain. Along the way the track crosses a broad rift, spotted with *shuqugh* trees. *Shitu* bushes grow by the roadside.

Passing into the colossal metropolis the traveller can discern the crystal clock-tower of the famed watchtower of Kikuw Kuwdis. Even though at such a great distance it looks elegant, the natives of the city find its bulk disagreeable, and shun it. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the bells of the university clock. In the end the perfume of *siwum* fruit fills the wind, and one has surely arrived.

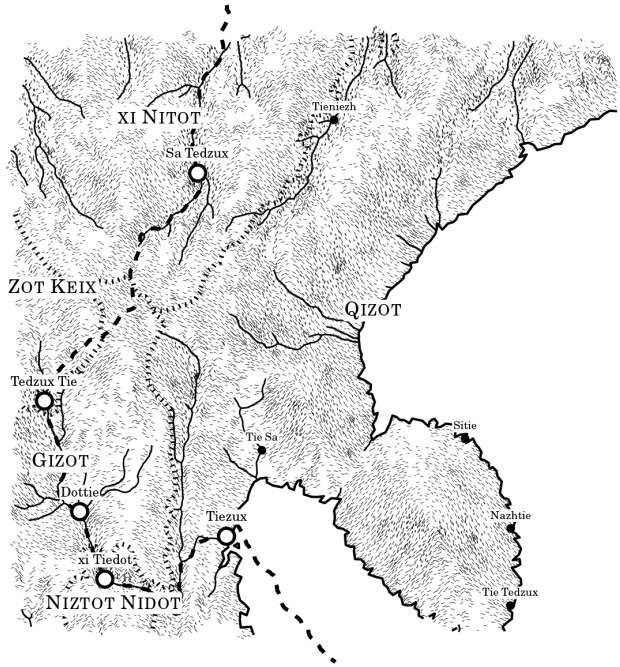
In the Temple Quarter, the roadways are lined with *shuqugh* flowers, and the blue blossoms sway in the late morning breeze. Should a traveller be fortunate enough to see a herd of *sudwa*, beloved for their horns, the traveller might be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape. One will take note of the caged *rimman* birds. These indicate the shop of a doctor.

Buwaq Muwsu

From Muwsu Yuyu the traveller can travel north to Buwaq Muwsu. It is a simple journey. *Qudshi* trees grow on the edge of the route. As a traveller enters Mubyaq, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls across the land.

The traveller, nearing the edge of the celebrated city of Buwaq Muwsu, will stumble upon the bourgeoisie, trying their luck on the *numi* board. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of joyous dejection, sung by citizens of the city. Eventually the fragrance of *sughwum* fruit fills the air, and one is without a doubt in Buwaq Muwsu.

Close to the palace, the streets are paved with lead, inlaid with stone. If one is ill-fated enough to find a game of *lilmi*, it can be half a day before escape is possible. The granite figurines which decorate the rooftops will be easy to see to a traveller. These are in memory of the war which in times past ravaged Buwaq Muwsu. Soldiers lounge here, dancing. In the late night, the traveller may usually hear the sound of the barbican clock.



Mukyu Yubu

Onwards from Buwaq Muwsu one may journey east to Mukyu Yubu. The route is long, but rewarding, taking many weeks. Near the road, hairy *sudwa* graze. When a traveller crosses into Qabum, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and scrubland.

Entering the great city of Mukyu Yubu the traveller will make out the emerald vaulted roof of the monumental temple of Khusha. From so far, one is unable to see how philosophers stay away from it, talking and telling stories. Closer to the centre of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sweet song of the *qudrim* birds. In the end the aroma of *shuqugh* trees fills the wind, and one has truly arrived.

In the Tailors' District of the city, the alleyways are lined with *siqwu* flowers, and the gentle musk fills the early morning breeze. The traveller can sometimes hear songs of plaintive joy, sung by labourers of the city. In the event that one is so unfortunate as to encounter merchants laughing, it can be a most educational experience.

XI NITOT TO QIZOT

Sa Tedzux

A traveller, at the outskirts of Sa Tedzux, may catch sight of mighty *beibo*, the national animal of xi Nitot. Slightly nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sweet song of the *zhied* birds, kept by soldiers. Finally the perfume of *tuttei* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in Sa Tedzux.

Near the dancing-hall, the back-streets are paved with limestone, inlaid with obsidian. Actors congregate here, dancing and praying. Should one be so blessed as to see the holy Deiniz ceremony, a traveller may be drawn in, and unable to leave.

Tedzux Tie

From Sa Tedzux one can travel to Tedzux Tie. It is an enjoyable journey. As the traveller crosses the border into Zot Keix, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls upon the terrain. By the roadside, shaggy *tos* graze. At one point the track crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *qautzux* plants.

The traveller, outside the mighty metropolis, can stumble upon a series of goldsmiths, hawking their wares. A little closer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the striking of the bastion clock. At last the aroma of *tobqaut* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Old District of the city, the plazas are lined with *qautzux* bushes, and the golden petals shimmer in the late afternoon air. Labourers throng here, practising their skill at the game of *nieq*. In the early evening, one may occasionally hear the song of the *tor* birds, kept by priests. The *qaut* trees will be obvious. These function as a deterrent to harmful spirits. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to encounter an altercation between two lovers, it can be a couple of hours before escape is possible.

Dottie

Leaving Tedzux Tie the traveller may journey north to Dottie. It is a pleasant journey. *Qautzux* plants grow on the fringe of the route. Along the way the track crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *to-*

bqaut flowers. When one enters Gizot, the greenery changes, giving way to open fields and thickets of *bod* trees.

Near the walls of Dottie a traveller may catch sight of the ruby dome of the iniquitous castle of Zuxraux Raux. While from this distance it seems magnificent, the citizens of Dottie find its architecture repellent, and avoid it. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will hear the chimes of the temple clock. Finally the fragrance of *poxo* fruit fills the breeze, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the prison of Keix kei Niz, the boulevards are paved with bronze, inlaid with marble. Philosophers gather here, singing. The traveller can typically hear songs of merry sadness, sung by merchants of a nearby village. An inattentive visitor will not notice the *du* stone medallions that adorn the lintels. These serve as a relic of the sickness which twenty years ago devastated Dottie.

xi Tiedot

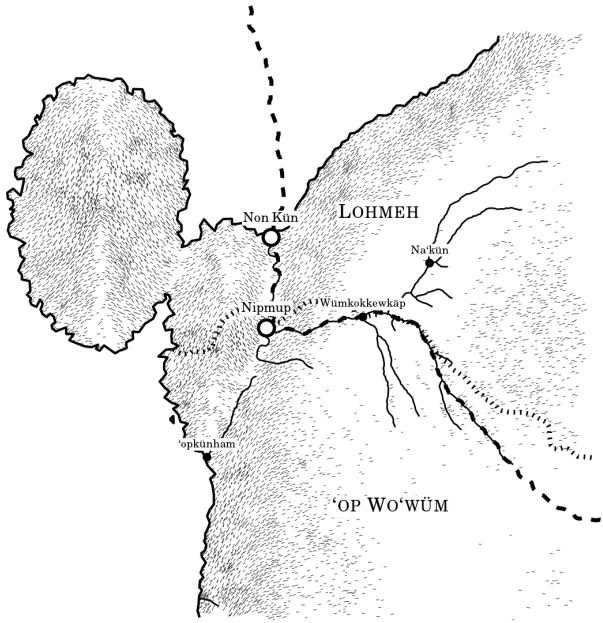
Onwards from Dottie one can go to xi Tiedot. The road is well-trodden, and the journey takes but an afternoon. At one point the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *teimbod* plants. As a traveller crosses the border into Niztot Nidot, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls over the landscape. Near the route, horned *tosniezh* graze.

Near to the celebrated city of xi Tiedot the traveller can discern the immense fortress of Si kei Zux. From here, one has no way to espy how the idle rich teem around its bronze walls. Closer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the delicate song of the *zhiedteim* birds, kept by soldiers. At last the musk of *qautzux* bushes fills the wind, and a traveller is undeniably in xi Tiedot.

In the Red Quarter of the city, the back-streets are lined with *tobqaut* flowers, and the pleasant scent fills the night breeze. In the late evening, a traveller may usually hear songs of doleful pleasure, sung by the bourgeoisie of the Merchants' District. If the traveller is so unfortunate as to catch sight of a game of *nieq*, it may be a very humbling experience.

Tiezux

From xi Tiedot a traveller can journey west to Tiezux. It is a smooth journey. When one enters Qizot, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *teimbod* bushes and pastures. *Qautzux* trees grow on



the track. Along the way the road crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *tobqaut* plants.

A traveller, on reaching the gates of gargantuan Tiezux, will stumble upon hairy *tosniezh*, valued for their leather. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear the gentle song of the *niezhxa* birds, kept by scholars. Eventually the perfume of *tuttei* fruit fills the air, and a traveller is without a doubt in Tiezux.

Around the bastion, the alleyways are paved with basalt, inlaid with granite. The idle rich flock here, laughing and praying. In the night, the traveller can occasionally hear the tolling of the mint clock. Should one be charmed enough to come across a quarrel between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible.

LOHMEH TO ‘OP WO‘WÜM

Non Kün

Entering the famed city of Non Kün a traveller may make out the vast temple of Monpiknä‘. Although from so far it may appear

quaint, the natives of the city find its form obscene, and stay away from it. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the delicate song of the *kukmüklih'än* birds, kept by artisans. In the end the smell of *pawkek'inpohham* flowers fills the breeze, and one has surely arrived.

In the Grey Quarter, the squares are paved with sandstone, inlaid with *'opkukkikmum* stone. In the afternoon, a traveller may sometimes hear the knell of the watchtower clock. One will see the *hüw'aw* trees. These betoken the home of an apothecary.

Nipmup

Leaving Non Kün the traveller may travel north to Nipmup. The route is busy, and the journey takes but a few hours. As one enters 'op Wo'wüm, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and open fields. Near the verge of the road, mighty *nök* graze.

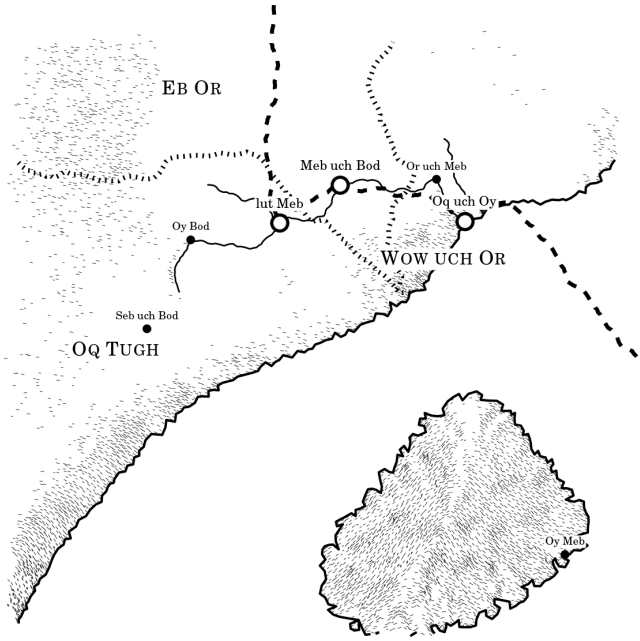
The traveller, at the walls of the city, may encounter merchants, dancing. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller can faintly hear songs of sorrowful exuberance, sung by scholars of the surrounding countryside. Ultimately the bouquet of *muh* fruit fills the air, and one is beyond doubt in Nipmup.

Near the dancing-hall of Käplihnä', the roadways are lined with *hüw'aw* flowers, and the pleasant musk fills the early night breeze. In the late morning, the traveller can often hear the song of the *kukmüklih'än* birds, kept by soldiers. Farmers crowd here, showing off on the *müklohhik'uk* tables. In the event that a traveller is fortunate enough to find a herd of *nök*, bred for racing by the the bourgeoisie of a nearby village, it can be a very educational experience. The limestone carvings that ornament the rooftops will be easy to see to a traveller. These repel unwanted influences.

Oq Tugh to Wow uch Or

lut Meb

A traveller, passing into tremendous lut Meb, can discern the infamous market-hall of Lut Ogh. From here, one is unable to observe how soldiers steer clear of it, laughing and telling stories. Closer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of hopeful melancholy, sung by actors of the Actors' District. Finally the scent of *nos* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller has truly arrived.



In the Ancient Quarter, the plazas are lined with *nos* plants. In the early evening, one may occasionally hear the bells of the citadel clock. The caged *yom* birds will be conspicuous to the traveller. These commemorate the plague which long ago engulfed the surrounding countryside. If a traveller is so lucky as to catch sight of a herd of shaggy *qew*, the sacred animal of Oq Tugh, the traveller might be drawn in, and it may be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Meb uch Bod

Onwards from lut Meb a traveller may journey south-west to Meb uch Bod. It is a delightful journey. *Nos* trees grow on the track. When the traveller crosses the border into Eb Or, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls upon the countryside. At one point the route crosses a broad rift, spotted with *ed* bushes.

Approaching the outskirts of the city of Meb uch Bod one will encounter pedlars, setting out their stalls. Closer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear songs of plaintive delight, sung by farmers of Meb uch Bod. At last the smell of *ok* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Meb uch Bod.

Close to the theatre of Or Wek, the streets are paved with stone, inlaid with granite. In the late afternoon, one can typically hear the balmy song of the *yom* birds, kept by scholars. Priests teem here, trying their luck on the *chuy* court. A careless observer will not notice the tame *wuc* birds. These signify the place of business of a smith.

Oq uch Oy

Onwards from Meb uch Bod a traveller can go west to Oq uch Oy. It is an agreeable journey. By the bank of the road, hairy *qew* graze. Along the way the route crosses a deep gully. As the traveller enters Wow uch Or, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls over the land.

Outside the city the traveller can see the gleaming towers of the famed castle of Or Tel. Though from so far it appear beautiful, the people of Oq uch Oy find its architecture distasteful, and avoid it. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the delicate song of the *yom* birds, kept by soldiers. Eventually the fragrance of *ok* fruit fills the air, and one has undeniably arrived.

In the Red District, the alleyways are lined with *nos* plants, and the red leaves sway in the early night breeze. In the late morning, one may often hear the clanging of the bastion clock. In the event that a traveller is so unfortunate as to see petty criminals singing, it can be three hours before escape is possible. Artisans cluster here, talking.

UDDESHOIG TO NEDESHEDKU

Itkumugmug

The traveller, near the outskirts of the celebrated metropolis of Itkumugmug, will come across philosophers, singing and dancing. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of merry gloom, sung by merchants of the Old Quarter. In the end the musk of *dukkam* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller has surely arrived.

In the Fishmongers' Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with obsidian, inlaid with bronze. The ivory figurines which grace the pediments will be apparent to a traveller. These are a vestige of the sickness which not long ago ravaged a nearby vil-

lage. If one is lucky enough to catch sight of the famous Shudshueâk dance, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave.

kyk- Êig-Ed

From Itkumugmug one may travel north-east to kyk- Êig-Ed. As many boats traf c these waters, a traveller can usually charter a small shing ship. Crew and passengers alike snack on a piquant soup made of seaweed and kunun fruit, garnished with duk berries. The bitter avour is tasty, enriched by the salty air. Great numbers of silver ukamshaosh may sometimes be seen in the water nearby, darting through the water.

On entering colossal kyk- Êig-Ed the traveller will espy the bone-white spire of the immense dancing-hall of Shudmig ên. At such a great distance, the traveller cannot observe how actors lounge by it, practising their skill at the game of mutsâshsishud. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will begin to hear songs of ebullient misery, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. Finally the smell of aâkkamâk fruit lls the air, and the traveller is truly in kyk- Êig-Ed.

In the vicinity of the fortress of Naknu, the squares are lined with duk plants, and the emerald blossoms whisper in the evening

‘oo“ay

Onwards from Ley Mom one may travel to ‘oo“ay. It is a smooth journey. As a traveller crosses the border into mok Mamoomew, the greenery changes, giving way to scrubland and wild *miyn* trees. Along the way the route crosses a broad depression.

Near to tremendous ‘oo“ay the traveller can stumble upon scattered fruit-sellers, hawking their wares. Closer to the heart of the city, one begins to hear songs of ecstatic melancholy, sung by scholars of the Actors’ District. Eventually the aroma of *noowmiwhak* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undeniably in ‘oo“ay.

Close to the university of Me‘aw, the back-streets are paved with basalt. In the late morning, one can typically hear the clanging of the temple clock. The *miyn* bushes will be easy to see to a traveller. These act as a vestige of the war which twenty years ago tormented the city.

Hoowhaywu

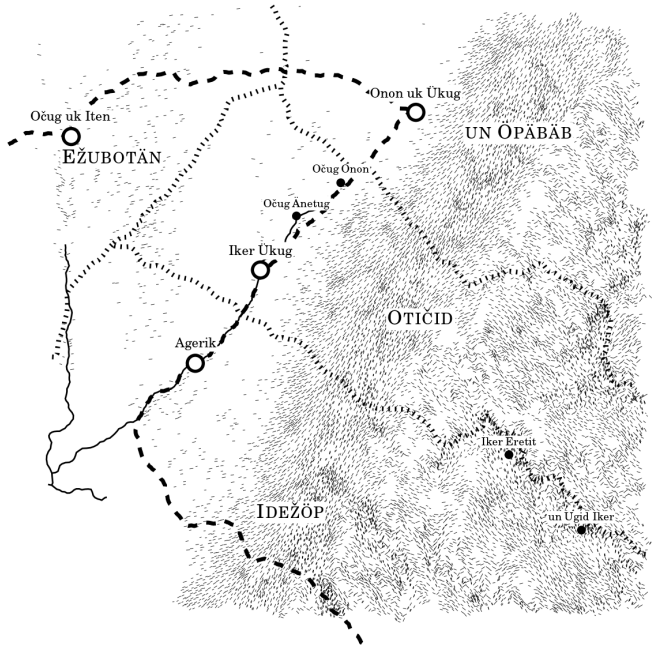
From ‘oo“ay one may go west to Hoowhaywu. The track is long, but scenic, taking many weeks. At one point the route crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *‘iyhmay* flowers. When a traveller enters Mooma, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls upon the land. Near the roadside, hairy *ley‘awhoo‘* graze.

The traveller, approaching the outskirts of the vast metropolis of Hoowhaywu, will catch sight of the bronze dome of the immense barbican of Mok Poyk. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, one will begin to hear songs of dirgeful delight, sung by the bourgeoisie of the Tailors’ Quarter. Finally the bouquet of *puwkuwwooh* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has truly arrived.

In the Old District of the city, the plazas are lined with *meyl‘ayhiwm* trees, and the yellow leaves rustle in the early night wind. If a traveller is so unlucky as to come across farmers dancing, it may be a very instructive experience. One may sometimes hear the delicate song of the *mey* birds, kept by the idle rich.

Mew‘u Wunoo

Leaving Hoowhaywu a traveller can go west to Mew‘u Wunoo. It is a delightful journey. Shaggy *hoo‘* graze by the road. As the traveller crosses into Kuy Lukik, there is a change in the quality of



the light, and a bluish cast falls over the landscape. Along the way the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *miyn* plants.

A traveller, outside the colossal city of Mew'u Wunoo, can encounter mighty *kokik*, valued for their milk. A little closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear songs of buoyant sadness, sung by petty criminals of Mew'u Wunoo. Eventually the smell of *'iyhmay* flowers fills the breeze, and a traveller is without a doubt in Mew'u Wunoo.

In the vicinity of the citadel of Mom Memnoo, the roadways are paved with bronze, inlaid with *mooliwhe* stone. The *meyl'ayhiwm* bushes will be clear to the traveller. These denote the home of a fortune-teller. Soldiers cluster here, telling stories and talking. Should one be blessed enough to find a herd of hairy *kokik*, the sacred animal of Kuy Lukik, a traveller might be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape.

EŽUBOTÄN TO IDEŽÖP

Očug uk Iten

At the gates of infamous Očug uk Iten the traveller may make out the sandstone spire of the gargantuan prison of Udötoč. At such a great distance, one has no way to observe how scholars stay away from it, trying their luck at the game of *ikožäz*. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the sweet song of the *onečer* birds. At last the perfume of *alogezas* fruit fills the air, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

In the Green Quarter, the plazas are lined with *asitegäg* plants. Merchants swarm here, practising their skill at *okog*. If the traveller is so fortunate as to see a game of *änäzäköč*, it may be two hours before escape is possible. One can typically hear the striking of the barbican clock.

Onon uk Ükug

Onwards from Očug uk Iten a traveller may journey west to Onon uk Ükug. The track is arduous, but rewarding, taking two days. When the traveller enters un Öpäbäb, the vegetation changes, giving way to hedgerows and copses of *ibäg* trees. At one point the track crosses a deep chasm. On the fringe of the route, *asitegäg* bushes grow.

Passing into the infamous city of Onon uk Ükug a traveller can come across the bourgeoisie, praying and dancing. Closer to the centre of the city, the traveller can faintly hear songs of forlorn pleasure, sung by philosophers of a nearby village. Ultimately the bouquet of *üžazäz* flowers fills the air, and one has undoubtedly arrived.

Near the dancing-hall of Öšikig, the boulevards are paved with limestone. Priests crowd here, showing off on the *änožuč* field. The traveller may usually hear the peal of the watchtower clock. A careless visitor will fail to see the ivory columns which ornament the pediments. These function as a deterrent to hostile influences.

Iker Ükug

From Onon uk Ükug a traveller can journey north-east to Iker Ükug. The road is long, but scenic, taking several weeks. Along the way the route crosses a broad valley. When one crosses into Otičid, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls across the countryside. *Ibäg* plants grow near the roadside.

The traveller, on reaching the walls of the monstrous city, may discern the gleaming spires of the mighty mint of Ödiküčud. Somewhat nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of ebullient melancholy, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. In the end the aroma of *alogezas* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller is without a doubt in Iker Ükug.

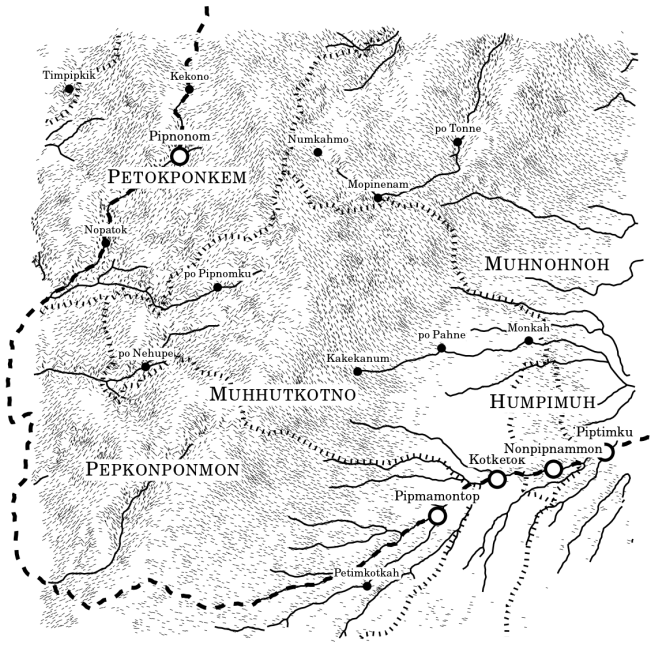
Around the theatre of Aböšigiž, the squares are lined with *üžazäz* trees, and the pleasant scent fills the late evening breeze. The idle rich lounge here, singing. The traveller will be humbled by the caged *ipöm* birds. These are in memory of the sickness which in times past troubled the Tailors' District. In the late morning, a traveller can occasionally hear the song of the *onečer* birds, kept by writers. Should one be so unfortunate as to encounter the famous Iläkäž ritual, it can be an edifying experience.

Agerik

Leaving Iker Ükug the traveller can travel north-east to Agerik. It is a pleasant journey. On the track, *äkomubüm* graze. At one point the road crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *üžazäz* bushes. As one enters Idežöp, the vegetation changes, giving way to meadows and wild *idüžig* flowers.

Near to tremendous Agerik a traveller will find crowds of fishmongers, setting out their stalls. A little closer to the centre of the city, one will begin to hear the knell of the prison clock. Eventually the bouquet of *ibäg* trees fills the air, and the traveller is truly in Agerik.

In the Temple Quarter of the city, the roadways are paved with obsidian, inlaid with sandstone. Labourers teem here, trying their luck on the *änäzäköč* board. The tame *ömad* birds will be apparent. These deter evil spirits.



PETOKPONKEM TO MUHNOHNOH

Pipnonom

The traveller, nearing the outskirts of the iniquitous metropolis, will make out the basalt roof of the celebrated bastion of Mohehhut. From so far, a traveller is unable to catch sight of how farmers mill by its golden gate, telling stories and laughing. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear songs of heavy-hearted bliss, sung by actors of the city. Ultimately the smell of *nothuk* bushes fills the breeze, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the vicinity of the barbican, the alleyways are lined with *tapepah* plants. A hasty visitor will not notice the marble medallions that adorn the balustrades. These mark the workplace of a smith. In the event that a traveller is charmed enough to catch sight of soldiers talking, it may be a most humbling experience.

Pipmamontop

Onwards from Pipnonom a traveller may travel north-west to Pipmamontop. It is an agreeable journey. As the traveller crosses into Pepkonponmon, there is a variation in the light, and a grey cast falls over the countryside. Along the way the road crosses a broad rift.

Entering the infamous city of Pipmamontop one can stumble upon *momtimmut*, bred for racing by the artisans of Pipmamontop. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the song of the *nokma* birds, kept by the idle rich. At last the musk of *hatannom* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is truly in Pipmamontop.

In the Artisans' District of the city, the boulevards are paved with ivory, inlaid with lead. Farmers teem here, singing. In the early night, one may usually hear songs of blissful gloom, sung by writers of the surrounding countryside. If a traveller is fortunate enough to find an argument between two lovers, it can be half a day before escape is possible. The *taka* trees will be obvious. These act as a memento of the plague which twenty years ago beset the city.

Kotketok

From Pipmamontop one may go south-west to Kotketok. The route is well-trodden, and the journey takes but an afternoon. *Tenatanka* graze by the roadside. At one point the track crosses a deep gully.

A traveller, at the edge of the city of Kotketok, can make out the immense fortress of Meheh. Although from this distance it may look quaint, denizens of Kotketok find its bulk obscene, and avoid it. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the striking of the theatre clock. Finally the fragrance of *tapepah* flowers fills the air, and one has surely arrived.

Close to the dancing-hall, the plazas are lined with *kutta* plants. In the event that the traveller is so blessed as to see a herd of horned *pite*, prized for their meat, one may be drawn in, and unable to leave. A traveller will see the caged *nanninuna* birds. These serve as a caution to malign influences.

Nonpipnammon

Leaving Kotketok one can journey to Nonpipnammon. On the bank of the route, *nothuk* trees grow. Along the way the track

crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *minkemhukhe* bushes.

On entering the mighty metropolis a traveller may stumble upon the idle rich, praying and laughing. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the delicate song of the *no-knot* birds. Ultimately the perfume of *munom* fruit fills the wind, and one has undeniably arrived.

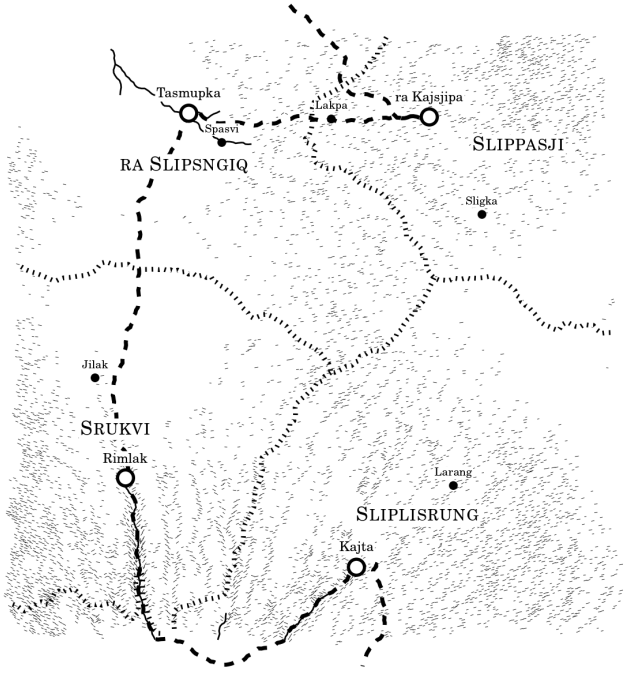
In the Fishmongers' Quarter, the back-streets are paved with sandstone, inlaid with limestone. If a traveller is ill-fated enough to catch sight of the holy Tetmonpeh ceremony, it may be a few hours before escape is possible. The *huknuktunnon* flowers will be conspicuous to the traveller. These signify the shop of an artisan. In the late afternoon, one may sometimes hear the clanging of the counting-house clock. Philosophers congregate here, praying.

Piptimku

From Nonpipnammon a traveller may travel west to Piptimku. The road is crowded, and the journey takes but half a day. When the traveller enters Muhnohnoh, the greenery changes, giving way to scrubland and *nothuk* plants. Shaggy *kemtepahpe* graze near the roadside. At one point the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *taka* bushes.

The traveller, near the walls of Piptimku, can espy the sapphire dome of the great mint of Kemtupmon. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one will hear the gentle song of the *nokma* birds, kept by soldiers. At last the fragrance of *puhmemnik* trees fills the breeze, and a traveller is beyond doubt in Piptimku.

Close to the university, the streets are lined with *taka* plants, and the pleasant perfume fills the early night wind. Should the traveller be so unfortunate as to find a game of *honkamnotop*, it can be a most educational experience. A distracted traveller will overlook the *nimhonmanum* stone gargoyles which decorate the archways. These betoken the home of an apothecary. Writers lounge here, practising their skill at the game of *pentintinkut*. A traveller can occasionally hear songs of desolate glee, sung by farmers of a nearby village.



SLIPPASJI TO SLIPLISRUNG

ra Kajsjipa

Outside the city of ra Kajsjipa the traveller will come across a series of merchants, hawking their wares. Slightly nearer to the heart of the city, one will hear the song of the *sliglu* birds, kept by citizens. Eventually the scent of *gaska* fruit fills the air, and a traveller has truly arrived.

In the Grey District of the city, the roadways are paved with bronze. In the late morning, the traveller may sometimes hear songs of merry dejection, sung by actors of the city. In the event that one is so unlucky as to find artisans telling stories, it may be an afternoon before escape is possible. The tame *sjalsvilu* birds will be conspicuous. These serve to repel harmful influences. The bourgeoisie mill here, singing and talking.

Tasmupka

Onwards from ra Kajsjipa a traveller can journey east to Tasmupka. The road is long, but rewarding, taking three days. When one crosses the border into ra Slipsngiq, the vegetation changes, giving way to open fields and thickets of *starna* flowers. Near the track, *naliji* bushes grow.

A traveller, approaching the outskirts of the city, may discern the bone-white spires of the tremendous citadel of Puslasvi. From here, the traveller has no way to make out how petty criminals throng near its emerald base, dancing. Closer to the centre of the city, one will begin to hear the sweet song of the *sliglu* birds, kept by philosophers. In the end the smell of *skaqapa* fruit fills the breeze, and a traveller is undoubtedly in Tasmupka.

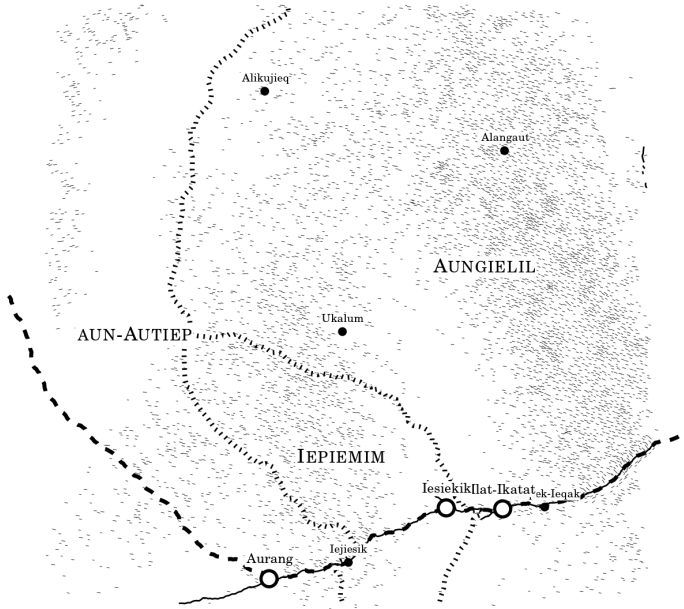
Near the palace of Lasjalsnuq, the alleyways are lined with *starna* plants, and the emerald blossoms sway in the afternoon breeze. Merchants swarm here, showing off on the *sligtaja* tables. One will be impressed by the *milnaga* flowers. These signify the workplace of a smith. If the traveller is unfortunate enough to encounter a herd of mighty *slansmup*, the national animal of ra Slipsngiq, a traveller might be drawn in, and it can be three hours before escape is possible. In the early evening, the traveller can usually hear the tolling of the bastion clock.

Rimlak

Leaving Tasmupka one may travel north to Rimlak. It is a simple journey. Along the way the route crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *sviqar* trees. As the traveller enters Srukvi, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls upon the land. *Sgapsjumslan* graze on the edge of the road.

On reaching the edge of the celebrated city of Rimlak one may stumble upon hairy *gatsra*, bred for work by the farmers of Rimlak. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear songs of plaintive joy, sung by the idle rich of a nearby village. At last the fragrance of *ralsqung* bushes fills the air, and the traveller is surely in Rimlak.

In the Green Quarter of the city, the boulevards are paved with stone, inlaid with bronze. Should one be so lucky as to come across a game of *sgapsrukja*, it can be a very instructive experience. In the late morning, a traveller can occasionally hear songs of hopeful gloom, sung by philosophers of the Old District. Citizens gather here, praying and laughing. The tame *sjalsvilu* birds will be obvious. These function as a vestige of the sickness which in times past engulfed Rimlak.



Kajta

Onwards from Rimlak the traveller can go west to Kajta. By the track, *sraknasmup* plants grow. At one point the route crosses a broad rift, spotted with *starna* trees. When a traveller crosses the border into Sliplisrung, the foliage changes, giving way to meadows and woods of *gaqarta* flowers.

The traveller, near to iniquitous Kajta, will catch sight of the granite tower of the monstrous castle of Snuqla. Though from here it appear beautiful, people of the city find its architecture repellent, and steer clear of it. Slightly closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the balmy song of the *srakluta* birds, kept by labourers. Finally the aroma of *ralsqung* bushes fills the wind, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the barbican, the streets are lined with *gaqarta* plants, and the gentle bouquet fills the early afternoon breeze. The marble figures that adorn the walls will be easy to see to a traveller. These are a warning to unwanted spirits. In the late night, one may typically hear the sound of the watchtower clock. If the traveller is charmed enough to encounter the intricate Stisma dance, it may be a couple of hours before escape is possible.

AUN-AUTIEP TO AUNGIELIL

Aurang

On entering the city a traveller will see merchants, telling stories. Nearer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear songs of melancholy bliss, sung by artisans of the city. In the end the musk of *iejumulauq* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has undeniably arrived.

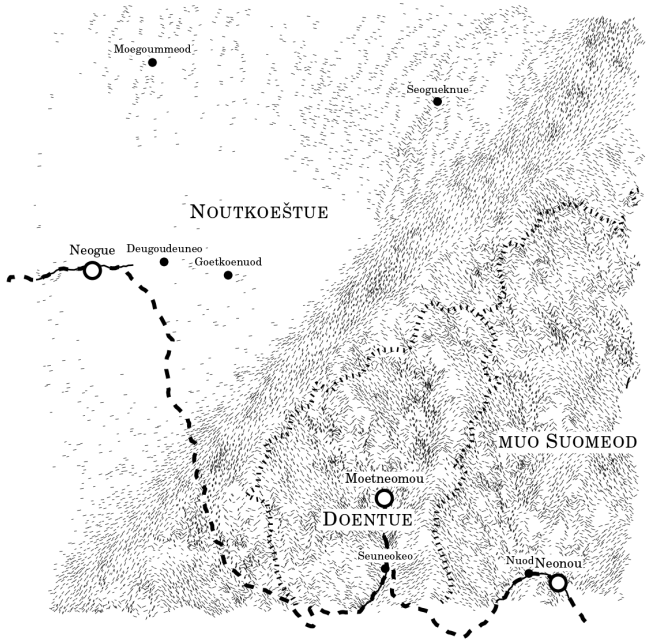
In the Actors' Quarter of the city, the squares are paved with sandstone, inlaid with ivory. An inattentive observer will miss the obsidian carvings which ornament the lintels. These commemorate the revolution which recently troubled the city. Should the traveller be so ill-fated as to encounter a herd of hairy *inig*, the sacred animal of aun-Autiep, one may be drawn in, and find it almost impossible to escape.

Iesiekik

From Aurang a traveller can travel to Iesiekik. It is an enjoyable journey. As one enters Iepiemim, there is a shift in the light, and a golden cast falls across the terrain. Along the way the road crosses a broad valley, spotted with *augauturauq* trees.

A traveller, near the gates of the colossal metropolis of Iesiekik, may observe the famous university of Ataujungieq. At such a large distance, a traveller cannot see how actors hide from it, trying their luck at the game of *auvaupum*. Closer to the heart of the city, one can faintly hear the sweet song of the *amavitit* birds, kept by farmers. At last the smell of *ingurieqim* flowers fills the breeze, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Iesiekik.

Around the fortress of Aujaugier, the roadways are lined with *anur* trees, and the red petals rustle in the early afternoon air. The *ierur* plants will be clear to one. These warn off hostile influences. In the event that the traveller is charmed enough to catch sight of a fight between two lovers, it may be a most edifying experience. In the late evening, a traveller can sometimes hear the peal of the citadel clock.



Ilat-Ikatat

Leaving Iesiekik a traveller may go to Ilat-Ikatat. The track is well-trodden, and the journey takes but half a day. At one point the road crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *ililauliem* bushes. Mighty *inig* graze on the roadside. When the traveller crosses the border into Aungielil, the foliage changes, giving way to pastures and scrubland.

Outside celebrated Ilat-Ikatat one can see shaggy *igasum*, beloved for their leather. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the song of the *aukaungiej* birds. Eventually the aroma of *iejumulauq* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is surely in Ilat-Ikatat.

In the New District of the city, the boulevards are paved with granite, inlaid with bronze. A traveller will see the caged *inam* birds. These mark the shop of a doctor. One may usually hear songs of exuberant misery, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. The bourgeoisie teem here, singing.

NOUTKOEŠTUE TO MUO SUOMEOD

Neogue

The traveller, approaching the edge of the city, can espy the famed mint of Teodeon. Despite the fact that from here it may seem magnificent, the citizens of Neogue find its bulk distasteful, and shun it. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the delicate song of the *duodougsueseos* birds, kept by citizens. Ultimately the bouquet of *šoedoem* fruit fills the breeze, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

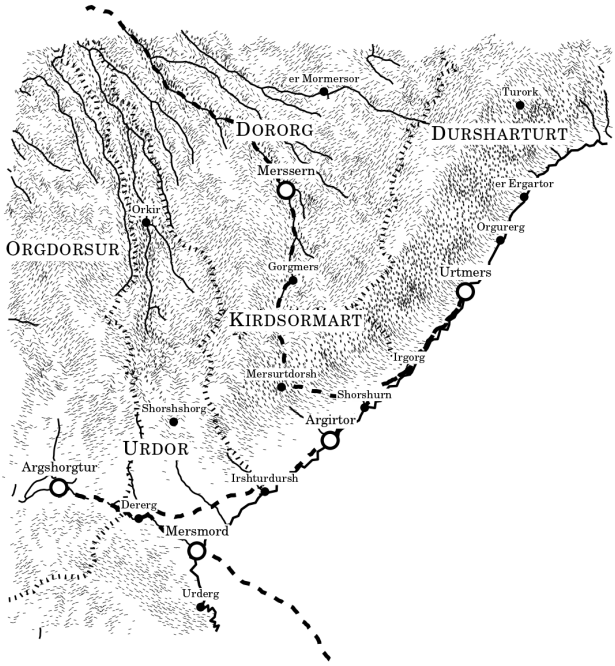
Around the temple of Meokguek, the plazas are lined with *goesdoe* flowers, and the balmy musk fills the morning air. An inattentive visitor will fail to see the *geumgeonoe* plants. These serve as a deterrent to unwanted spirits. Actors lounge here, practising their skill at the game of *tuegguekšuetuo*. In the event that the traveller is so fortunate as to come across the revered Suomgeugneoš parade, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Moetneomou

Onwards from Neogue the traveller may journey north-west to Moetneomou. The route is arduous, but scenic, taking many weeks. As a traveller enters Doentue, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a harsh cast falls over the countryside. Along the way the track crosses a broad depression, spotted with *goesnoutsuedoem* flowers. By the verge of the road, *geumgeonoe* trees grow.

Passing into infamous Moetneomou the traveller may find labourers, praying. A little nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear the chimes of the barbican clock. In the end the scent of *doengoessoemmeod* bushes fills the wind, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Moetneomou.

In the Goldsmiths' Quarter of the city, the back-streets are paved with *šeukuemeuk* stone, inlaid with ivory. Scholars mill here, telling stories and talking. If one is lucky enough to catch sight of a game of *tuegguekšuetuo*, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. The marble figurines that grace the walls will be conspicuous to one. These function as a reminder of the pestilence which in times past ravaged the Temple District.



Neonou

From Moetneomou a traveller can go north-west to Neonou. *Goetguetmeodneom* graze near the route. At one point the track crosses a deep ravine, spotted with *toegguo* trees. When the traveller crosses the border into muo Suomeod, there is a change in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls across the land.

The traveller, nearing the walls of the great city of Neonou, will discern the immense theatre of Geodteuš. From such a great distance, one cannot make out how farmers swarm by it, trying their luck on the *geusoemtuen* field. Closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear songs of sorrowful delight, sung by the bourgeoisie of the surrounding countryside. At last the perfume of *šoedoem* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the temple of Deomšeom, the squares are lined with *geunoenuod* flowers, and the fragrant leaves whisper in the early evening wind. Should a traveller be so ill-fated as to come across writers dancing, it can be a very humbling experience. In the night, one can often hear the song of the *duodougsueseos* birds, kept by merchants.

Dororg to Urdor

Merssern

A traveller, on entering the city, may discern the chryselephantine clock-tower of the famous fortress of Gordorsh. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear songs of blissful melancholy, sung by labourers of a nearby village. Ultimately the bouquet of *ortirm* bushes fills the air, and one is undeniably in Merssern.

Close to the palace, the plazas are paved with obsidian. A careless observer will miss the stone statues which adorn the pediments. These act to ward off evil influences. In the event that the traveller is unfortunate enough to catch sight of the holy Morgorder procession, it can be three hours before escape is possible.

Urtmers

Leaving Merssern a traveller may travel north-west to Urtmers. It is a smooth journey. On the roadside, *urnirmserk* trees grow. As the traveller enters Dursharturt, the vegetation changes, giving way to open fields and hedgerows. At one point the road crosses a broad valley, spotted with *sirturt* flowers.

At the gates of infamous Urtmers one can see scattered pedlars, setting out their stalls. Nearer to the heart of the city, a traveller will begin to hear the sound of the prison clock. Finally the smell of *mermerd* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Ancient Quarter of the city, the alleyways are paved with lead, inlaid with ivory. The tame *narermur* birds will be apparent. These indicate the home of a fortune-teller. If one is so blessed as to find a herd of hairy *serkterdord*, the sacred animal of Dursharturt, it may be a very instructive experience.

Argirtor

Onwards from Urtmers a traveller can journey to Argirtor. It is a pleasant journey. Along the way the route crosses a broad rift, spotted with *urnirmserk* plants. When the traveller crosses the border into Kirdsormart, the greenery changes, giving way to copses

of *gorgsirtort* bushes and scrubland. *Ermgort* trees grow by the bank of the track.

Near to the tremendous city of Argirtor one can catch sight of crowds of fruit-sellers, hawking their wares. Slightly closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear the knell of the university clock. Eventually the perfume of *kirdirmurt* flowers fills the wind, and the traveller is surely in Argirtor.

In the Green Quarter of the city, the boulevards are lined with *urnirmserk* bushes, and the pleasant aroma fills the afternoon breeze. Actors throng here, telling stories and dancing. In the event that one is charmed enough to come across soldiers singing, the traveller may be drawn in, and it may be half a day before escape is possible. A traveller will take note of the *sherssirterd* trees. These call to mind the plague which long ago tormented Argirtor. One may typically hear the gentle song of the *orkger* birds, kept by farmers.

Argshorgtur

From Argirtor the traveller can travel east to Argshorgtur. The route is long, but rewarding, taking three days. As one enters Orgdorsur, there is a variation in the light, and a golden cast falls upon the landscape. Along the way the track crosses a deep gully. On the roadside, horned *gerdserurd* graze.

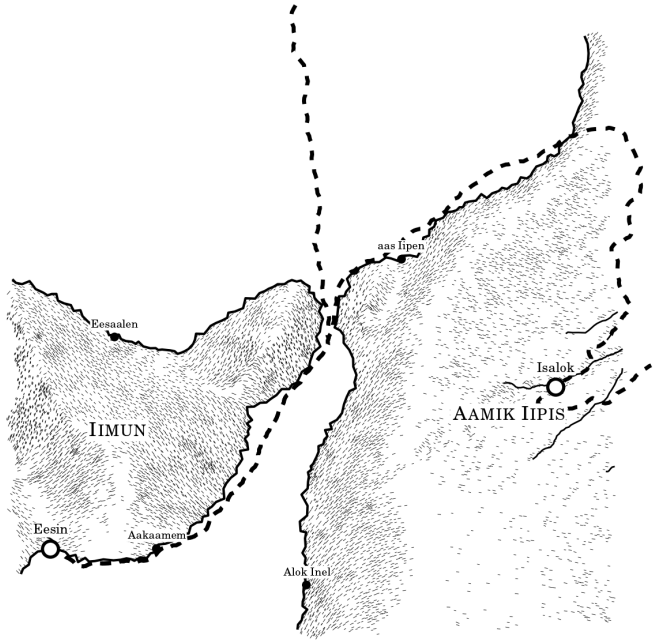
The traveller, nearing the outskirts of the monumental metropolis, can espy the ivory lookout of the iniquitous castle of Mordorshner. Although from so far it appear elegant, the people of the city find its form unsavoury, and hide from it. A little nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of dirgeful glee, sung by citizens of the city. Finally the bouquet of *urgmorg* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Near the market-hall of Orshmorgirsh, the roadways are lined with *sherssirterd* bushes, and the golden petals sway in the late morning air. In the early evening, one can usually hear the sweet song of the *orkger* birds. Priests crowd here, singing.

Mersmord

From Argshorgtur a traveller may go north-west to Mersmord. When the traveller crosses the border into Urdor, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a grey cast falls across the terrain. At one point the road crosses a deep ravine.

A traveller, entering Mersmord, will stumble upon the bourgeoisie, telling stories and dancing. Closer to the heart of the city,



one will begin to hear the striking of the counting-house clock. Eventually the scent of *kirdirmurt* plants fills the breeze, and the traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the Merchants' District of the city, the squares are paved with marble. Farmers mill here, showing off at the game of *orarsh*. The granite gargoyles that ornament the rooftops will be tricky to miss to a traveller. These denote the place of business of an artisan. In the night, one may sometimes hear songs of joyous sadness, sung by merchants of a nearby village.

IIMUN TO AAMIK IIPIS

Eesin

On reaching the gates of the city of Eesin the traveller will encounter mighty *elameem*, bred for racing by the philosophers of the Goldsmiths' District. Closer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear the delicate song of the *iilas* birds, kept by artisans. At last the fragrance of *iineenaat* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller is beyond doubt in Eesin.

Near the dancing-hall of Ipaal, the streets are paved with obsidian, inlaid with bronze. A traveller will see the *etam* trees. These are a relic of the war which not long ago devastated the surrounding countryside. Actors gather here, talking. In the late morning, one may typically hear the bells of the theatre clock.

Isalok

Leaving Eesin the traveller may journey west to Isalok. A traveller may hear flocks of seabirds the land's edge, diving for *uleel* fish. Both fishermen and passengers subsist on a thin stew made of seaweed and *isomas* bird meat, flavoured with *iinetus* leaves. The taste is dark. There are occasionally shoals of iridescent fish in the water nearby, barely visible beneath the surface.

The traveller, near to the city, may catch sight of the crystal dome of the great citadel of Oneep. At this distance, one is unable to observe how petty criminals steer clear of it, praying and singing. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, the traveller will hear the balmy song of the *isomas* birds, kept by writers. Ultimately the aroma of *aalotop* flowers fills the air, and a traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

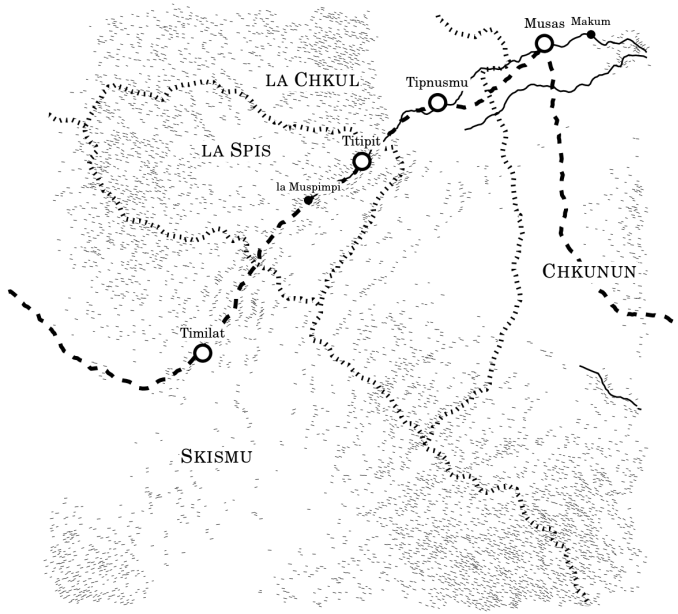
In the Grey Quarter, the back-streets are lined with *etiis* trees, and the sweet smell fills the early evening breeze. The ivory columns which grace the eaves will be clear to one. These act as a warning to hostile spirits. Should the traveller be so ill-fated as to find a game of *aanesut*, it may be a most edifying experience. In the late afternoon, one can often hear songs of heavy-hearted pleasure, sung by labourers of a nearby village.

Skismu to Chkunun

Timilat

Near the outskirts of the mighty city of Timilat the traveller may catch sight of a series of hawkers, setting out their stalls. Somewhat closer to the heart of the city, a traveller begins to hear the chimes of the mint clock. At last the scent of *chnichkalchku* fruit fills the air, and one is undeniably in Timilat.

In the vicinity of the dancing-hall, the alleyways are lined with *chmuspumchpichpi* bushes. The traveller can sometimes hear the gentle song of the *puchkumunsmu* birds, kept by the idle rich. The bourgeoisie throng here, practising their skill on the *slutmalsasmis*



board. A hasty traveller will not notice the caged *snapspukkit* birds. These serve to deter harmful influences.

Titipit

Onwards from Timilat a traveller can travel south-west to Titipit. As the traveller enters la Spis, the vegetation changes, giving way to pastures and wild *pumsu* flowers. At one point the route crosses a broad rift, spotted with *pismuspukchpu* plants. *Chmuspumchpichpi* bushes grow near the edge of the track.

A traveller, approaching the walls of monstrous Titipit, will make out the jade vaulted roof of the monumental prison of Snipnipchta. Nearer to the centre of the city, one will begin to hear songs of gleeful gloom, sung by soldiers of the surrounding countryside. Finally the musk of *pumsu* trees fills the wind, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the New District, the plazas are paved with limestone. In the morning, one may occasionally hear the balmy song of the *snapspukkit* birds. The *chmuspumchpichpi* flowers will be obvious to the traveller. These signify the shop of a fortune-teller.

Tipnusmu

From Titipit the traveller may go south-west to Tipnusmu. It is a simple journey. When a traveller crosses into la Chkul, there is a change in the light, and a golden cast falls upon the land. Along the way the road crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *pismuspukchpu* plants. By the route, *susmis* graze.

On entering the infamous metropolis of Tipnusmu one will see the vast palace of Tikik. From here, one has no way to espy how priests avoid it, telling stories. Slightly closer to the heart of the city, a traveller will hear songs of forlorn delight, sung by writers of the city. Eventually the fragrance of *nichmusmusnun* fruit fills the air, and the traveller is undoubtedly in Tipnusmu.

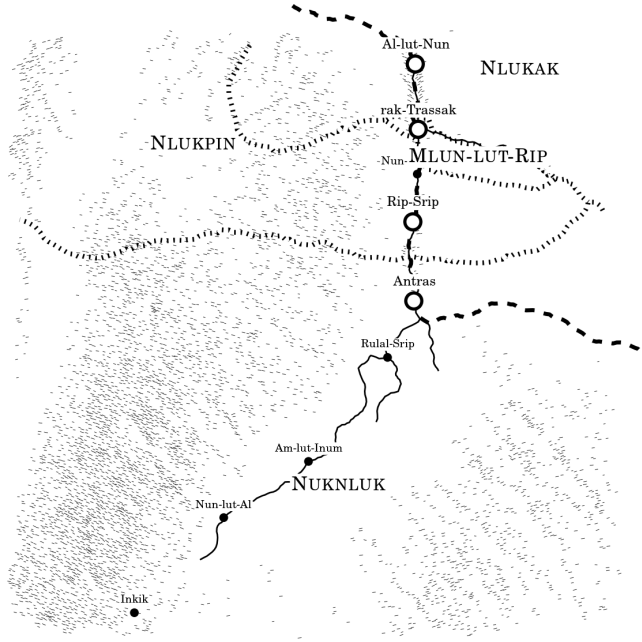
Close to the fortress of Kimsmuluk, the boulevards are lined with *kamuk* bushes, and the pleasant smell fills the evening breeze. Artisans flock here, talking and praying. A careless traveller will fail to see the lead figures that decorate the lintels. These function as a reminder of the plague which twenty years ago engulfed Tipnusmu. If a traveller is fortunate enough to see a quarrel between two lovers, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible.

Musas

Leaving Tipnusmu one may go to Musas. It is a pleasant journey. At one point the route crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *pismuspukchpu* flowers. As the traveller crosses the border into Chkunun, the greenery changes, giving way to hedgerows and meadows.

The traveller, on reaching the edge of mighty Musas, may come across philosophers, dancing. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller begins to hear the striking of the citadel clock. In the end the bouquet of *tikupum* trees fills the wind, and one is surely in Musas.

In the Actors' Quarter of the city, the alleyways are paved with stone. The traveller can usually hear songs of exuberant misery, sung by merchants of the Green District. The *pumsu* plants will be apparent to the traveller. These are a caution to hostile influences. Should a traveller be so lucky as to stumble upon a herd of *chkumspimchmuschnumluk*, bred for show by the priests of the city, it can be an educational experience.



NLUKAK TO NUKNLUK

Al-lut-Nun

Passing into the infamous city one can make out the gleaming towers of the monstrous market-hall of Nluprat. While from such a large distance it looks quaint, the natives of Al-lut-Nun find its architecture obscene, and hide from it. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller can faintly hear the clanging of the mint clock. Eventually the smell of *saklik* fruit fills the air, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the watchtower of Liprat, the back-streets are lined with *itil* bushes. If one is blessed enough to see farmers telling stories, the traveller might be drawn in, and find it difficult to escape. One may often hear the sweet song of the *ris* birds, kept by actors. Philosophers congregate here, trying their luck at the game of *tlamlap*.

rak-Trassak

From Al-lut-Nun a traveller can travel to rak-Trassak. The road is busy, and the journey takes but a couple of hours. When the traveller enters Mlun-lut-Rip, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a pale cast falls over the landscape. Along the way the track crosses a broad valley. *Il* flowers grow near the track.

A traveller, nearing the edge of famed rak-Trassak, can catch sight of goldsmiths, hawking their wares. A little nearer to the inner parts of the city, one will begin to hear songs of ebullient sadness, sung by the idle rich of the surrounding countryside. At last the perfume of *ripmral* fruit fills the wind, and the traveller has truly arrived.

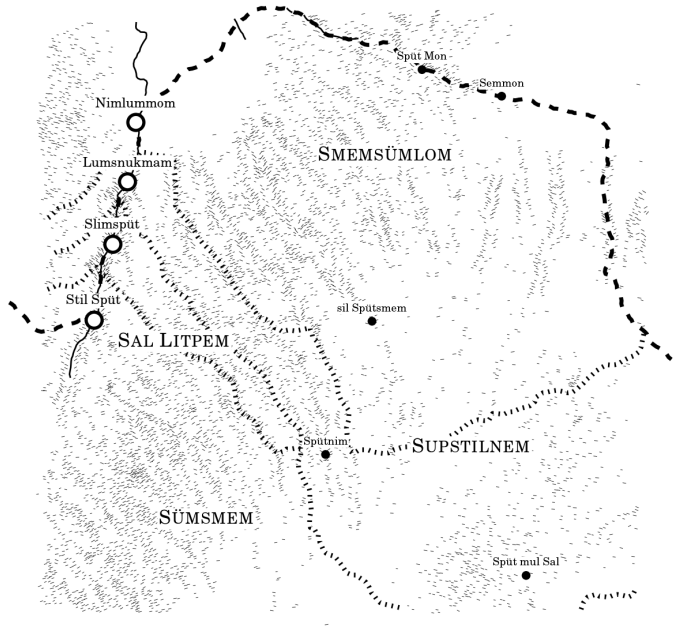
In the Red Quarter, the boulevards are paved with granite. Writers gather here, singing. A traveller will take note of the caged *us* birds. These call to mind the pestilence which long ago troubled rak-Trassak. Should one be so ill-fated as to encounter the revered Rak-Nlun-As dance, the traveller may be drawn in, and it may be two hours before escape is possible.

Rip-Srip

Leaving rak-Trassak a traveller can journey to Rip-Srip. Along the way the road crosses a broad depression. By the roadside, hairy *run* graze. When one crosses the border into Nlukpin, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *il* trees and scrubland.

Outside the city of Rip-Srip the traveller may observe the famous barbican of Map-Ratlan. From so far, one cannot catch sight of how petty criminals cluster around its gates, praying and dancing. Somewhat closer to the centre of the city, the traveller will hear the balmy song of the *us* birds, kept by scholars. In the end the aroma of *akran* bushes fills the air, and a traveller is undoubtedly in Rip-Srip.

Near the theatre of Srankruk-Lat, the back-streets are lined with *itil* plants, and the yellow blossoms whisper in the afternoon breeze. In the event that one is unfortunate enough to come across a herd of shaggy *nal*, valued for their horns, it may be a very humbling experience. The *il* trees will be easy to see to the traveller. These denote the workplace of a smith. In the early night, a traveller can occasionally hear songs of doleful exuberance, sung by artisans of the Tailors' District.



Antras

Onwards from Rip-Srip one may travel to Antras. The route is crowded, and the journey takes but half a day. At one point the road crosses a deep chasm, spotted with *krip* bushes. *Ran* plants grow on the roadside. As a traveller enters Nuknluk, there is a shift in the light, and a harsh cast falls over the countryside.

The traveller, near the gates of the gargantuan metropolis, will stumble upon horned *run*, the national animal of Nuknluk. Nearer to the heart of the city, the traveller begins to hear the chimes of the castle clock. Finally the fragrance of *itil* trees fills the air, and one is surely in Antras.

In the Goldsmiths' Quarter, the squares are paved with obsidian. In the late morning, a traveller may typically hear songs of desolate joy, sung by priests of a nearby village. Should the traveller be so fortunate as to see writers laughing, it may be a few hours before escape is possible.

SÜMSMEM TO SMEMSÜMLOM

Stil Spüt

Entering vast Stil Spüt a traveller will observe the silver clock-tower of the celebrated citadel of Slumnimmom. Even though from here it may look beautiful, the denizens of the city find its bulk distasteful, and avoid it. Closer to the inner parts of the city, one begins to hear the tolling of the counting-house clock. Eventually the musk of *smumstutstem* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller has beyond doubt arrived.

Close to the palace of Snukstammup, the plazas are lined with *limslol* trees, and the delicate fragrance fills the early morning breeze. In the late evening, one may often hear the sweet song of the *nunsmem* birds, kept by merchants. In the event that a traveller is blessed enough to catch sight of a squabble between two lovers, it can be an afternoon before escape is possible. A distracted visitor will miss the tame *nunslimsnup* birds. These act to warn off unwanted spirits.

Slimspüt

Onwards from Stil Spüt the traveller may go to Slimspüt. It is a delightful journey. Along the way the route crosses a broad rift. When the traveller enters Sal Litpem, the foliage changes, giving way to hedgerows and open fields. Near the side of the track, *stuksun* plants grow.

The traveller, at the walls of the tremendous city, may stumble upon actors, practising their skill on the *lanspun* tables. Slightly nearer to the centre of the city, one can faintly hear songs of blissful melancholy, sung by the bourgeoisie of the surrounding countryside. In the end the scent of *smumstutstem* fruit fills the air, and a traveller is truly in Slimspüt.

In the Temple District of the city, the alleyways are paved with sandstone, inlaid with basalt. Writers gather here, praying and singing. In the early afternoon, the traveller can usually hear the bells of the theatre clock.

Lumsnukmam

From Slimspüt one can travel to Lumsnukmam. *Smumsünstol* graze on the road. At one point the route crosses a deep gully, spotted with *slimslol* flowers.

On entering the mighty city of Lumsnukmam one will discern the bronze spire of the infamous temple of Sil Limmes. At this distance, a traveller is unable to catch sight of how philosophers stay away from it, telling stories. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of heavy-hearted ecstasy, sung by soldiers of the city. At last the bouquet of *stuksun* plants fills the wind, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

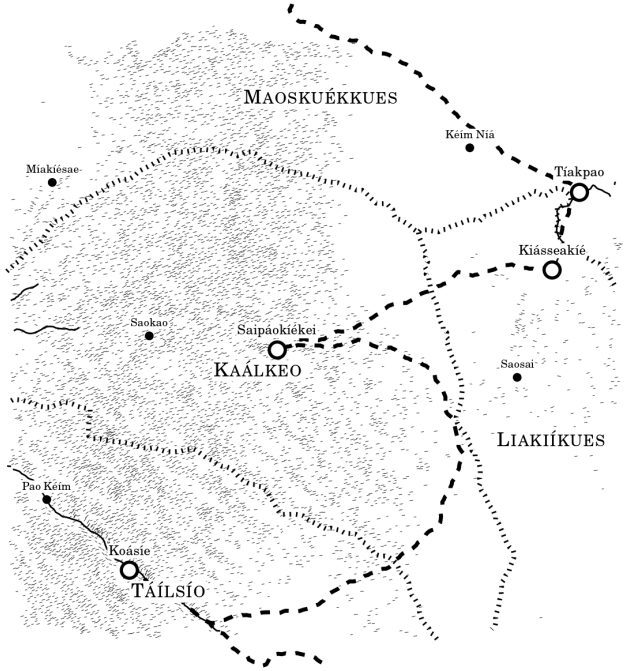
Around the citadel, the back-streets are lined with *limslol* trees. Actors mill here, dancing. In the late night, the traveller may sometimes hear the pleasant song of the *nun* birds, kept by petty criminals. If one is so ill-fated as to catch sight of the famous Skistül ceremony, a traveller might be drawn in, and unable to leave. The granite gargoyles which ornament the archways will be clear to the traveller. These betoken the shop of a doctor.

Nimlummom

Leaving Lumsnukmam one can journey to Nimlummom. The track is well-trodden, and the journey takes but an afternoon. By the roadside, *smasstuksmes* flowers grow. As the traveller crosses the border into Smemsümlom, there is a variation in the quality of the light, and a golden cast falls upon the terrain. At one point the route crosses a broad depression, spotted with *slimslol* bushes.

A traveller, nearing the outskirts of the gargantuan metropolis, will come across *stol*, bred for show by the scholars of the Actors' Quarter. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, one can faintly hear the knell of the dancing-hall clock. Ultimately the musk of *slol* plants fills the breeze, and a traveller is beyond doubt in Nimlummom.

Near the market-hall of Kulspessmem, the streets are paved with stone, inlaid with ivory. In the morning, the traveller can usually hear the gentle song of the *nunsmem* birds. The idle rich lounge here, laughing and praying. Should a traveller be charmed enough to find a herd of hairy *snassnalslim*, bred for work by the artisans of a nearby village, it can be a humbling experience. The traveller will notice the bronze carvings which grace the doorways. These commemorate the sickness which recently tormented Nimlummom.



MAOSKUÉKKUES TO TÁÍLSÍO

Tíakpao

The traveller, passing into Tíakpao, can stumble upon writers, trying their luck on the *síé* field. Nearer to the centre of the city, one begins to hear songs of melancholy bliss, sung by merchants of the surrounding countryside. Ultimately the aroma of *piesteu* fruit fills the wind, and a traveller is surely in Tíakpao.

In the Grey District of the city, the roadways are lined with *kaéttíintíinkoáloi* trees, and the red leaves rustle in the early evening air. In the afternoon, the traveller may often hear the clanging of the bastion clock. In the event that one is so blessed as to catch sight of a game of *koémsié*, it can be a few hours before escape is possible. Priests throng here, showing off at the game of *síé*.

Kiásseakíé

Onwards from Tíakpao the traveller may go to Kiásseakíé. As a traveller enters Liakiíkues, the vegetation changes, giving way to wild *kaétmía* plants and pastures. *Keokuéksiam* graze on the verge of the track. Along the way the route crosses a deep gorge, spotted with *kaétmoetkáos* flowers.

On entering the iniquitous city of Kiásseakíé one can see the ivory spires of the famed watchtower of Káikséíkpáo. Closer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller will hear songs of gleeful misery, sung by soldiers of the city. In the end the perfume of *kaétmoetkáos* flowers fills the air, and the traveller has undoubtedly arrived.

In the Artisans' Quarter, the alleyways are paved with obsidian. In the late morning, a traveller may sometimes hear the bells of the castle clock. The *kéíkkoásáelsái* bushes will be tricky to miss to one. These serve as a warning to harmful spirits. The idle rich congregate here, singing and laughing.

Saipáokíékei

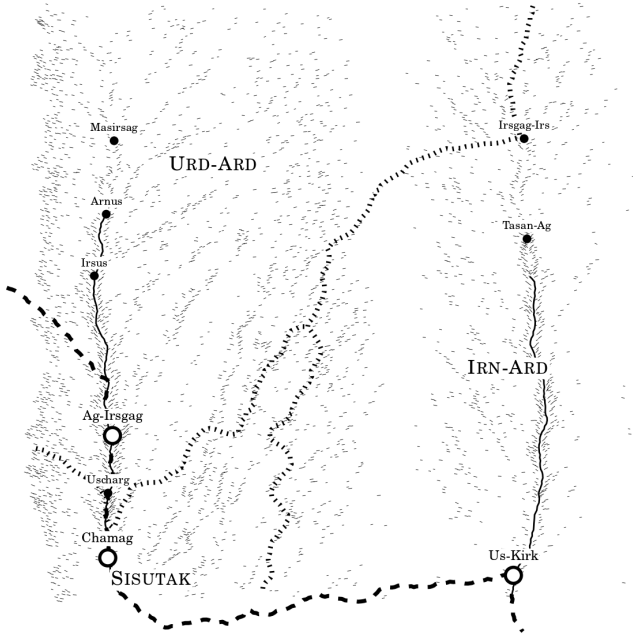
From Kiásseakíé a traveller can journey east to Saipáokíékei. The road is arduous, but scenic, taking several weeks. When one crosses the border into Kaálkeo, there is a change in the light, and a grey cast falls across the land. Along the way the track crosses a broad valley, spotted with *kaétmía* trees. *Kaéttíintíinkoáloi* plants grow by the roadside.

Approaching the edge of the mighty metropolis the traveller will see *keokuéksiam*, prized for their milk. Closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear the sweet song of the *séikpeoptéamsaí* birds, kept by petty criminals. Eventually the smell of *kaétmía* flowers fills the wind, and a traveller has without a doubt arrived.

In the vicinity of the counting-house of Séíktoí, the roadways are lined with *meístíis* trees. A hasty observer will not notice the caged *séal* birds. These are a memento of the war which twenty years ago beset the Blue District. In the early evening, one can often hear songs of merry gloom, sung by scholars of Saipáokíékei. Philosophers cluster here, praying.

Koásíe

Leaving Saipáokíékei the traveller may travel north-east to Koásíe. It is a smooth journey. As one crosses the border into Táílsío, the



greenery changes, giving way to woods of *níékéík* bushes and open fields. On the route, mighty *keokuéksiam* graze. At one point the road crosses a deep canyon, spotted with *kaétmía* plants.

A traveller, near the walls of Koásíe, may make out the vast mint of Keotíinséík. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the tolling of the temple clock. Ultimately the musk of *níelkoákáas* fruit fills the breeze, and the traveller is undeniably in Koásíe.

In the Ancient Quarter of the city, the streets are paved with bronze, inlaid with limestone. If one is lucky enough to come across a game of *koémsié*, the traveller may be drawn in, and find it hard to escape. The *kaéttíintíinkoáloi* flowers will be easy to see to a traveller. These mark the workplace of a fortune-teller. In the morning, one can typically hear the song of the *séal* birds, kept by labourers. Citizens teem here, telling stories and talking.

URD-ARD TO IRN-ARD

Ag-Irsgag

Near to the celebrated city a traveller may stumble upon pedlars, setting out their stalls. Somewhat nearer to the centre of the city, the traveller begins to hear songs of elegiac pleasure, sung by farmers of the surrounding countryside. Finally the perfume of *ardsurs* fruit fills the air, and one has beyond doubt arrived.

Around the university, the alleyways are lined with *girdak* bushes, and the blue blossoms shimmer in the wind. In the event that the traveller is so unfortunate as to find a herd of shaggy *ud*, the national animal of Urd-Ard, it may be a most edifying experience. In the late afternoon, a traveller may usually hear the delicate song of the *dalsnulknirs* birds.

Chamag

Leaving Ag-Irsgag one may journey north to Chamag. It is a simple journey. Along the way the track crosses a deep gully, spotted with *irsgird* trees. When a traveller enters Sisutak, there is a shift in the quality of the light, and a bluish cast falls upon the landscape. *Girdchuk* plants grow near the edge of the route.

A traveller, outside the famous city of Chamag, will observe the tremendous market-hall of Cham-Id. A little closer to the heart of the city, the traveller will begin to hear songs of mournful delight, sung by soldiers of the city. Ultimately the fragrance of *girdchuk* flowers fills the breeze, and one is undoubtedly in Chamag.

In the New District, the boulevards are paved with stone, inlaid with ivory. Writers throng here, trying their luck at the game of *gagurdnirn*. If a traveller is unlucky enough to see an altercation between two lovers, it may be half a day before escape is possible. In the early evening, one may occasionally hear the peal of the palace clock. The traveller will be inspired by the granite figures that decorate the pediments. These are in memory of the plague which in times past troubled the Green Quarter.

Us-Kirk

Onwards from Chamag a traveller can go west to Us-Kirk. The track is long, but scenic, taking some days. When one crosses the border into Irn-Ard, the vegetation changes, giving way to scrubland and hedgerows. On the roadside, horned *kirdchuk* graze.

At the outskirts of Us-Kirk the traveller can catch sight of actors, dancing and praying. Nearer to the inner parts of the city, a traveller can faintly hear the balmy song of the *dalsnulknirs* birds, kept by petty criminals. Finally the scent of *surs* fruit fills the air, and the traveller has surely arrived.

Near the bastion of Idutan, the squares are paved with marble, inlaid with basalt. Scholars swarm here, singing. The tame *dalsnulknirs* birds will be conspicuous to one. These signify the place of business of an apothecary.